HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University

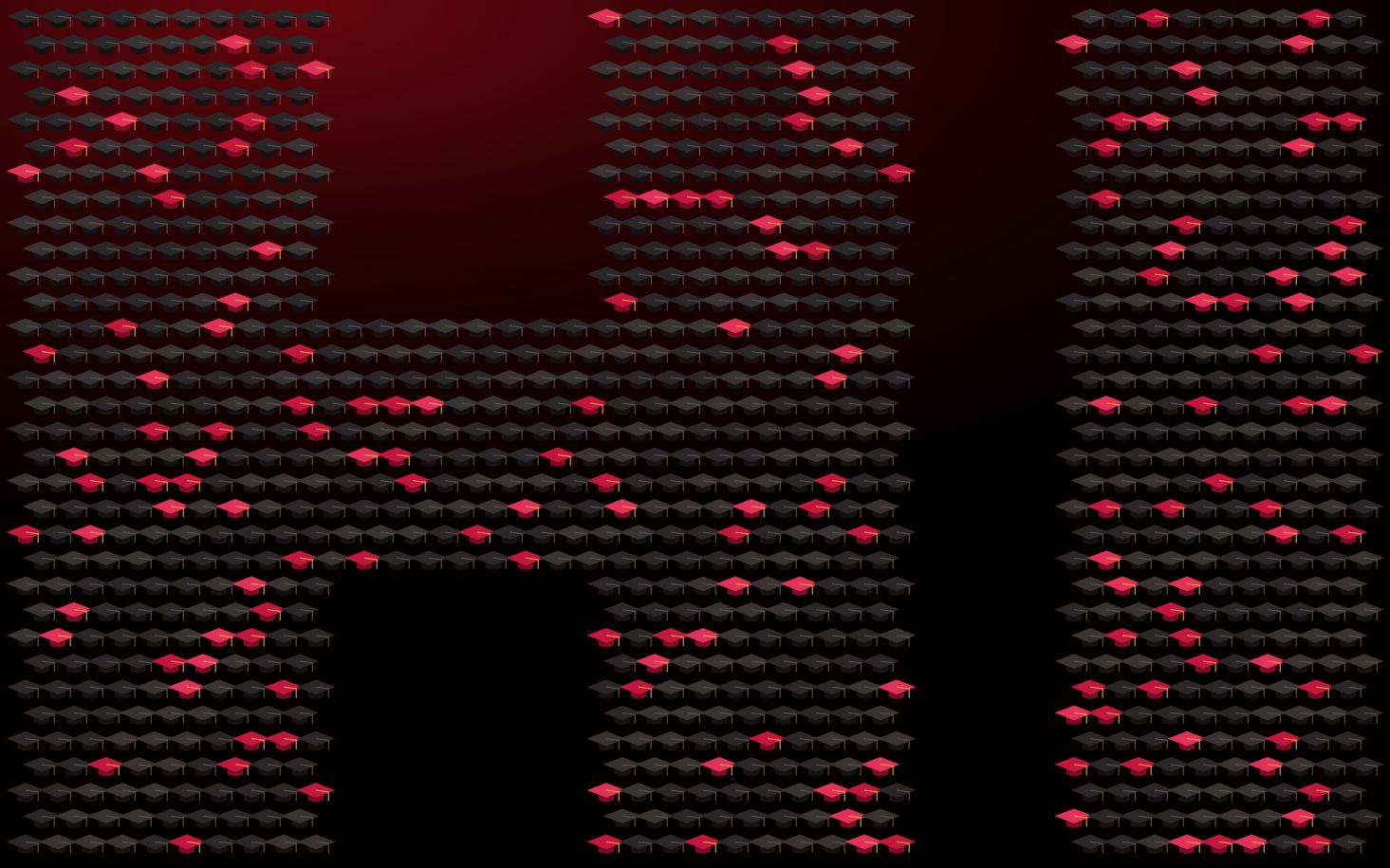
HAI Stanford University Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence

NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **16 in every 100**, mark the international share of Hawaii's STEM master's degrees.



This page intentionally left blank.

HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University

Stanford University
Human-Centered
Artificial Intelligence

The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

Table of Contents

OVERVIEW

At a Glance 6

SECTIONS

Section 1 International Dependence 8
Section 2 STEM Degrees 18
Section 3 Where Students Come From 24
Section 4 K-12 Preparation 30
Section 5 Graduate Research 32
Section 6 Do Graduates Stay? 34
Section 7 Research Funding 36
Section 8 H-1B Jobs and Green Cards 38
Section 9 STEM Workforce 42
Section 10 Patents 44
Section 11 Competitors 46
Section 12 Fields of Study 48
Section 13 Students and Money 58
Section 14 Student Outcomes 66
Section 15 Faculty 70
Section 16 Institutions 74

BACK MATTER

About these Data 78
By the Numbers 80
Sources 89

Authors

Emerson Victoria Johnston is a research assistant with the Hoover Institution's Technology Policy Accelerator. A Knight-Hennessy Scholar, she holds a master's in international policy from Stanford University, and is on leave from its master's program in the history of science, technology, environment, and medicine.

Dr. Amy Zegart is the Morris Arnold and Nona Jean Cox Senior Fellow at the Hoover Institution, director of Hoover's Technology Policy Accelerator, and a senior fellow and associate director at Stanford University's Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence.

Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Hawaii: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

How to Cite this Profile

Emerson V. Johnston and Amy Zegart, “The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile,” Technology Policy Accelerator, Hoover Institution, and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, November 2026.

Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, and from SEVIS by the Numbers, published by the Department of Homeland Security's Student and Exchange Visitor Program. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Hawaii's numbers say

1. **International students earn 16% of Hawaii's STEM master's degrees,** 36.1 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 46th of 51 on dependence. The share is 35% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 8.3% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Hawaii awarded 40 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.0% of the U.S. total and 47th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed −15%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in engineering,** where international students earned 17% of master's degrees (76 degrees; U.S. 49%). No STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Hawaii ranks 5th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Hawaii 16%, Delaware 72%, South Dakota 48%, North Dakota 36%, Rhode Island 47%.
5. **73% of Hawaii's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 5.3% came from abroad. More residents left for other states (3.98K) than students arrived from them (1.79K), a net loss of 2.19K; the top destination for those leaving was California.

16%

of the STEM master's degrees Hawaii awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

61.4K #44
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −11% since 2015

40 #47
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · −15% since 2015

16% #46
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · −2.9 pp since 2015

10% #36
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · −1.8 pp since 2015

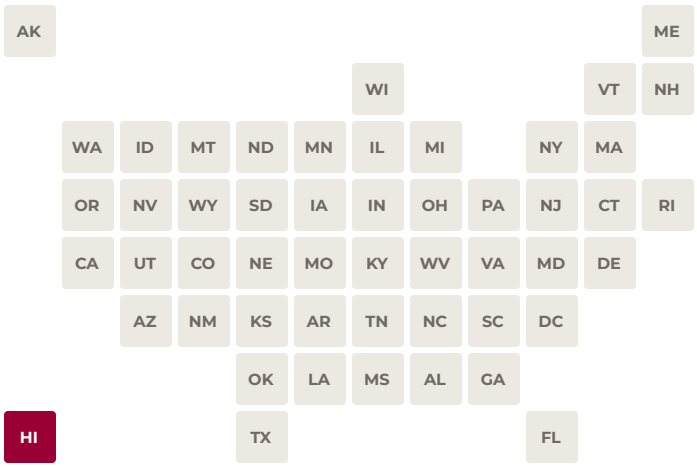
20% #42
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +4.4 pp since 2015

56% #42
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +6.1 pp since 2015

$16.9K #7
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +36% since 2015

73% #24
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −4.2 pp since 2016

$110K #13
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −4.2% since 2016

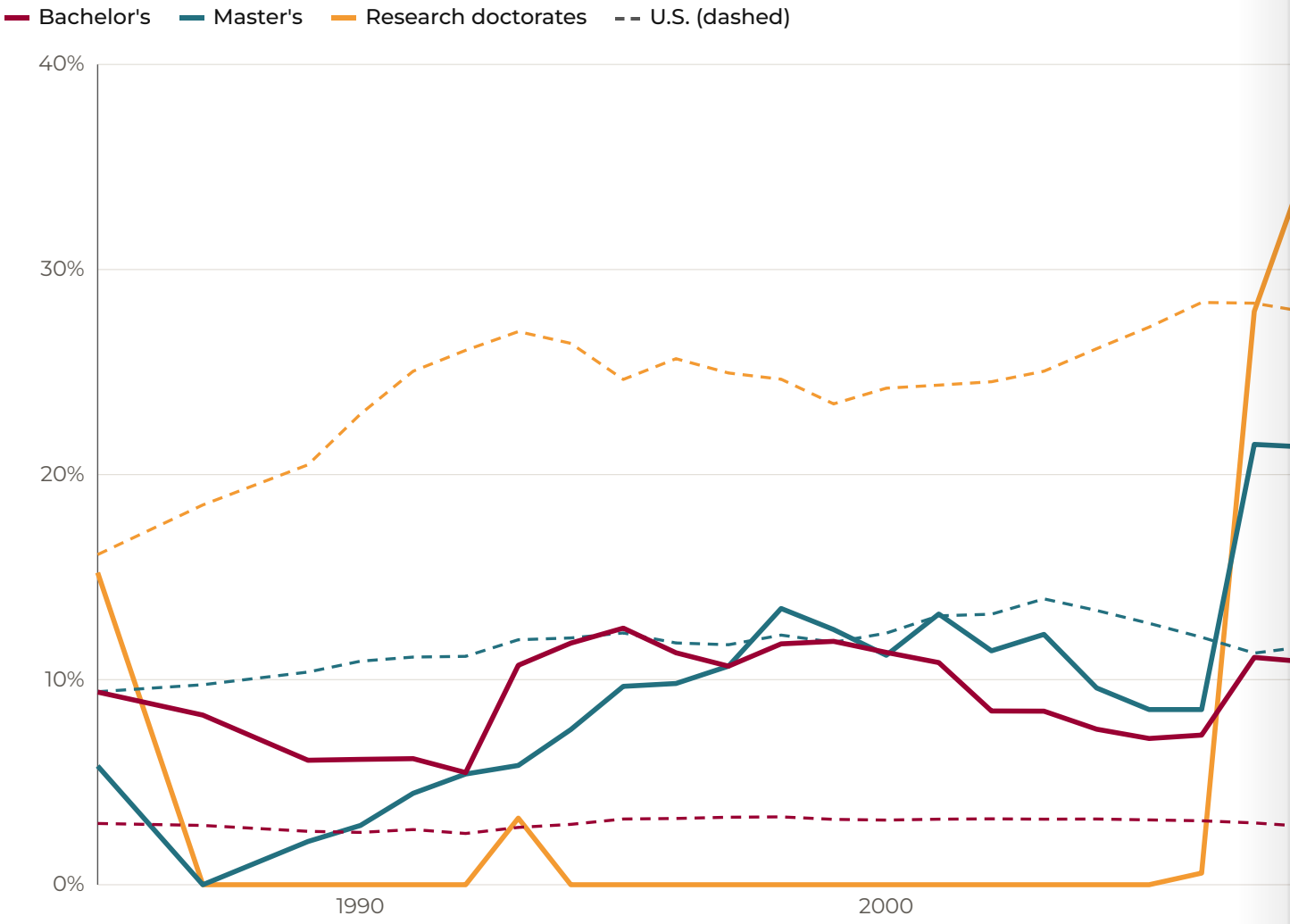


Badges give Hawaii's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

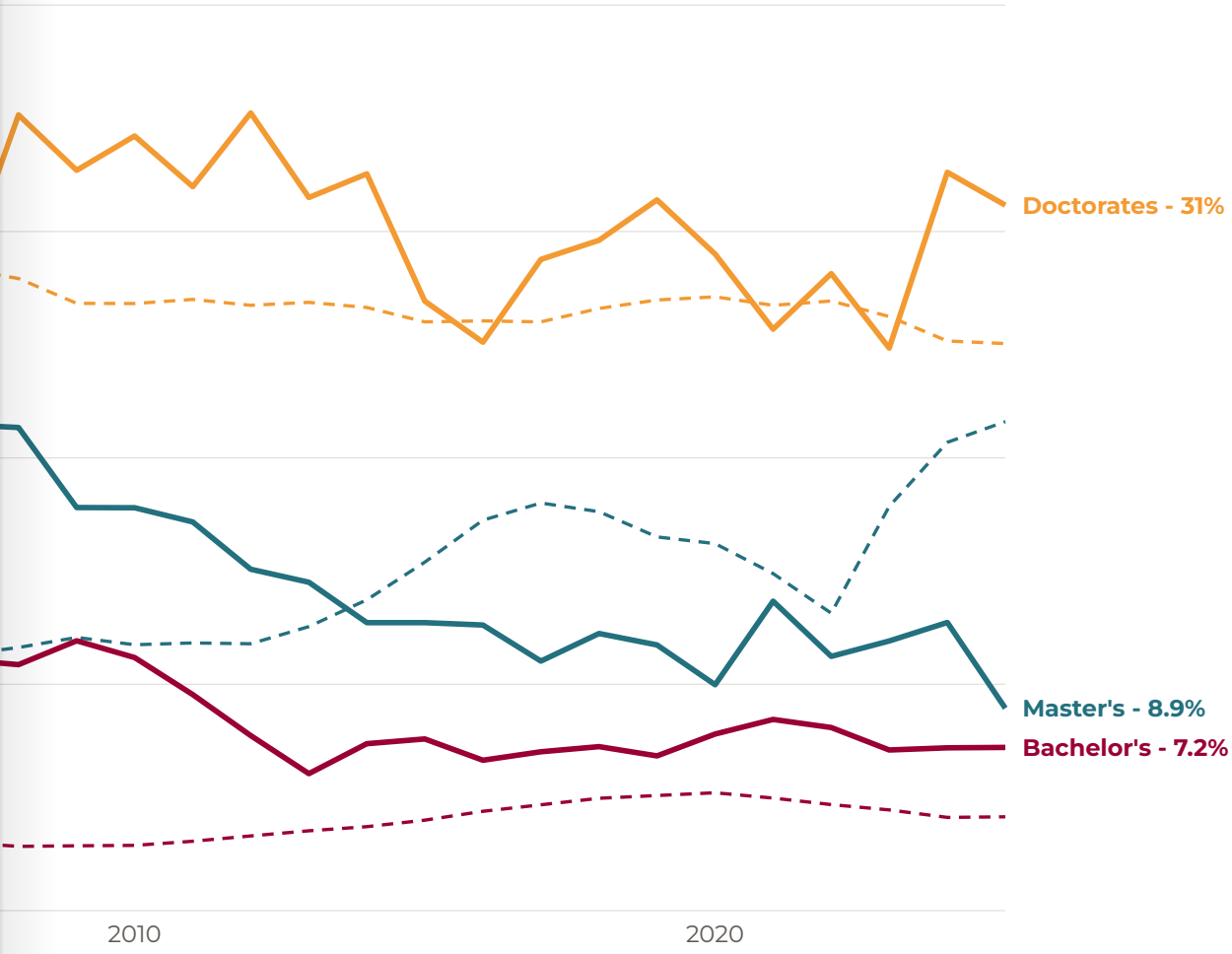
Figure 1 What Share of Hawaii's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025

International students make up 10% of Hawaii's graduate enrollment and 6.2% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 7.2% of bachelor's, 8.9% of master's and 31% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 8.3% of STEM bachelor's, 16% of STEM master's and 35% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.0% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 47th of 51.



5.

10%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **36th** of 51 · −1.8 pp since 2015

8.9%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

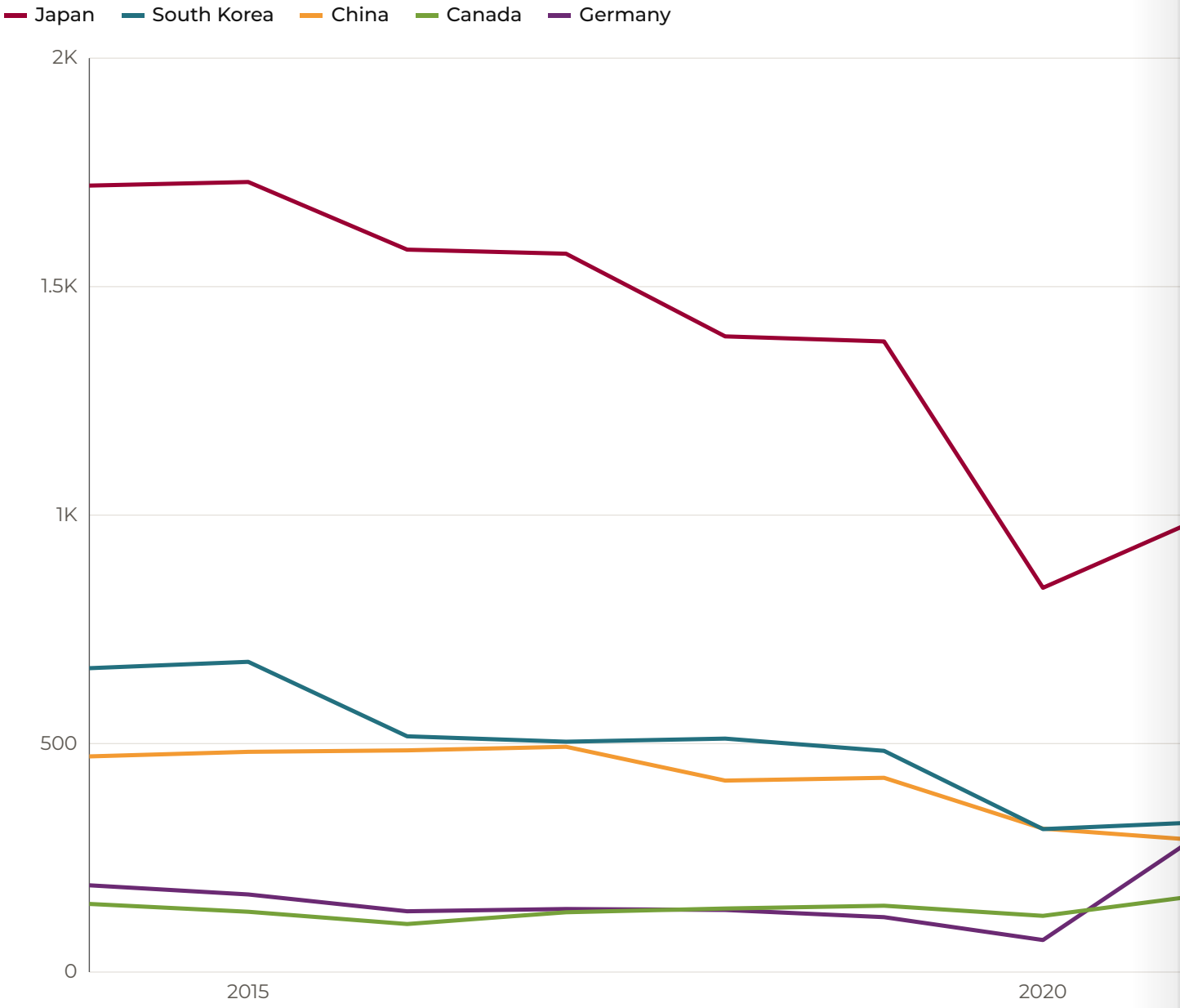
U.S. **22%** · **41st** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

16%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **46th** of 51 · −2.9 pp since 2015

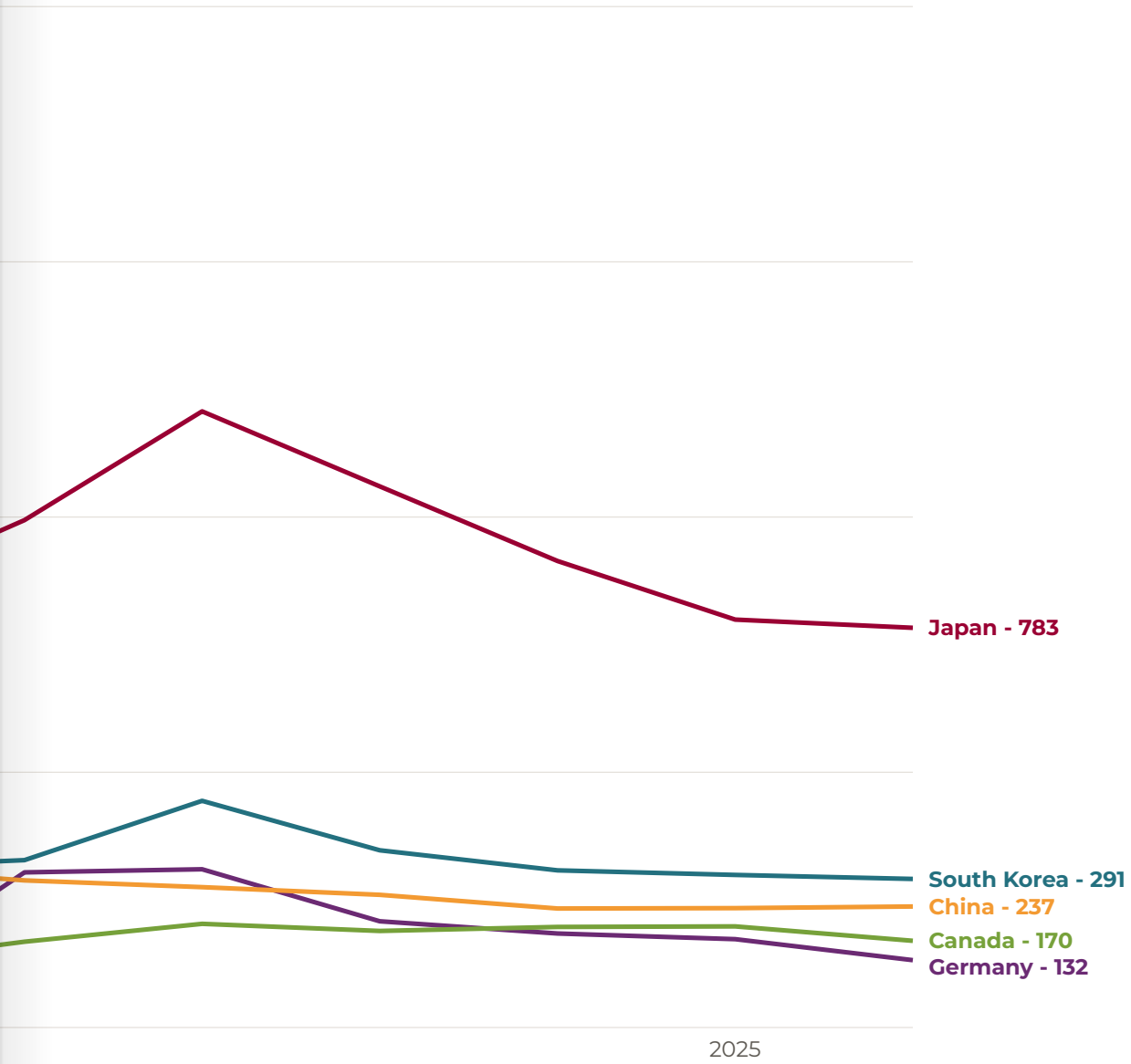
Figure 2 Where Do Hawaii's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one snapshot per year (the latest m

In October 2026, Hawaii had 2.68K active international students in SEVIS, 44th of 51. Japan accounted for 29% of them and South Korea for 11%, against 1.2% and 3.5% nationally.

Students came from 101 countries, but the two largest supplied 40%. The state's total is down 46% since 2014.



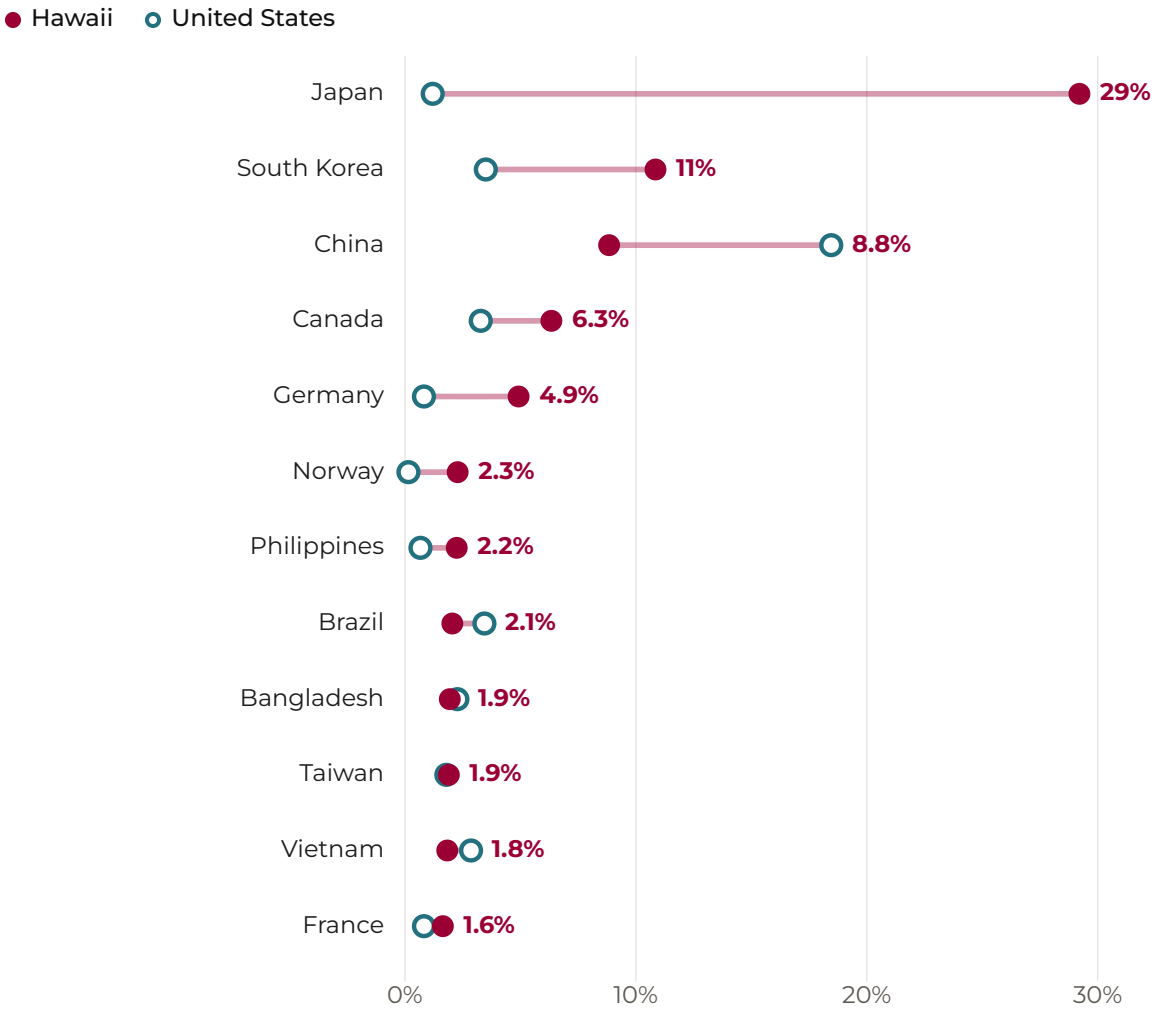
onth available), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

2.68K
Active international students, October 2026
44th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

29%
From Japan
U.S. **1.2%**

26%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

Figure 3 Is Hawaii's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

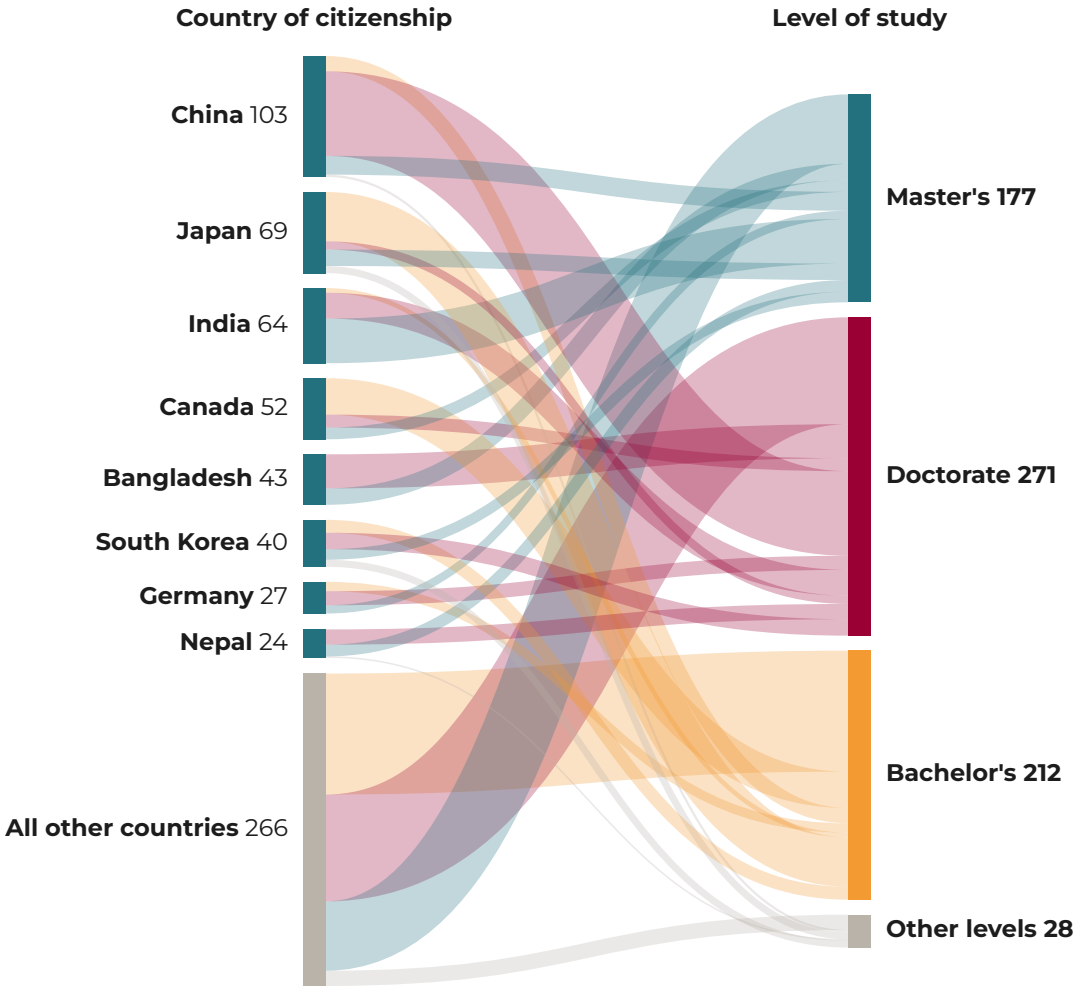
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is one of the 12 countries with the most active F-1 and M-1 student records in Hawaii in October 2026. The filled dot is the country's share of the state's international students; the open dot is its share of all international students in the United States. Students at every level, from secondary school to doctorate, are counted. Yearly counts are the latest month available in each year.

THE NUMBERS

- **All active international students**: 2.68K in October 2026, 44th of 51 states (U.S. 1.19M), down 5.9% from 2.85K in 2025, and down 44% since 2015 (4.8K).
- **Japan**: 29% of the state's international students (U.S. 1.2%); 783 students in 2026, down 2.0% from 799 in 2025, and down 55% since 2015 (1.73K).
- **South Korea**: 11% of the state's international students (U.S. 3.5%); 291 students in 2026, down 2.7% from 299 in 2025, and down 57% since 2015 (679).
- **China**: 8.8% of the state's international students (U.S. 18%); 237 students in 2026, up 1.3% from 234 in 2025, and down 51% since 2015 (482).

Figure 4 Which Countries Supply Hawaii's International STEM Students?



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level, October 2026; the eight largest countries. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

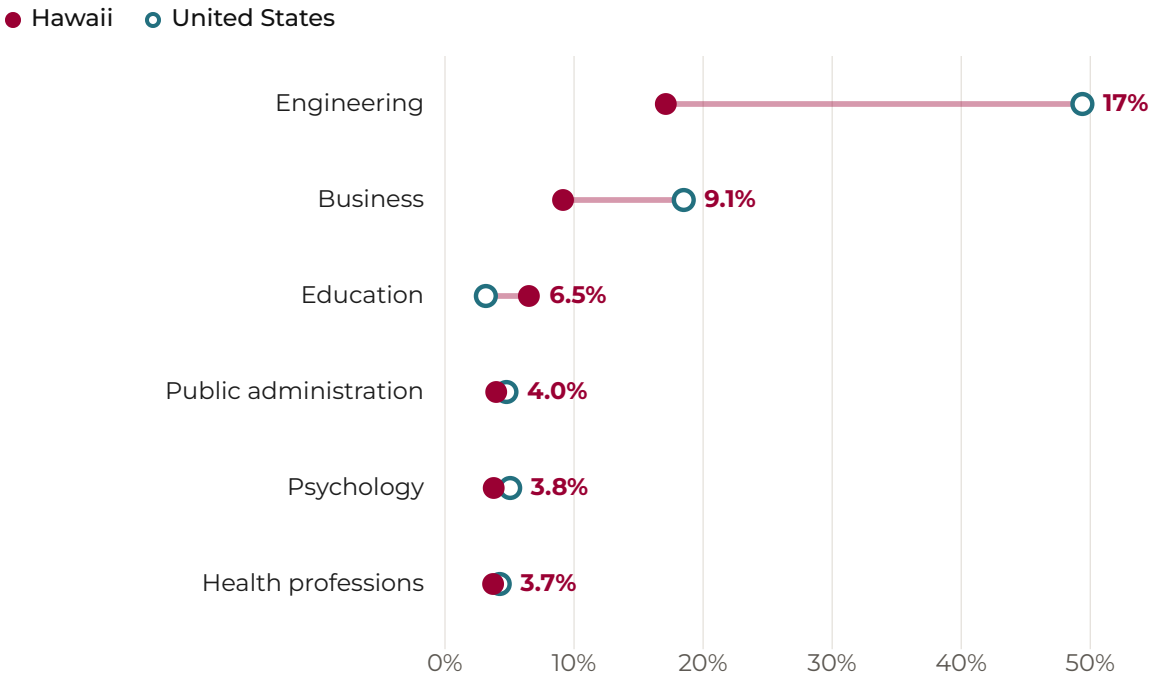
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each band runs from a country of citizenship on the left to a level of study on the right, for international students enrolled in STEM fields in October 2026. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. The eight largest countries are shown and the rest are grouped as all other countries.

THE NUMBERS

- **Share of international students in STEM fields**: 26% in October 2026 (U.S. 63%).
- **Master's level**: 177 students; largest countries India (38), China (16), Bangladesh (14).
- **Doctorate level**: 271 students; largest countries China (72), Bangladesh (29), India (22).
- **Bachelor's level**: 212 students; largest countries Japan (42), Canada (31), China (13).
- **Active STEM students**: 688 in 2026 (U.S. 749K; 47th of 51 states), down 7.7% from 745 in 2025, and up 27% since 2015 (543).
- **Share of STEM master's students from India**: 21% in 2026 (U.S. 58%; 50th of 51 states), down 4.6 points from 26% in 2025, and up 15.7 points since 2015 (5.8%).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Hawaii in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international shares**: engineering 17% (U.S. 49%); business 9.1% (U.S. 19%); education 6.5% (U.S. 3.2%).
- **All master's degrees**: 8.9% in 2025 (U.S. 22%; 41st of 51 states), down 3.8 points from 13% in 2024, and down 3.8 points since 2015 (13%).
- **STEM master's degrees**: 16% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 46th of 51 states), up 2.6 points from 13% in 2024, and down 2.9 points since 2015 (19%).
- **Computer and information sciences master's**: 20% in 2025 (U.S. 65%; 44th of 47 states), down 8.2 points from 28% in 2016, and down 6.5 points since 2015 (26%).

Table 1 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	15% / 8.6%	**20% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	2.0% / 7.2%	**17% / 49%**	61% / 55%
Engineering technology	– / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	8.3% / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	5.1% / 6.0%	**15% / 33%**	25% / 38%
Biological sciences	9.1% / 3.4%	**19% / 23%**	33% / 23%
Natural resources	7.1% / 2.0%	**10% / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	0.0% / 7.3%	**4.5% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Hawaii / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

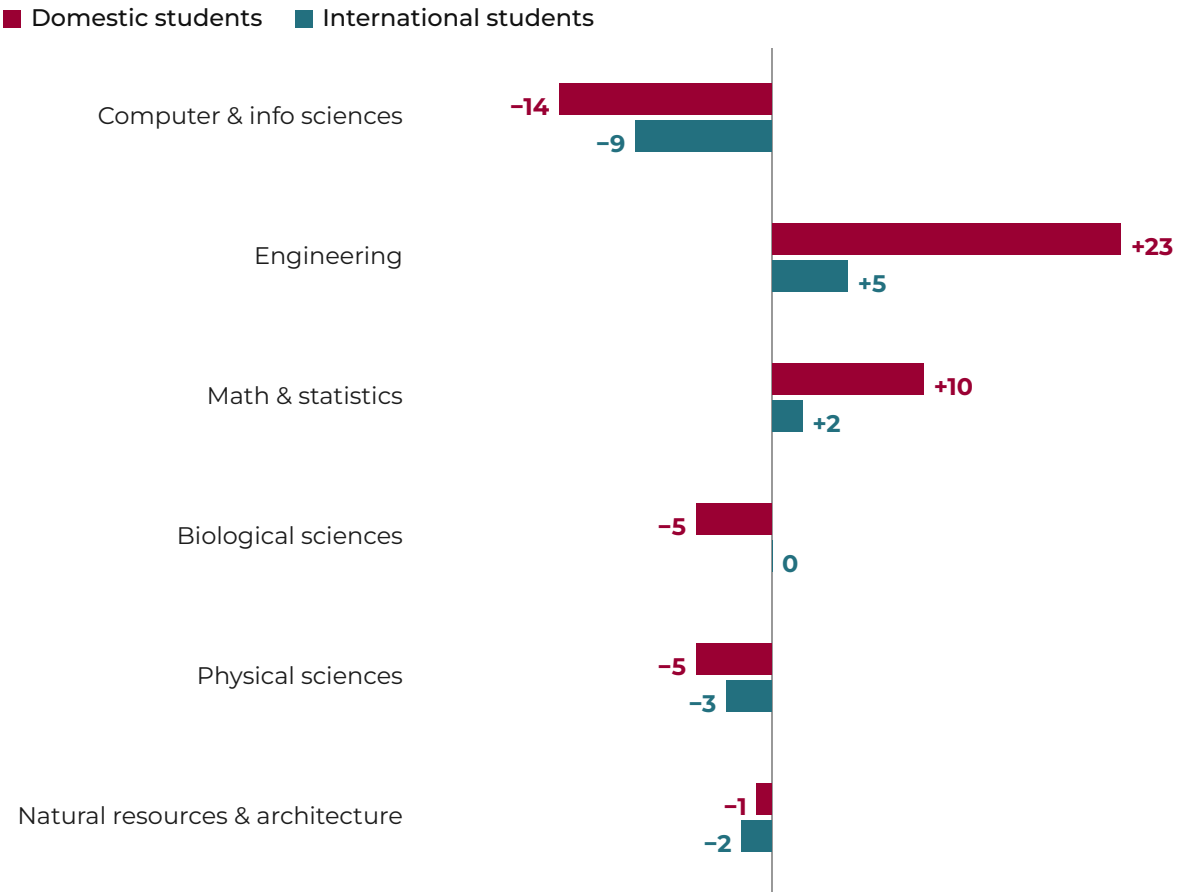
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Hawaii first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international share among STEM master's fields**: engineering, 17% (U.S. 49%).
- **International share of STEM bachelor's**: 8.3% in 2025 (U.S. 6.6%; 7th of 51 states), up 1.5 points from 6.8% in 2024, and up 3.2 points since 2015 (5.1%).
- **International share of STEM master's**: 16% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 46th of 51 states), up 2.6 points from 13% in 2024, and down 2.9 points since 2015 (19%).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 35% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 41st of 51 states), up 2.2 points from 32% in 2024, and down 5.7 points since 2015 (40%).

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Hawaii between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

THE NUMBERS

- **STEM master's degrees**: 250 in 2025, against 249 in 2015: −7 for international students and +8 for domestic students.
- **Computer & info sciences**: −14 for domestic students and −9 for international students.
- **Engineering**: +23 for domestic students and +5 for international students.
- **Math & statistics**: +10 for domestic students and +2 for international students.
- **International students' STEM master's degrees**: 40 in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 47th of 51 states), up 38% from 29 in 2024, and down 15% since 2015 (47).

Table 2 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	68	**45**	−34%	9	26%	20%
Engineering	48	**76**	+58%	13	17%	17%
Math & statistics	7	**19**	+171%	4	29%	21%
Biological sciences	37	**32**	−14%	6	16%	19%
Physical sciences	35	**27**	−23%	4	20%	15%
Natural resources & architecture	54	**51**	−5.6%	4	11%	7.8%

STEM master's degrees awarded in Hawaii, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Hawaii in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

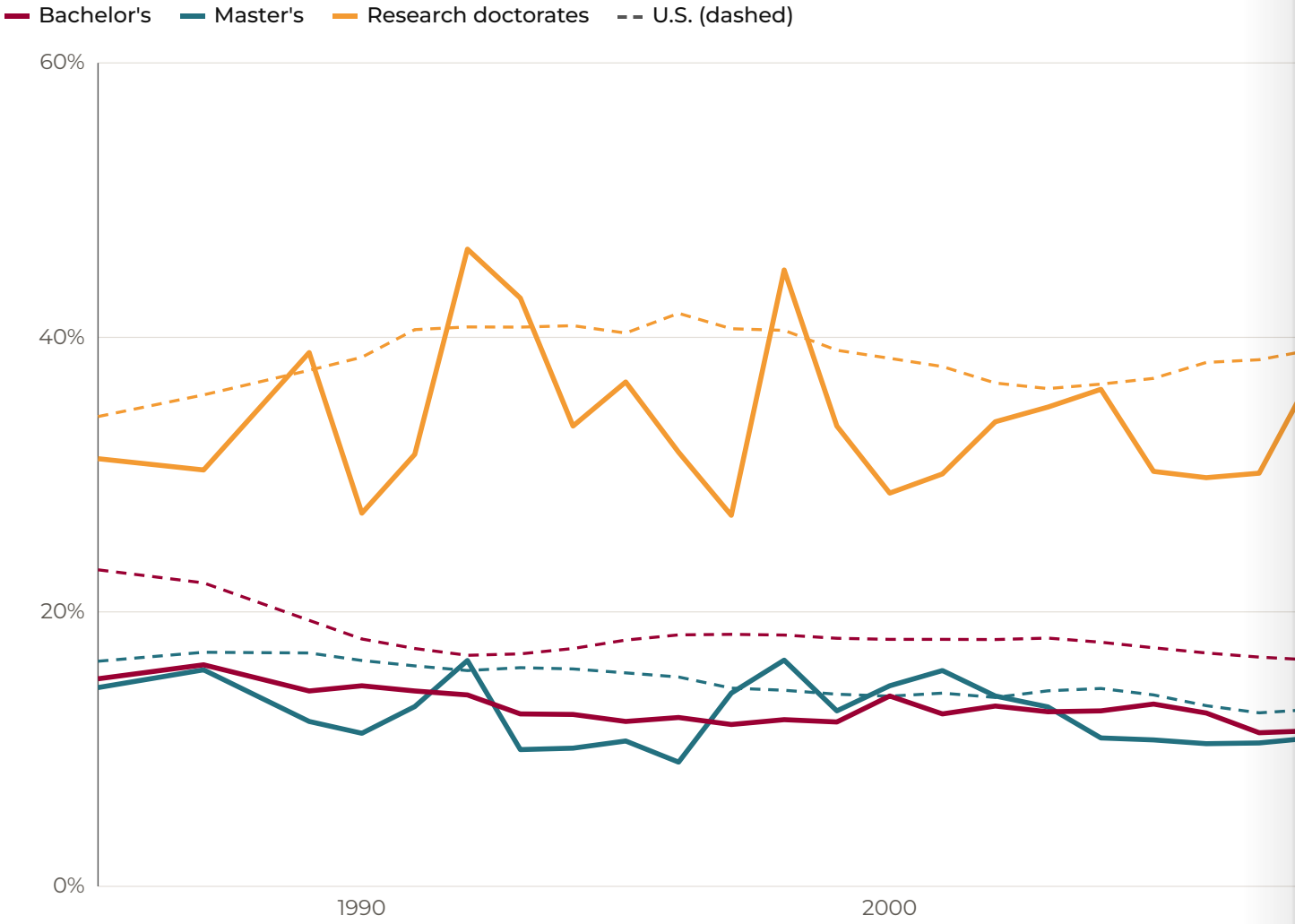
THE NUMBERS

- **STEM share of master's degrees**: 17% in 2025 (U.S. 23%; 35th of 51 states), up 1.9 points from 15% in 2024, and up 3.5 points since 2015 (13%).
- **Share of all U.S. international STEM master's**: 0.0% in 2025 (47th of 51 states), unchanged from 0.0% in 2024, and down 0.1 points since 2015 (0.1%).
- **STEM master's degrees per research doctorate**: 2.6 in 2025 (U.S. 6.4; 49th of 51 states), down 0.3 from 2.8 in 2024, and down 0.1 since 2015 (2.6).

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

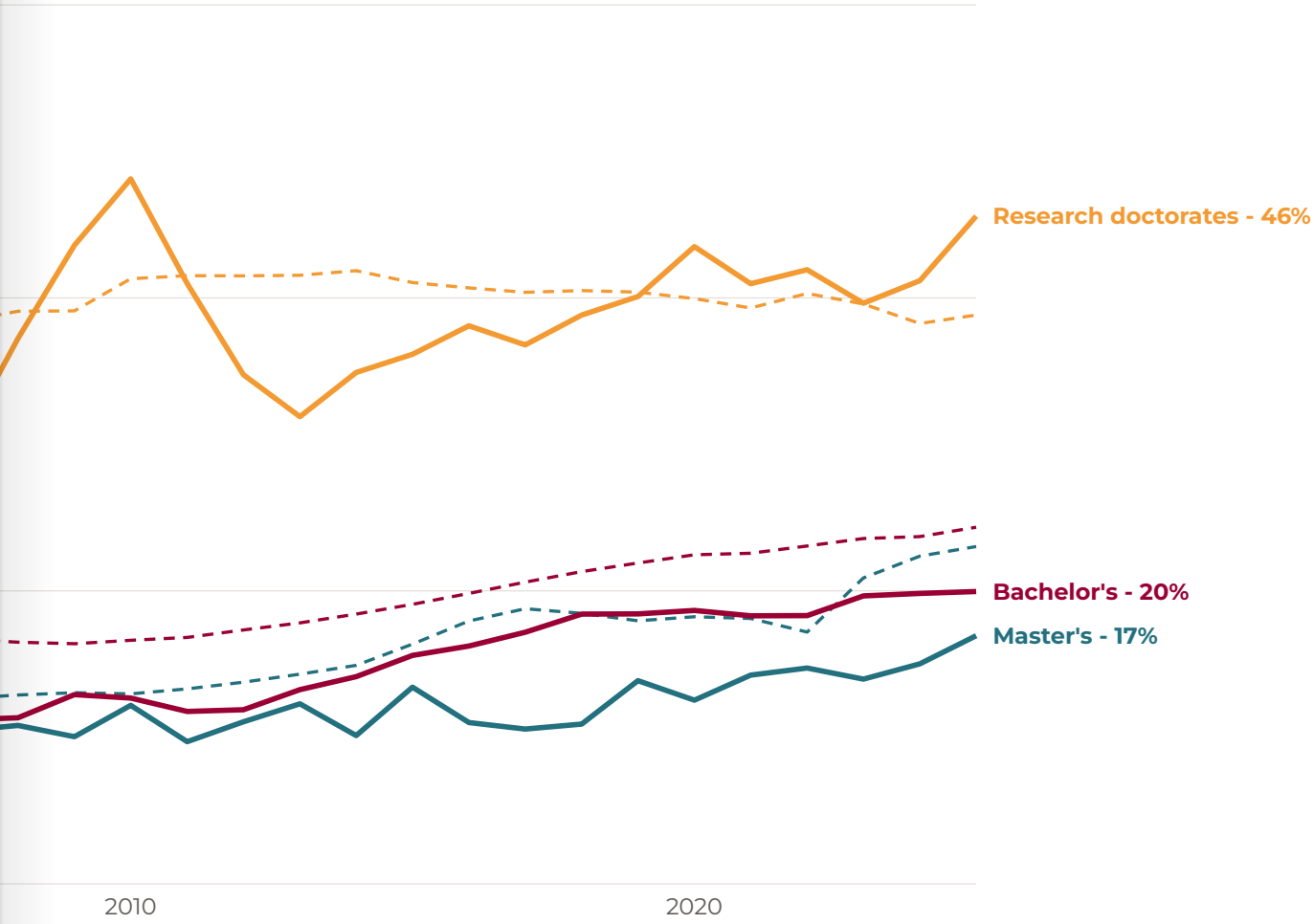
Figure 7 How Much of Hawaii's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 20% of Hawaii's bachelor's degrees, 17% of its master's and 46% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 3.5 points since 2015, and the state ranks 35th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 42nd of 51.



20%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **42nd** of 51 · +4.4 pp since 2015

17%

STEM share of master's, 2025

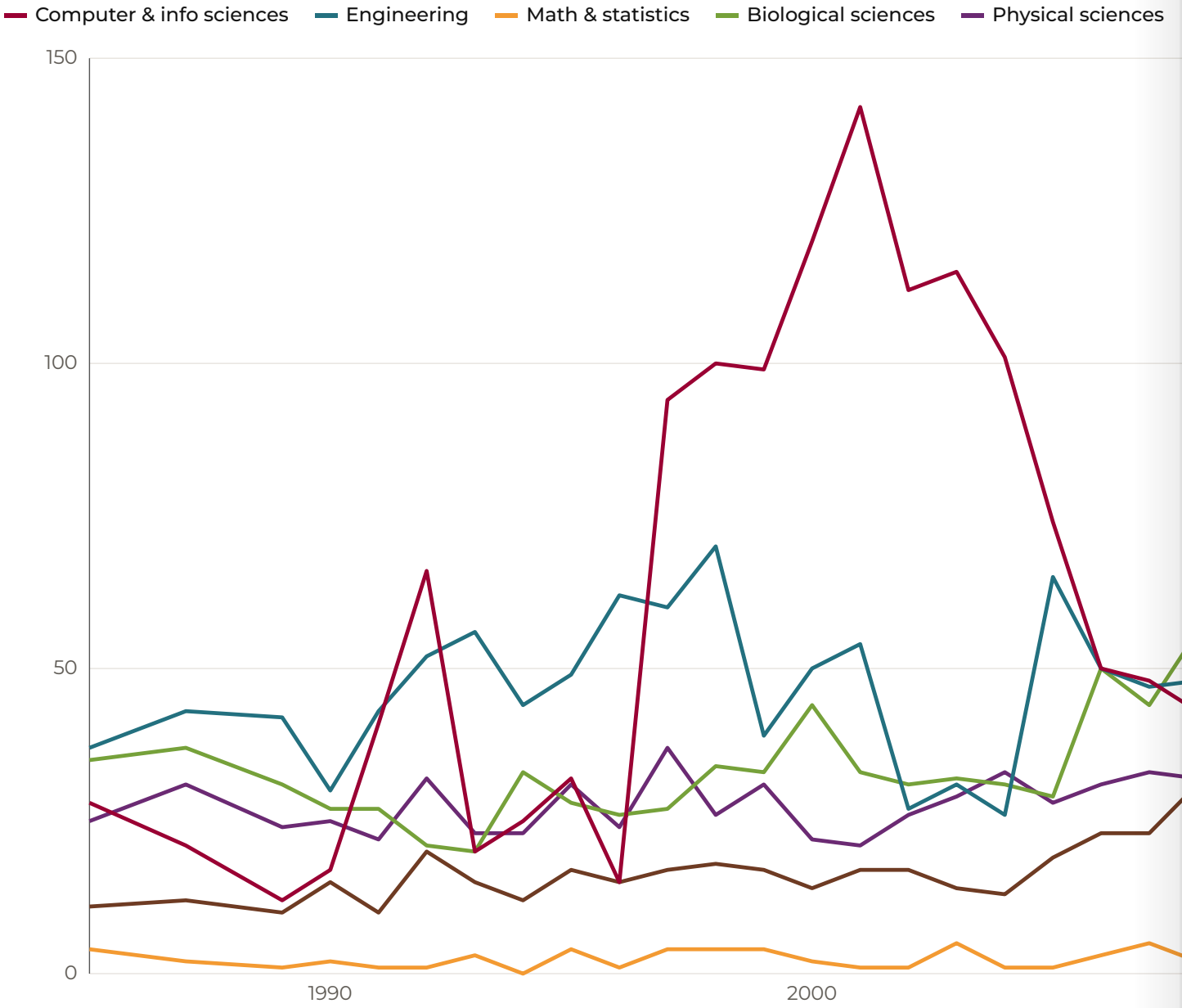
U.S. **23%** · **35th** of 51 · +3.5 pp since 2015

46%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **18th** of 51 · +9.4 pp since 2015

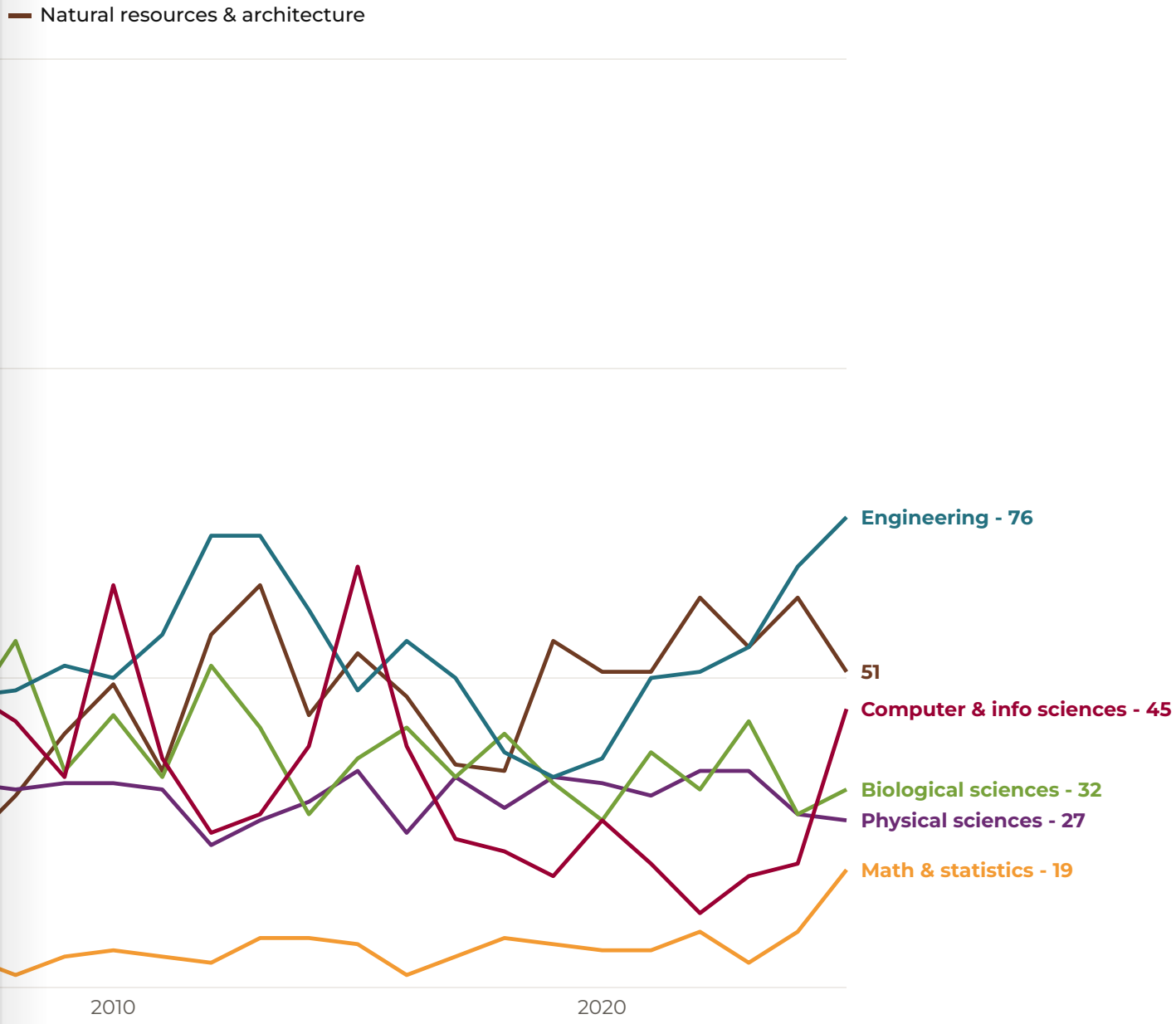
Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Hawaii's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Engineering produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 76, followed by natural resources & architecture (51) and computer & info sciences (45). Master's degrees in engineering are up 58% since 2015.

International students earned 40 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.0% of the national total (47th of 51).



40

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **47th** of 51 · −15% since 2015

0.0%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

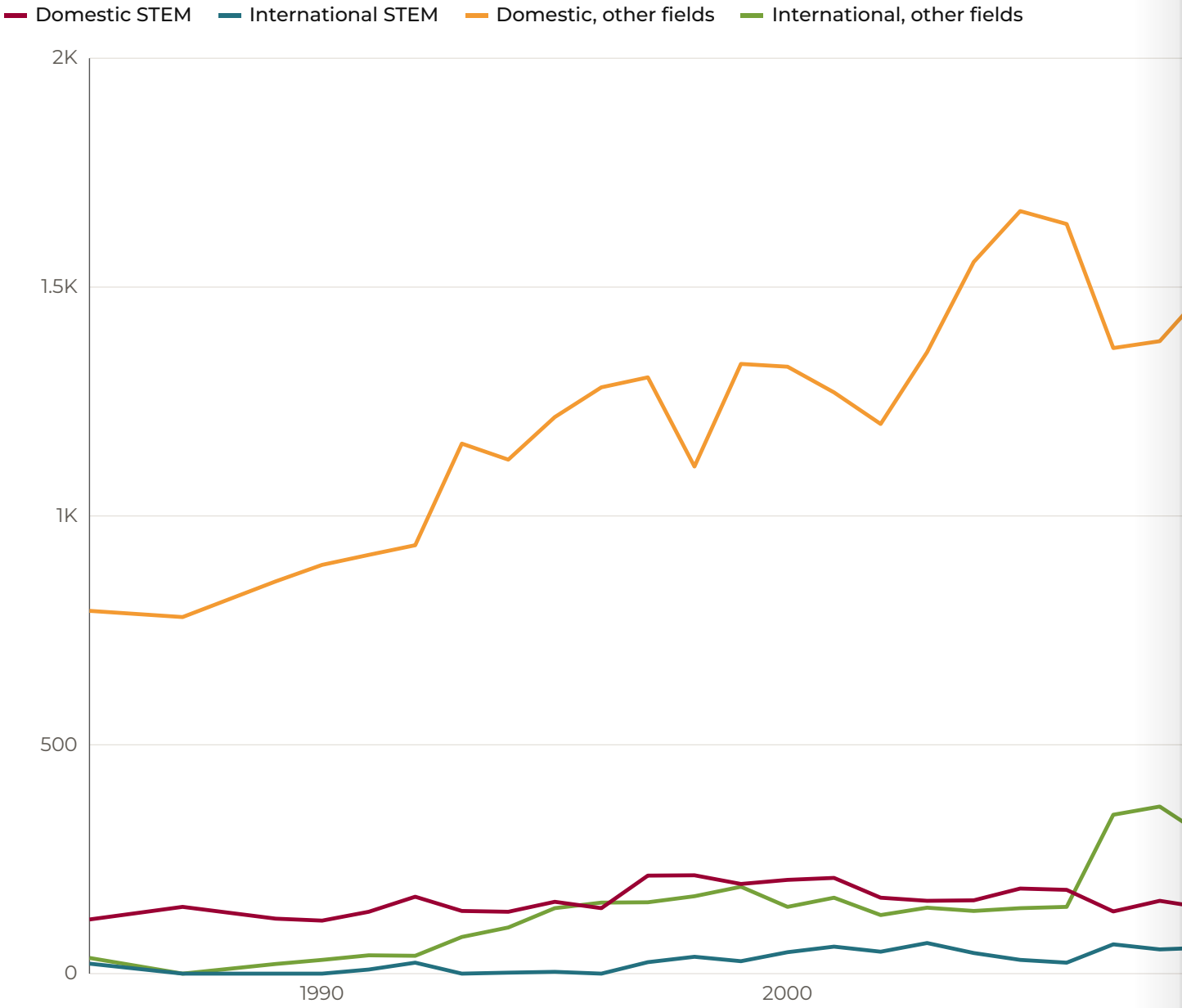
U.S. **100%** · **47th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

20%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **44th** of 47 · −6.5 pp since 2015

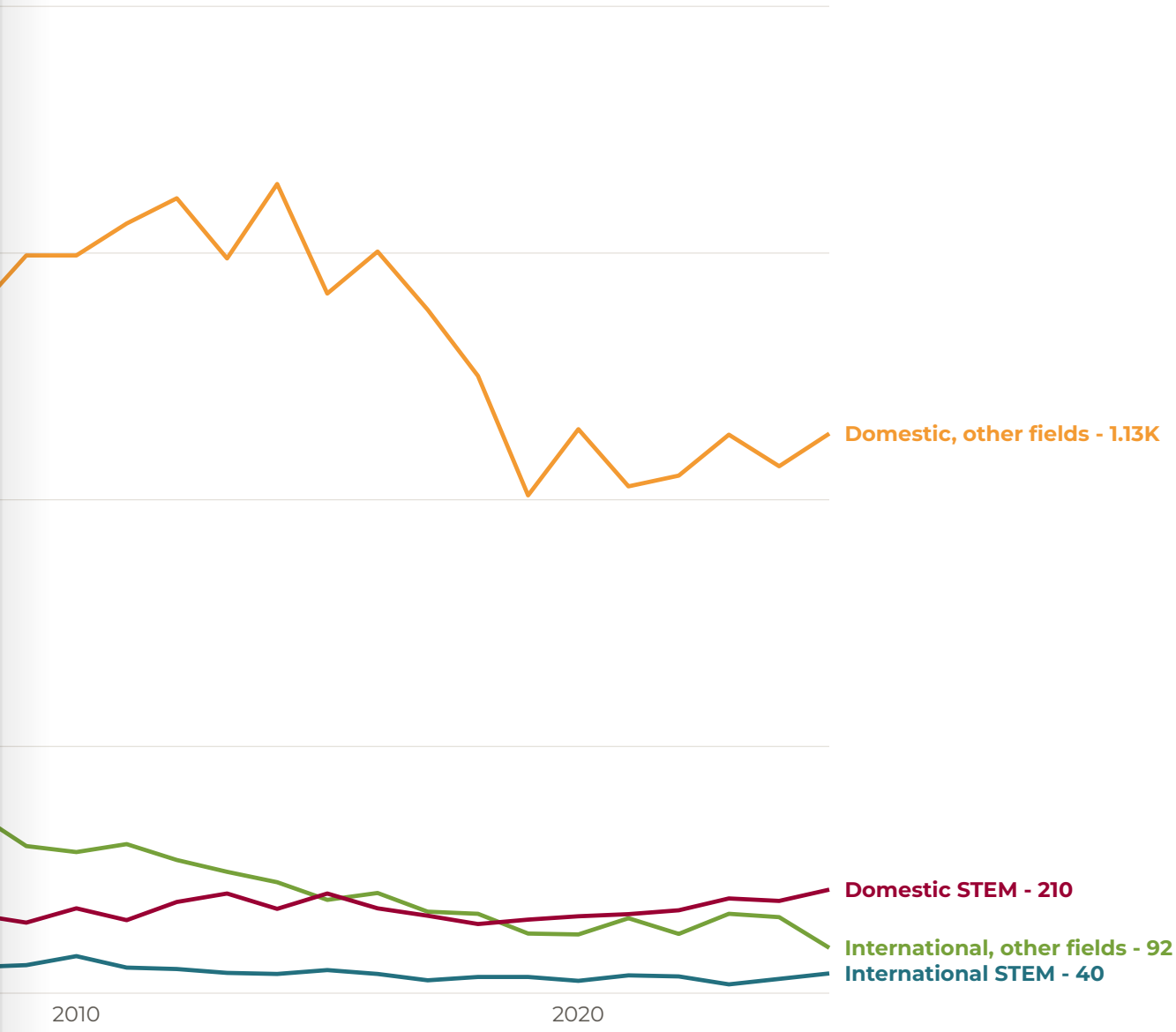
Figure 9 Who Earns Hawaii's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, –7 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 8 more to domestic students.

International students earn 16% of Hawaii's STEM master's but 7.5% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).



8.9%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **41st** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

16%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **46th** of 51 · −2.9 pp since 2015

2.6

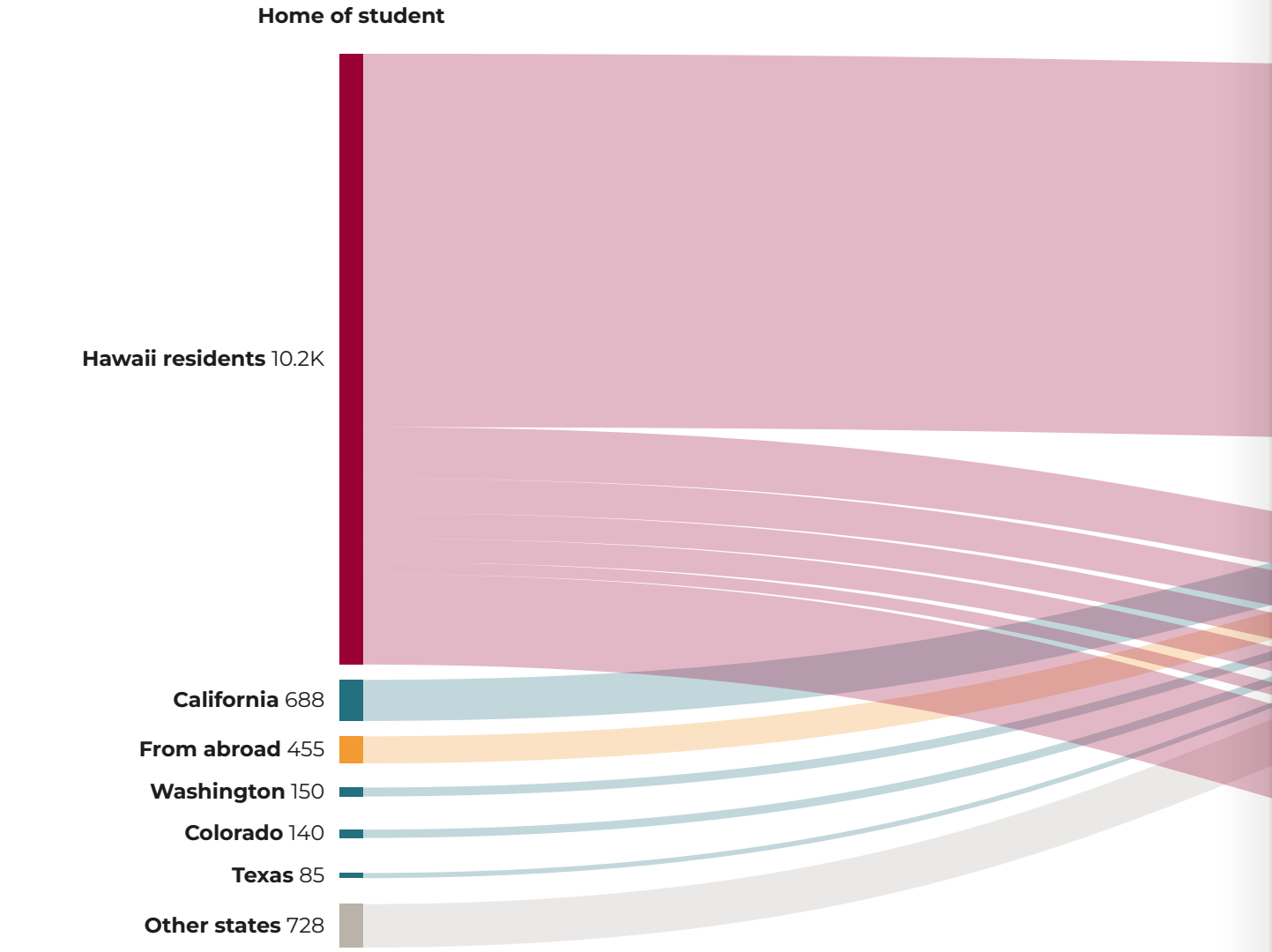
STEM master's per doctorate, 2025

U.S. **6.4** · **49th** of 51 · −0.1 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

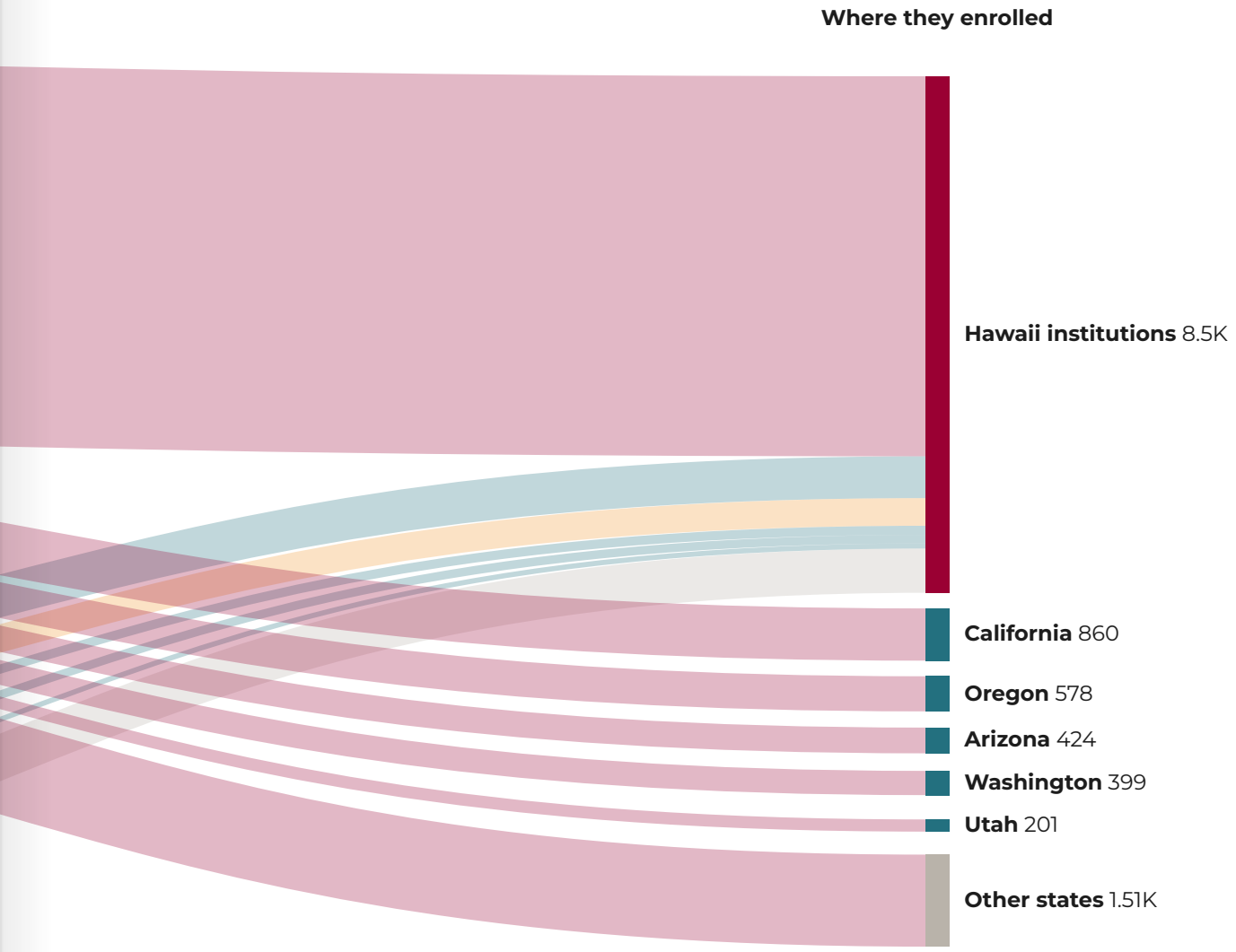
Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest s

6.26K residents stayed in Hawaii for college in fall 2024; 1.79K students arrived from other states and 455 from abroad, while 3.98K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 73% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).



ources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

73%

First-time students from in state, 2024

· **24th** of 51 · −4.2 pp since 2016

5.3%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

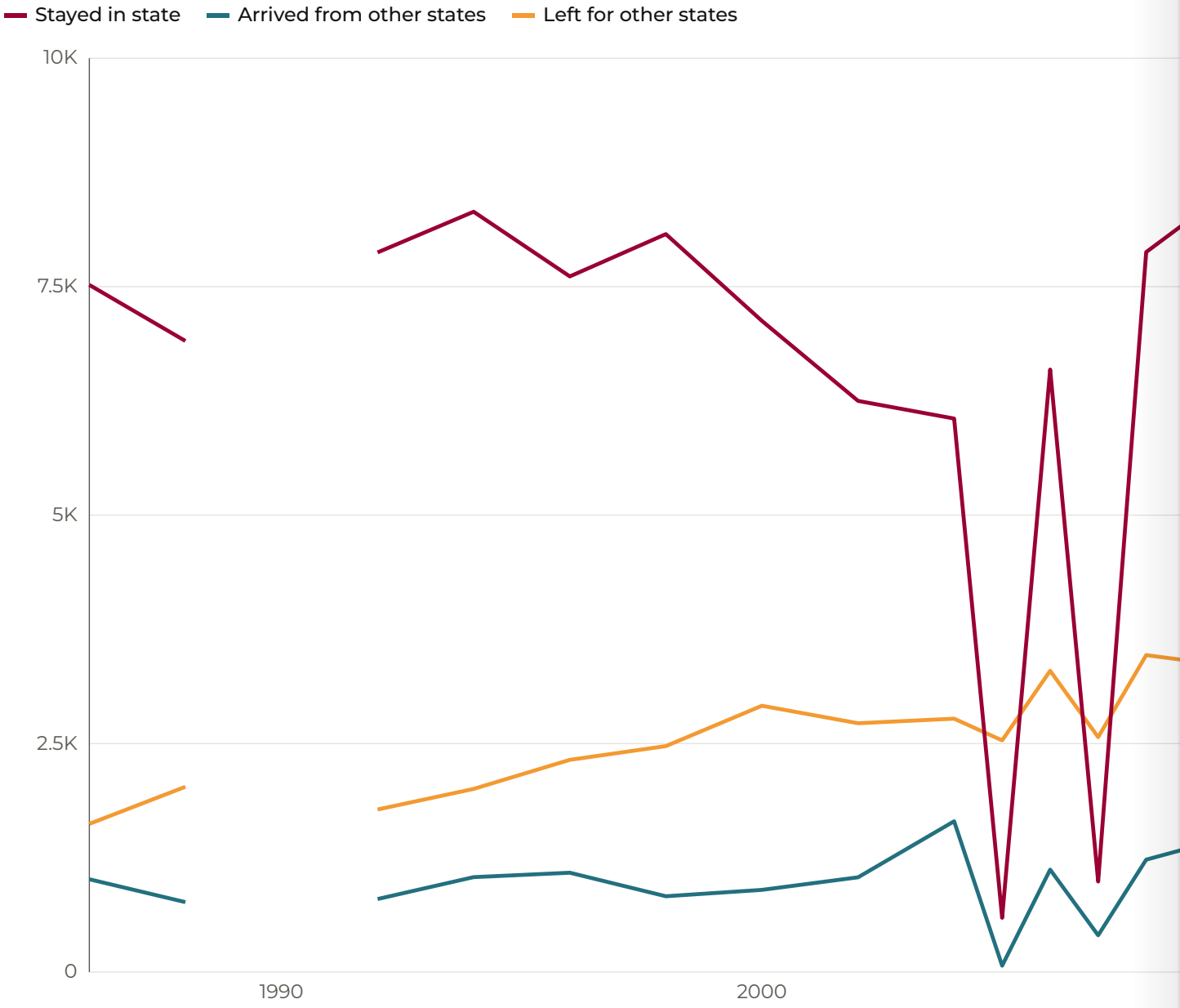
U.S. **3.1%** · **5th** of 51 · +0.8 pp since 2016

−21

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

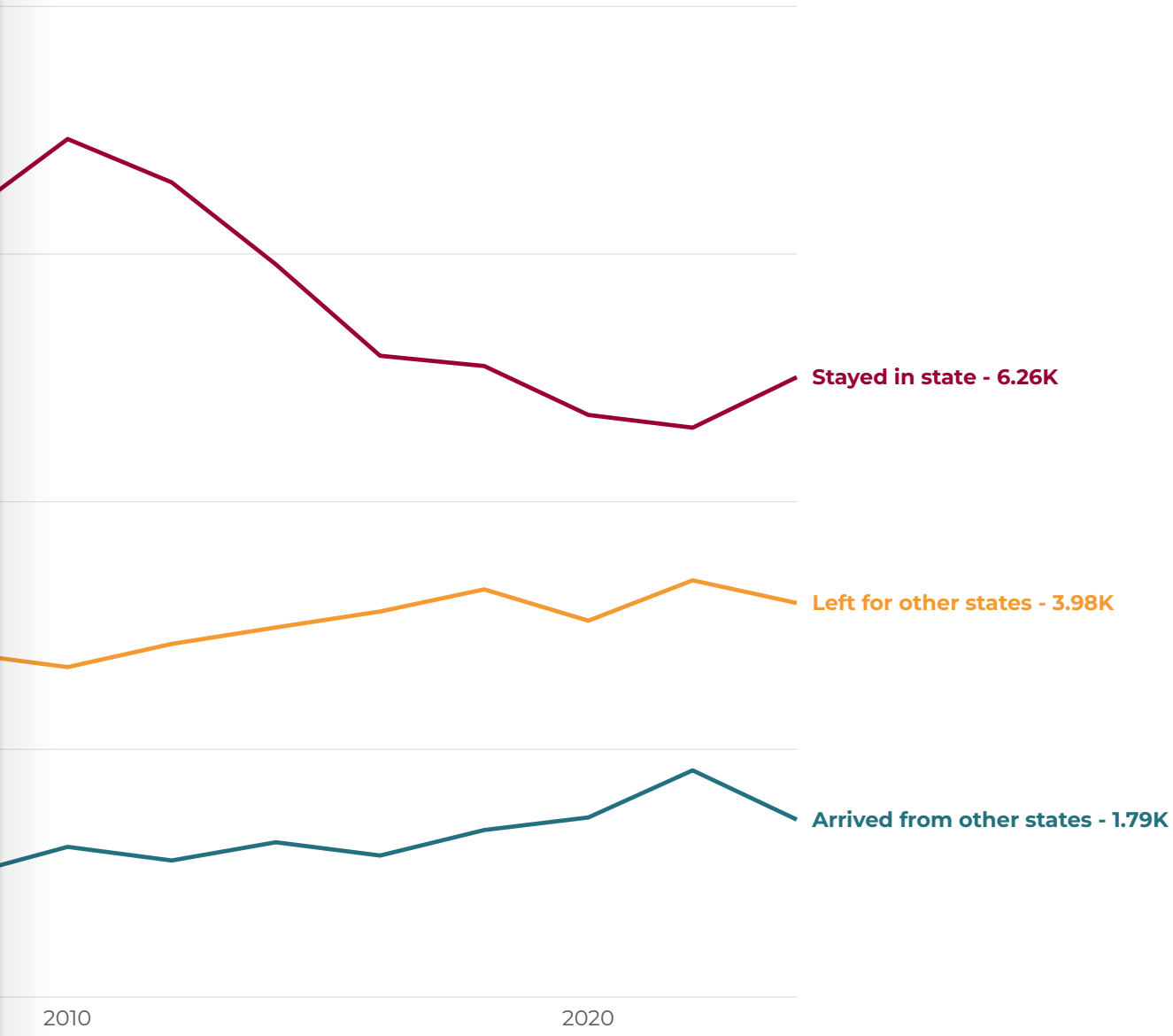
· **49th** of 51 · +2.4 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



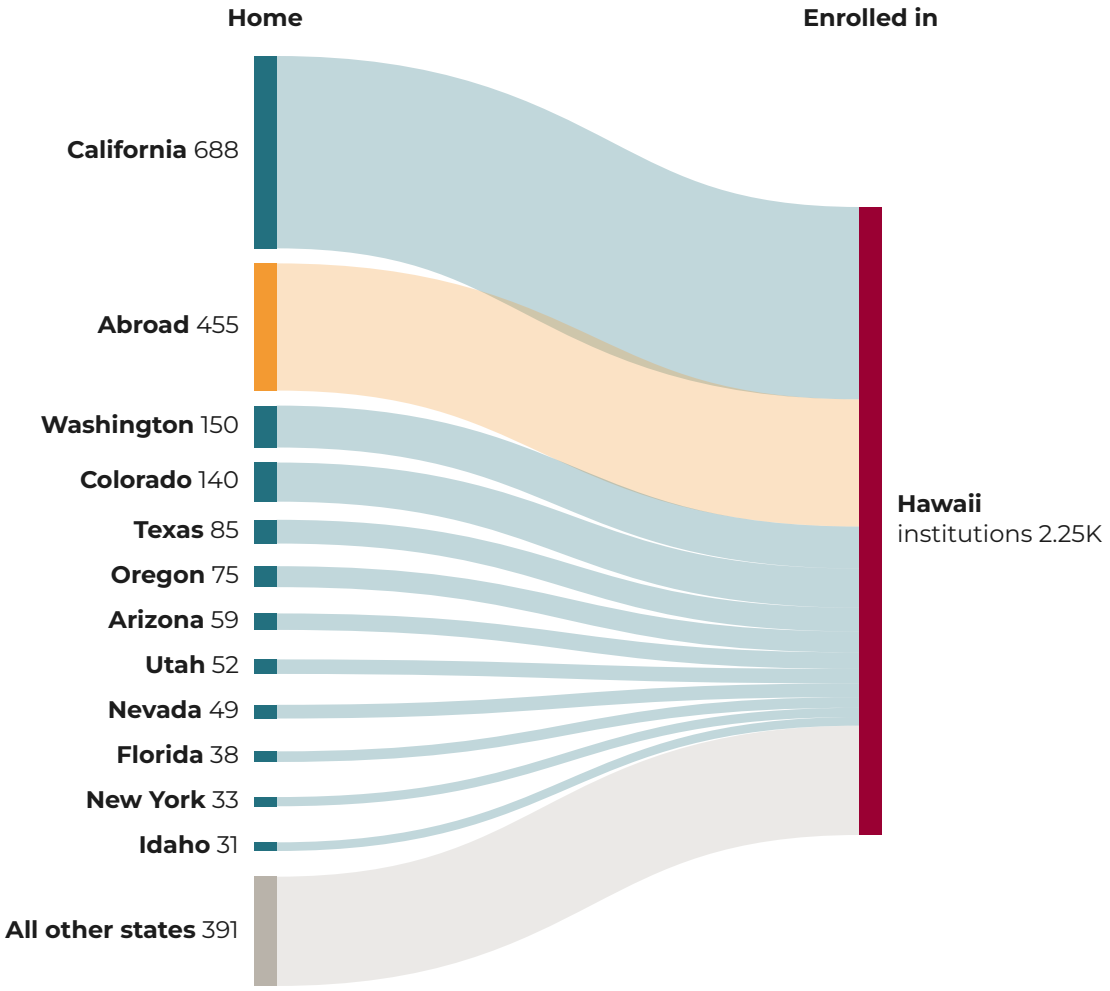
First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 3%, arrivals from other states are up 25%, and residents leaving are up 2%.



Net migration was −21 per 100 resident first-time students (49th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was California (860).

Figure 12 Where Do Hawaii's Newcomers Come From?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

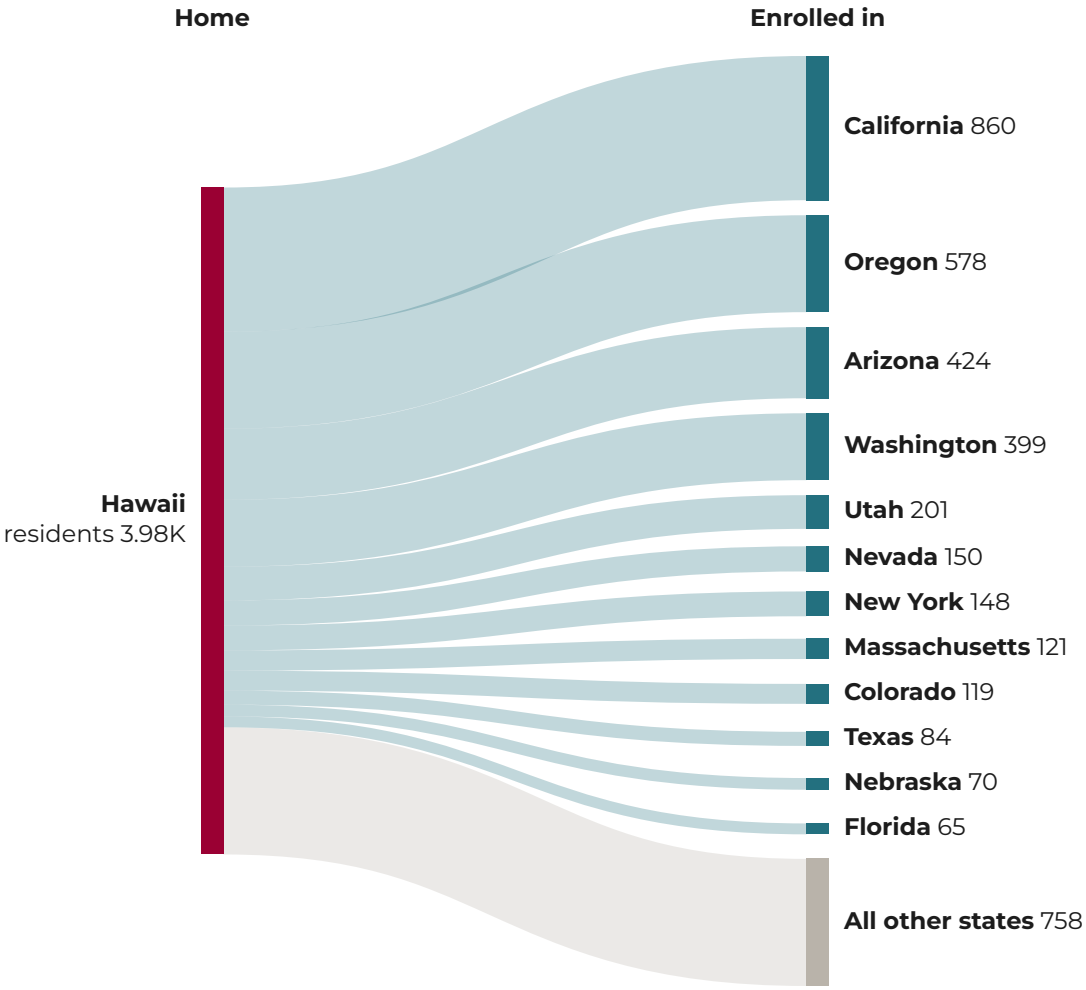
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Hawaii's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

THE NUMBERS

- **Students arriving from other states**: 1.79K in fall 2024, down 22% from 2.29K in fall 2022, and up 25% since fall 2016 (1.43K).
- **Students arriving from abroad**: 455 in fall 2024.
- **Largest home states**: California (688), Washington (150), Colorado (140).
- **Share of first-time students from outside the U.S.**: 5.3% in 2024 (U.S. 3.1%; 5th of 51 states), down 0.7 points from 6.0% in 2022, and up 0.8 points since 2016 (4.5%).

Figure 13 Where Do Hawaii's Residents Go When They Leave?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where Hawaii residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

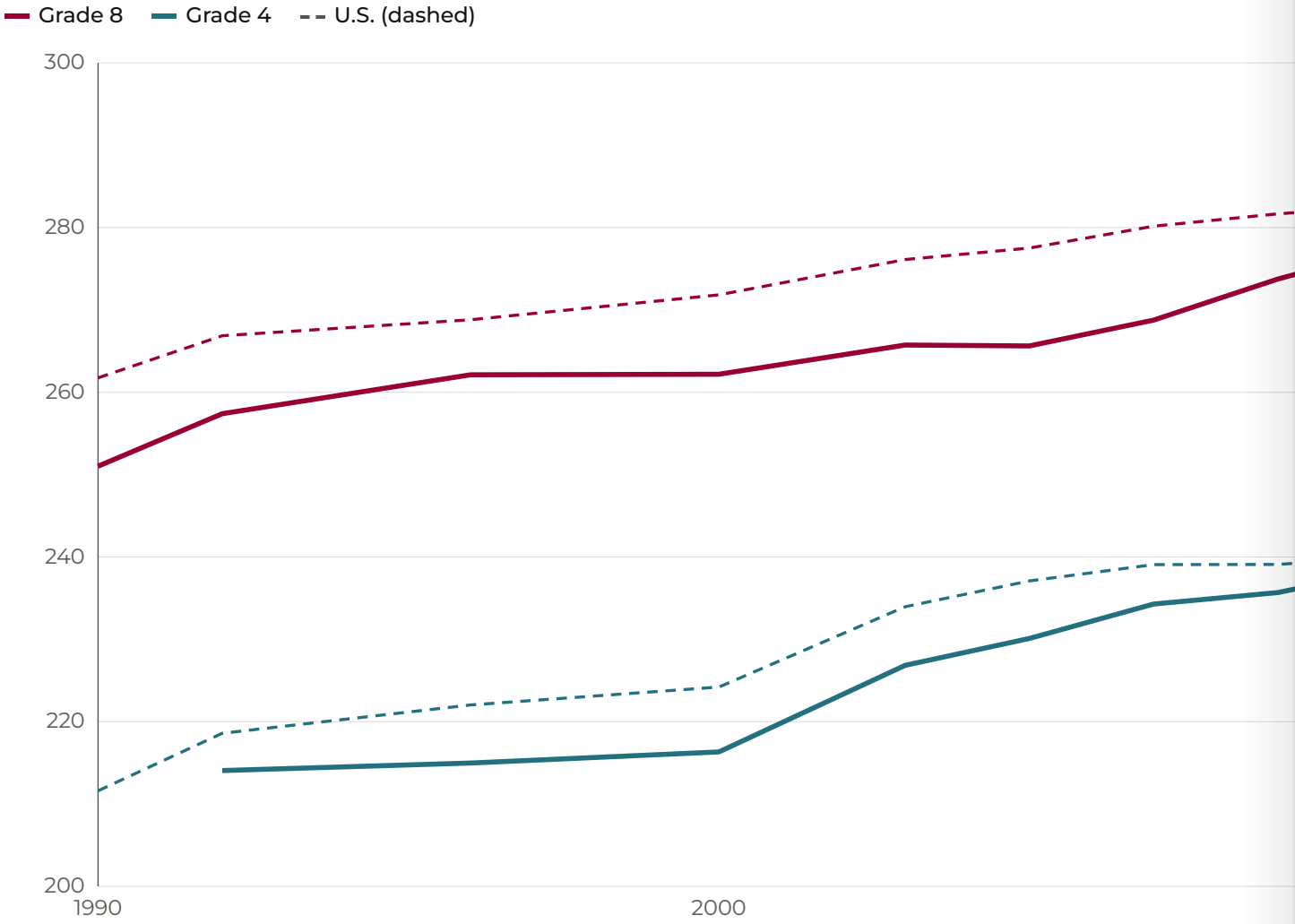
THE NUMBERS

- **Residents leaving for other states**: 3.98K in fall 2024, down 5.4% from 4.21K in fall 2022, and up 2.2% since fall 2016 (3.89K).
- **Residents staying in the state**: 6.26K in fall 2024, up 8.8% from 5.75K in fall 2022, and down 3.4% since fall 2016 (6.47K).
- **Largest destinations**: California (860), Oregon (578), Arizona (424).
- **Net migration per 100 resident first-time students**: −21 in 2024 (49th of 51 states), down 2 from −19 in 2022, and up 2 since 2016 (−24).

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

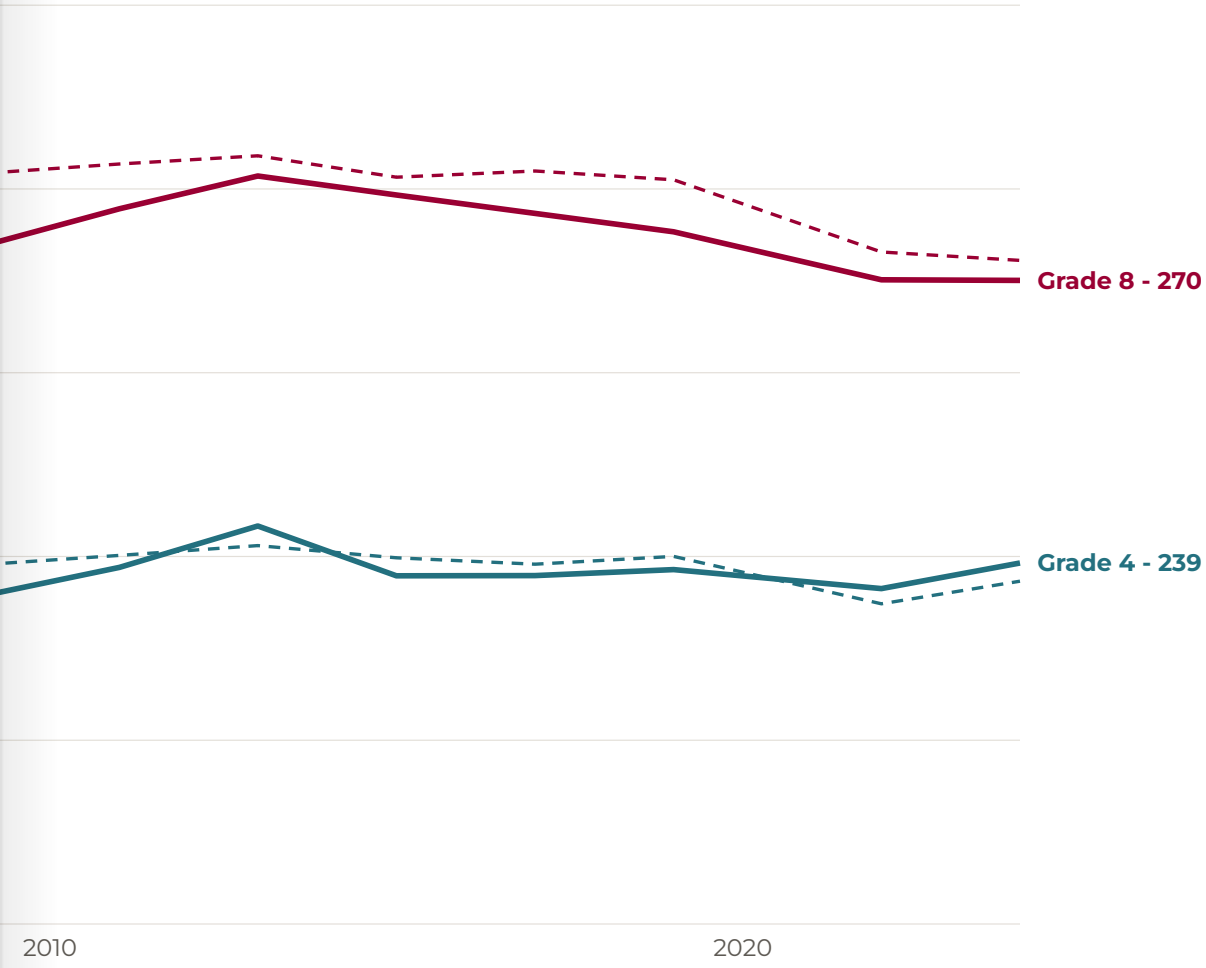
Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Hawaii's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, N

The talent pipeline starts in school. Hawaii's eighth graders averaged 270 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 30th of 51 among the states.

23% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.



lational Assessment of Educational Progress.

270

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **30th** of 51 · −9.3 since 2015

23%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **38th** of 51 · −6.9 pp since 2015

257

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **257** · **25th** of 51 · −0.1 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Figure 15 How Many of Hawaii's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Tem



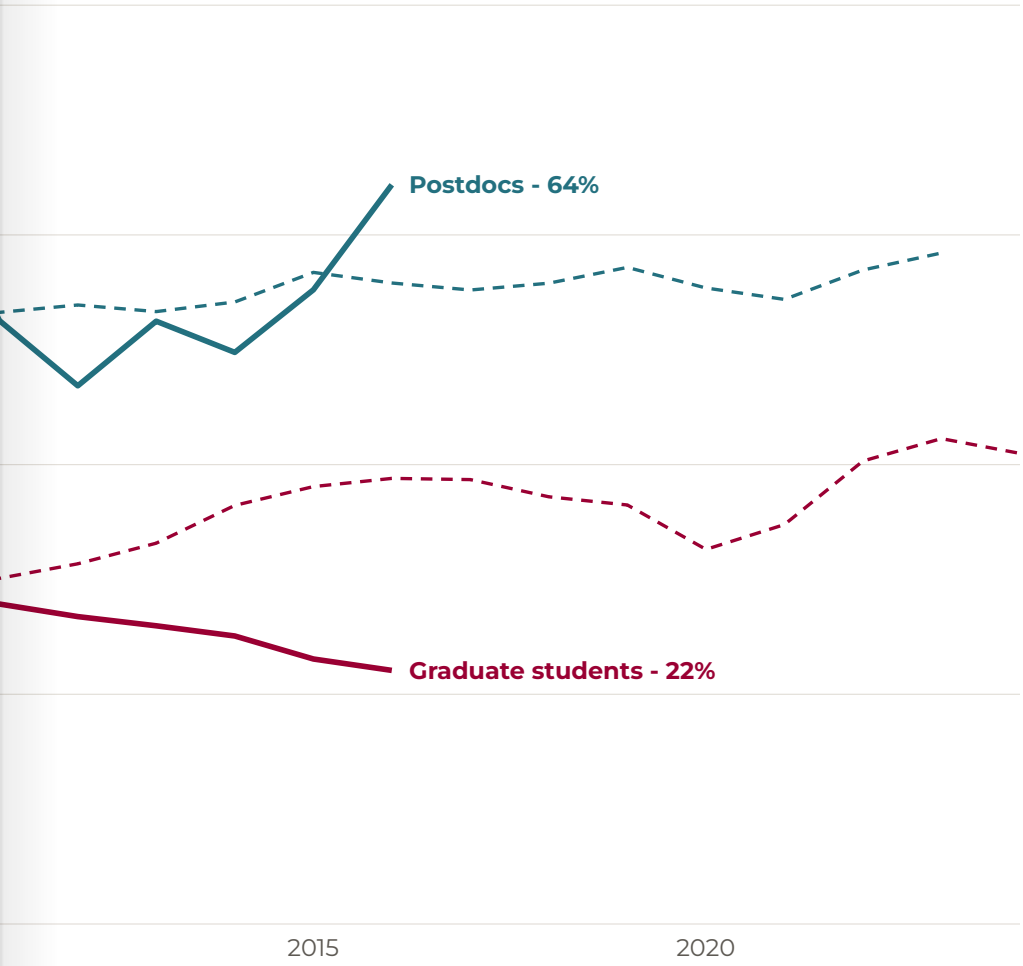
Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's sta
Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 22% of Hawaii's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 46th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 64% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 202 research doctorates in 2025, 0.3% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

porary Visas?



te; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate

22%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **46th** of 51 · −1.0 pp since 2015

64%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **6th** of 51 · +9.1 pp since 2015

202

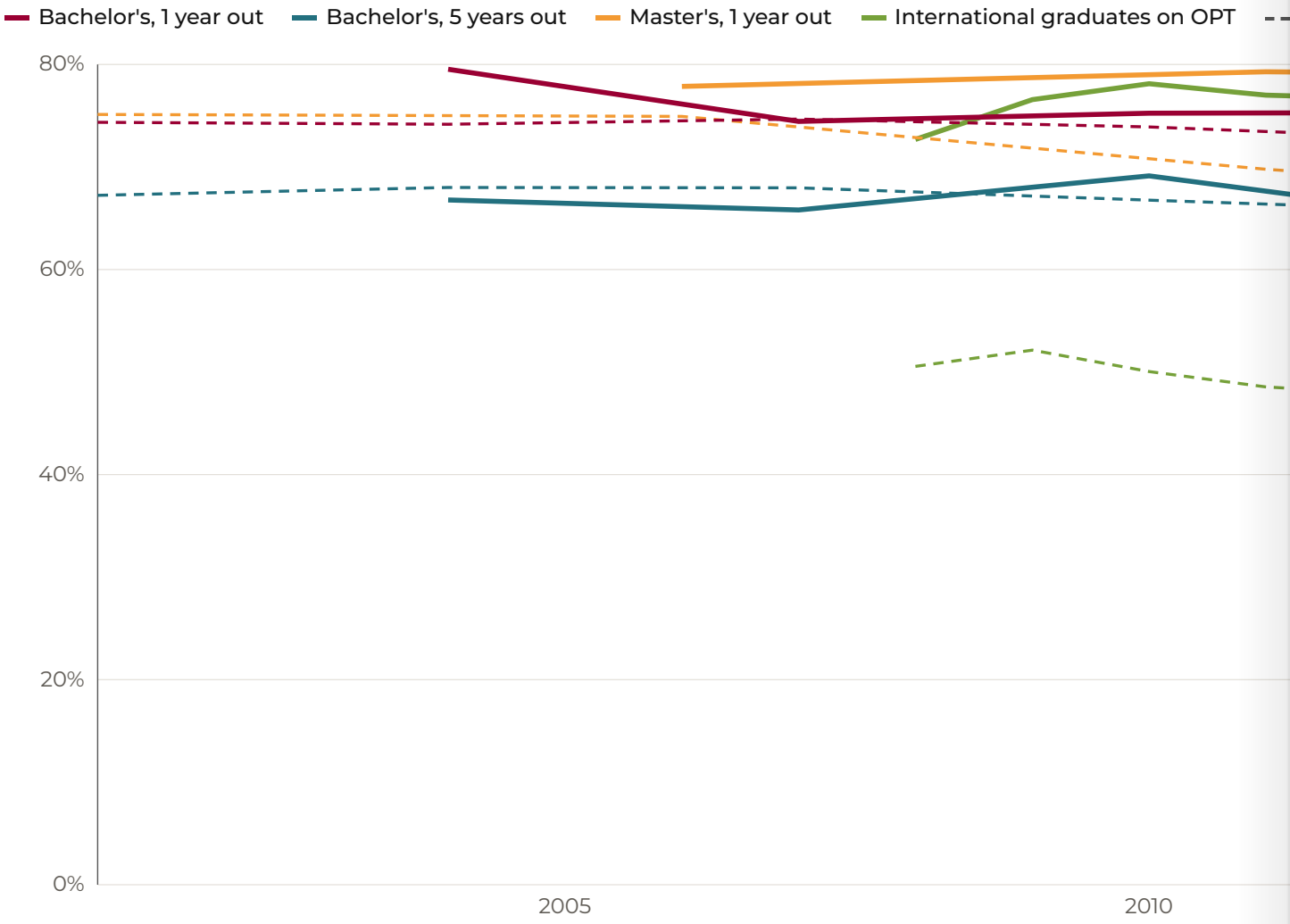
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

U.S. **59K** · **44th** of 51 · −16% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Figure 16 How Many of Hawaii's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?

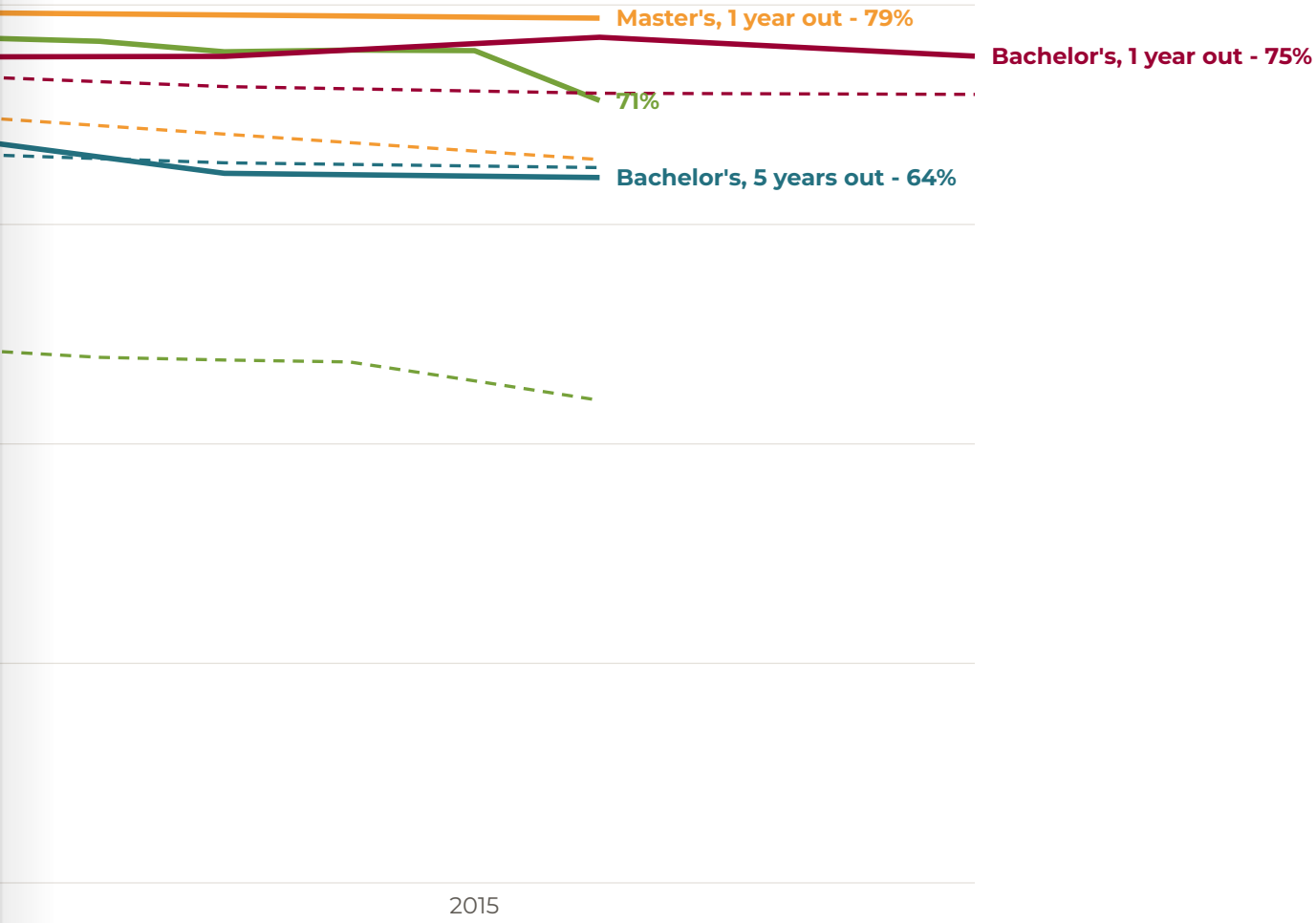


Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Burea
state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or particip

Of Hawaii's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 75% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 64%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 71% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). Through migration between states, the state lost 3.5 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

U.S. (dashed)



au, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the
pating states dashed.

75%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **8th** of 33 · −1.7 pp since 2016

71%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **2nd** of 51 · −4.5 pp since 2015

−3.5

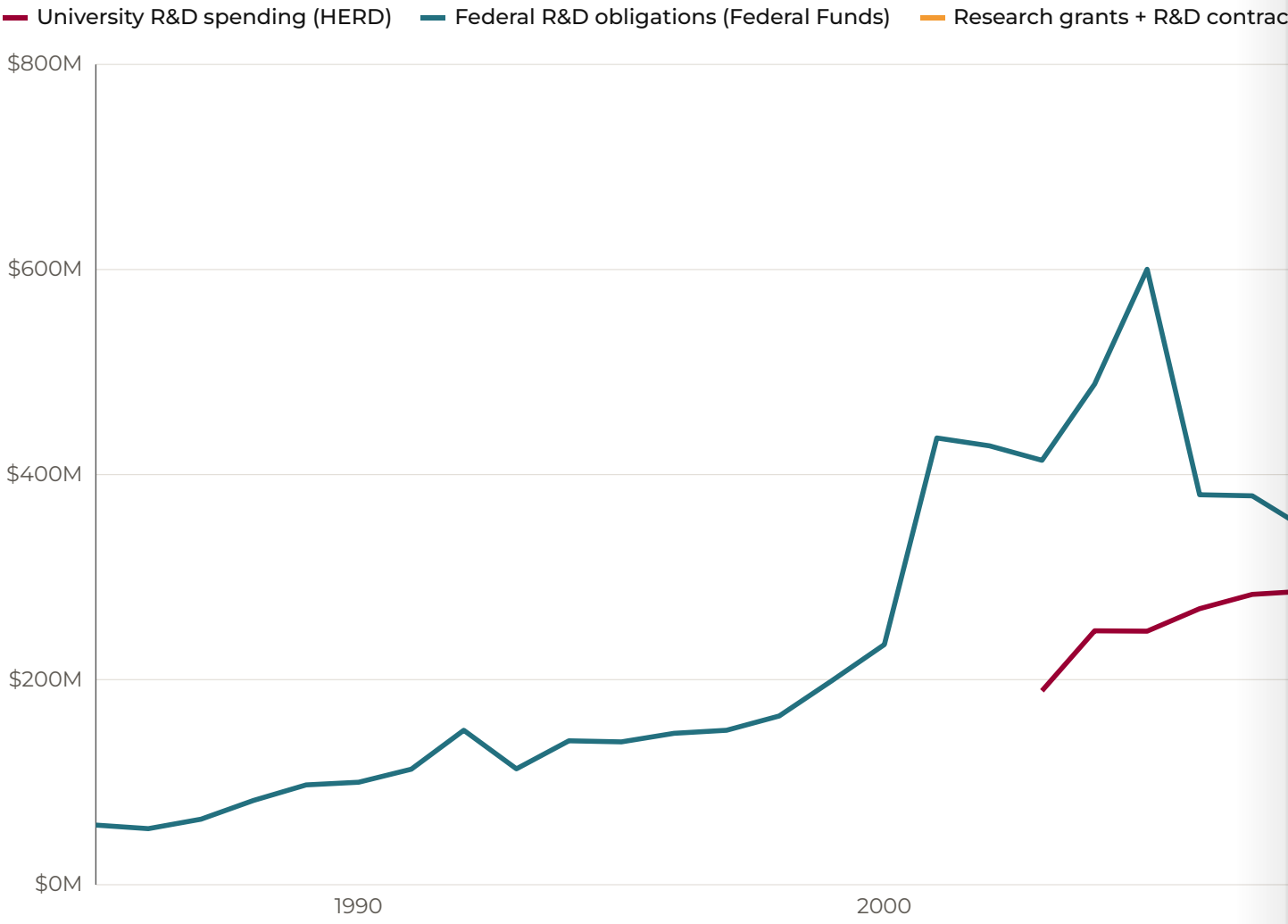
Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

· **38th** of 51 · +1.0 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Hawaii?

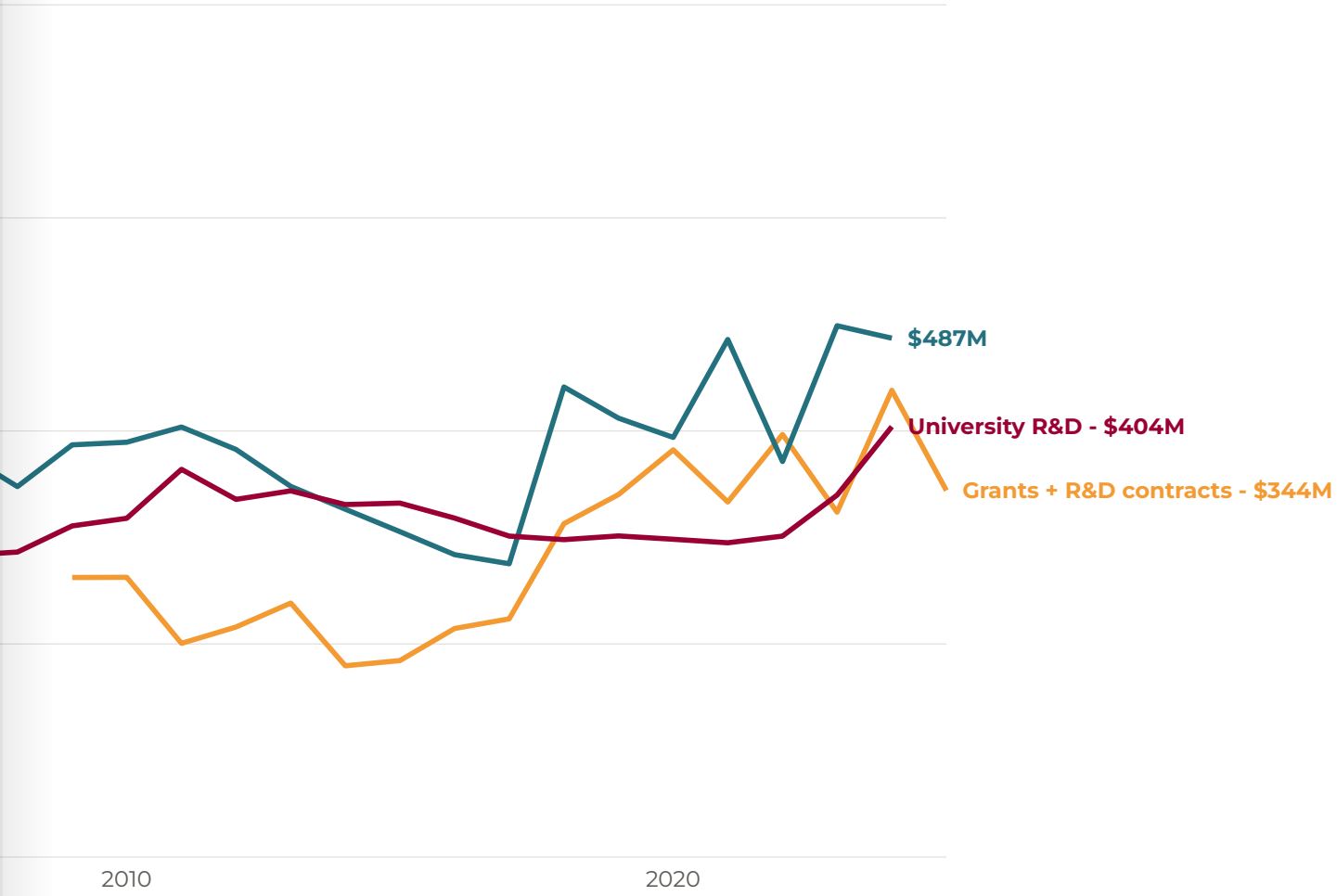


Millions of nominal dollars, fiscal years. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Developm
Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D co

Hawaii's universities spent $404M on research and development in FY2024, 42nd of 51 among the states; 65% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $487M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

ts (USAspending)



ent Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, ntracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

$404M

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **42nd** of 51 · +22% since 2015

65%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **6th** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2015

$487M

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

U.S. **$193B** · **38th** of 51 · +59% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Hawaii Gene

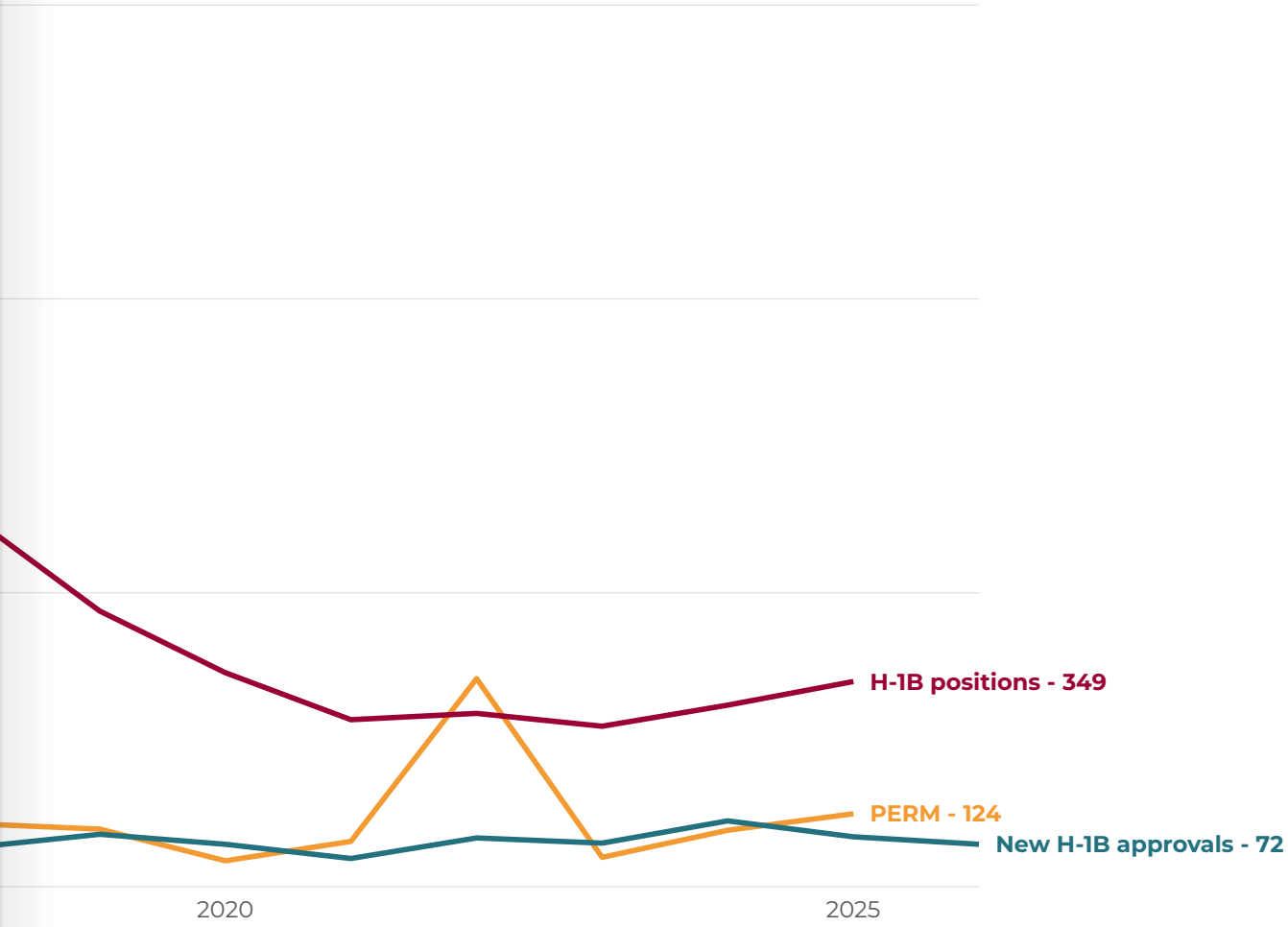


Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal
from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 349 H-1B positions at Hawaii worksites in FY2025, 49th of 51 among the states. A labor certification comes before the petition, so this overstates hires; USCIS approved 72 new H-1B petitions from employers in the state in FY2026.

DOL certified 124 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 22% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

erate?



year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data

349

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **49th** of 51 · −56% since 2015

124

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

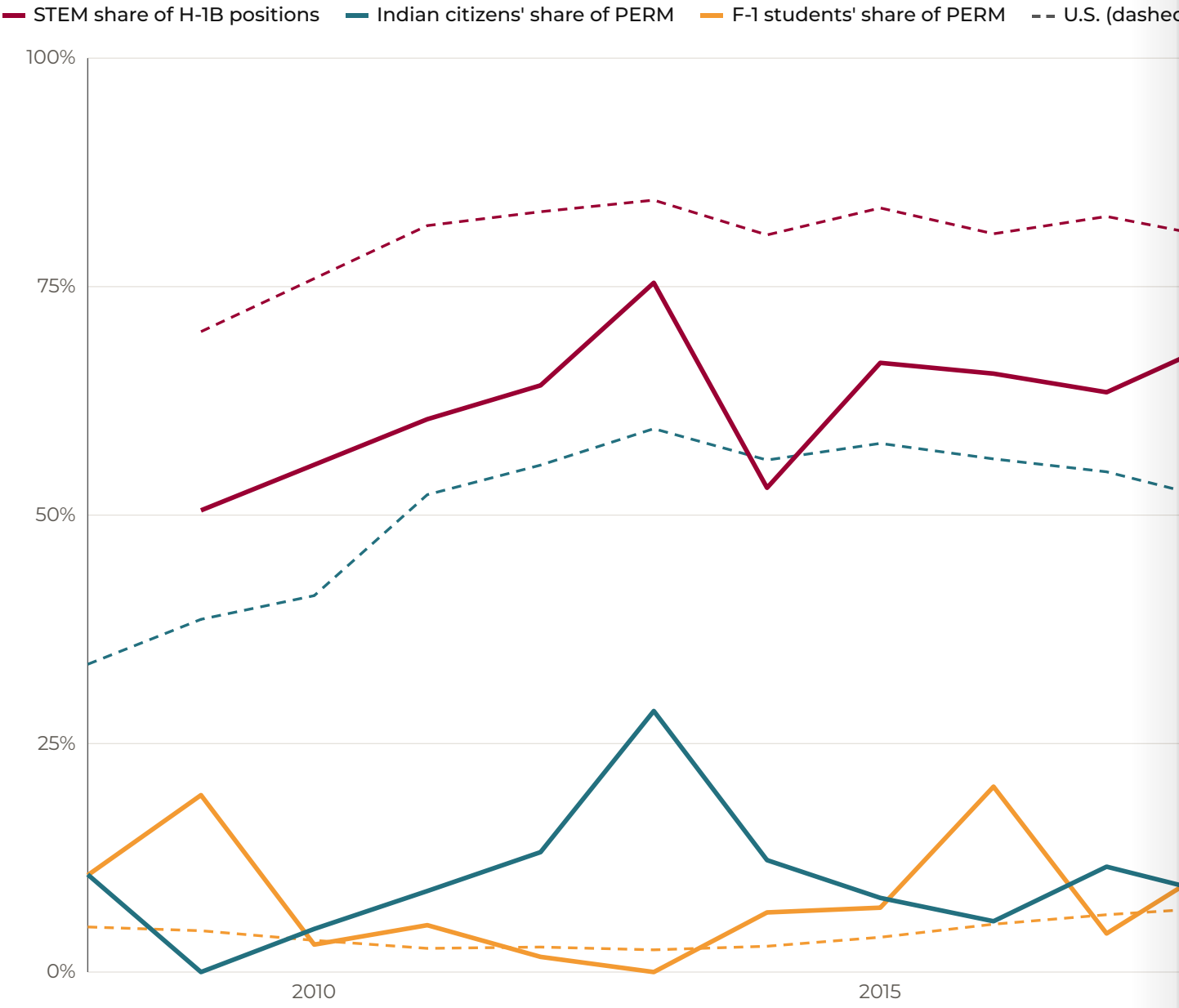
U.S. **138K** · **46th** of 51 · +68% since 2015

22%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **2nd** of 51 · +15.2 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds Hawaii's Skilled-Visa Jobs?

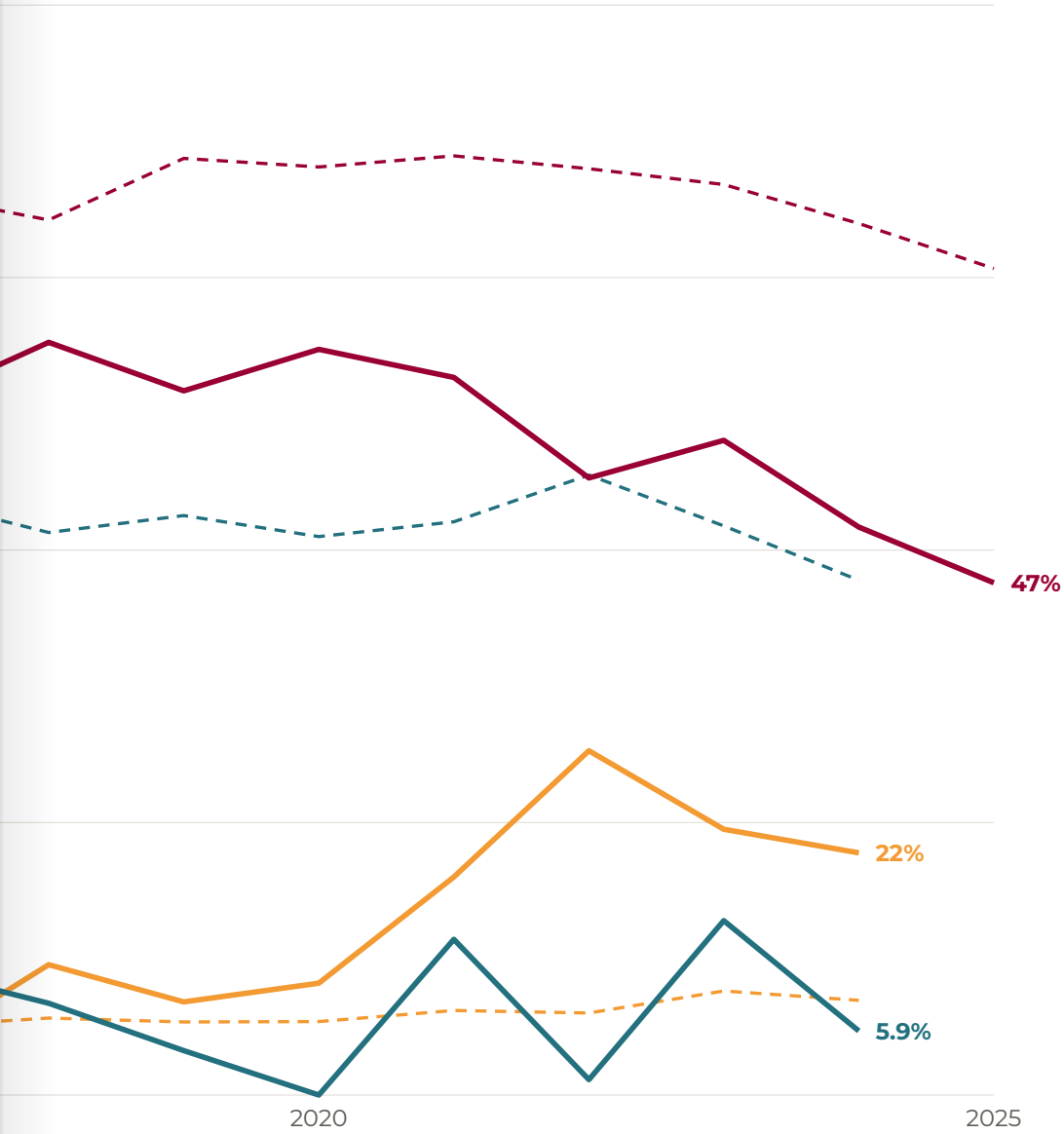


State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from D

47% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 5.9% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

d)



OL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

47%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **41st** of 51 · −19.7 pp since 2015

5.9%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **47th** of 51 · −2.2 pp since 2015

$90.7K

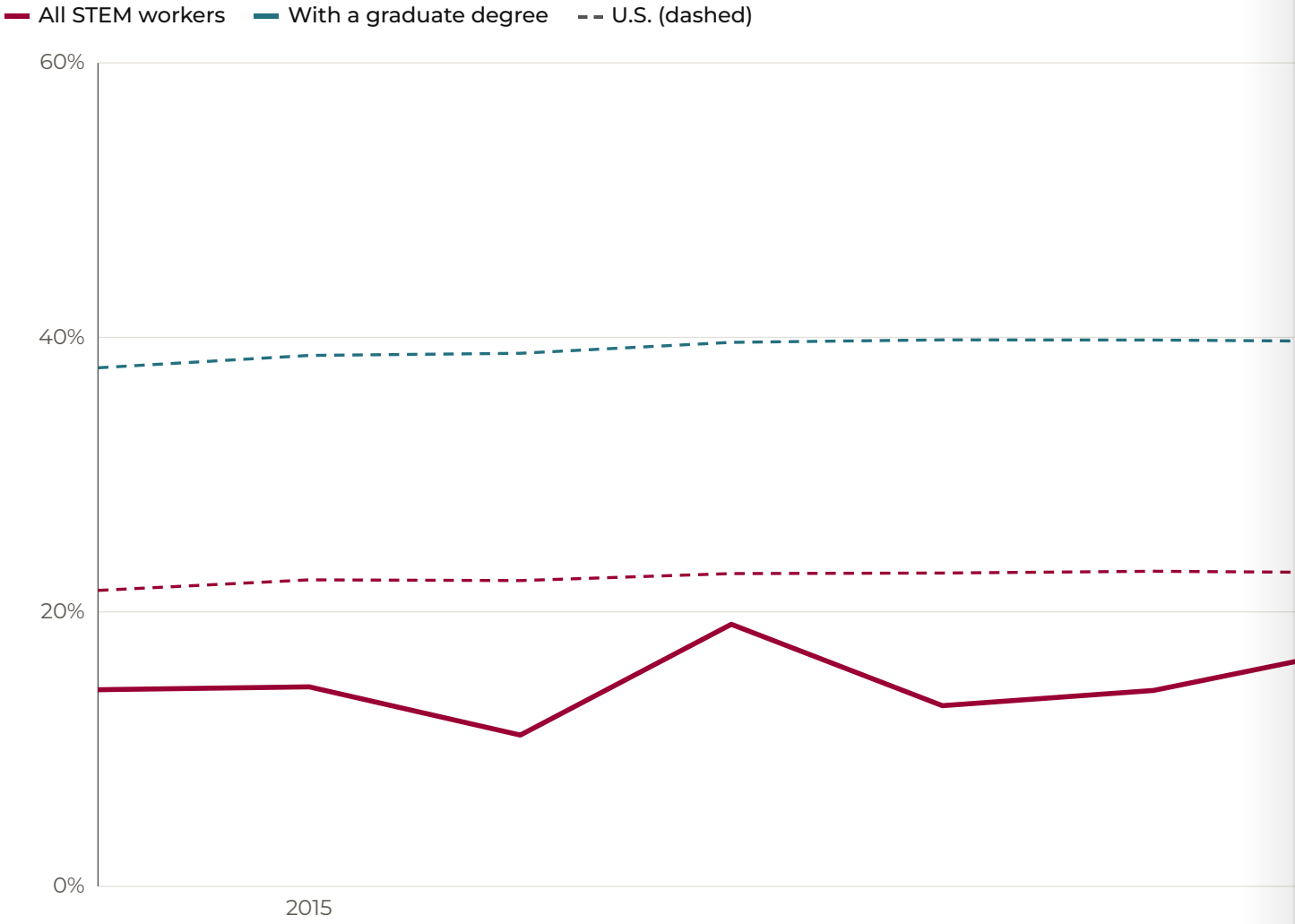
Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

U.S. **$119K** · **40th** of 51 · +39% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

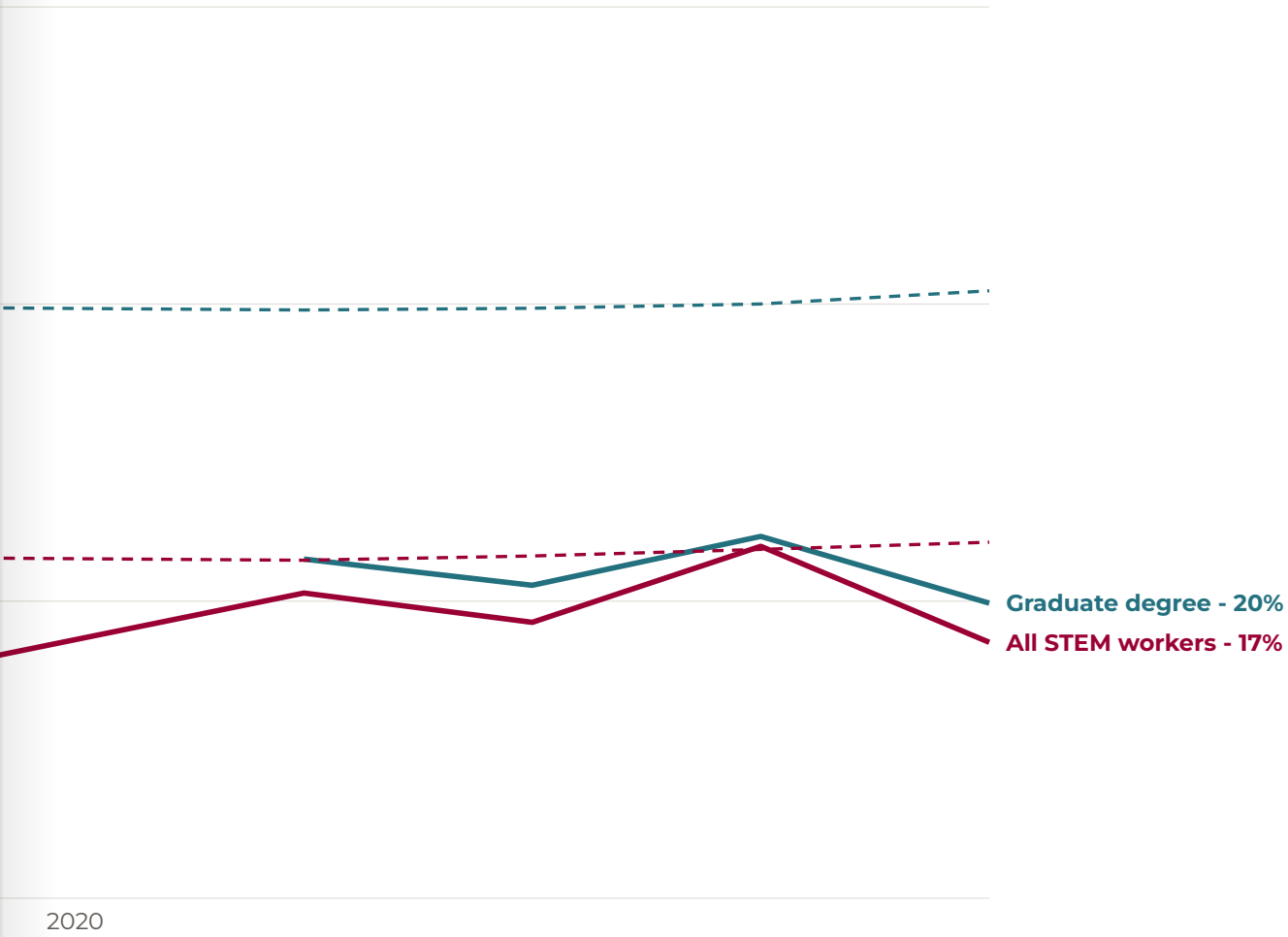
Figure 20 How Much of Hawaii's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resti
Community Survey.

In 2024, 17% of the people working in STEM occupations in Hawaii were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 19th of 51).

The share rises with education: 20% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 4.9% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.



ng on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American

17%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **19th** of 51 · +2.7 pp since 2015

20%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **38th** of 44 · −3.0 pp since 2021

4.9%

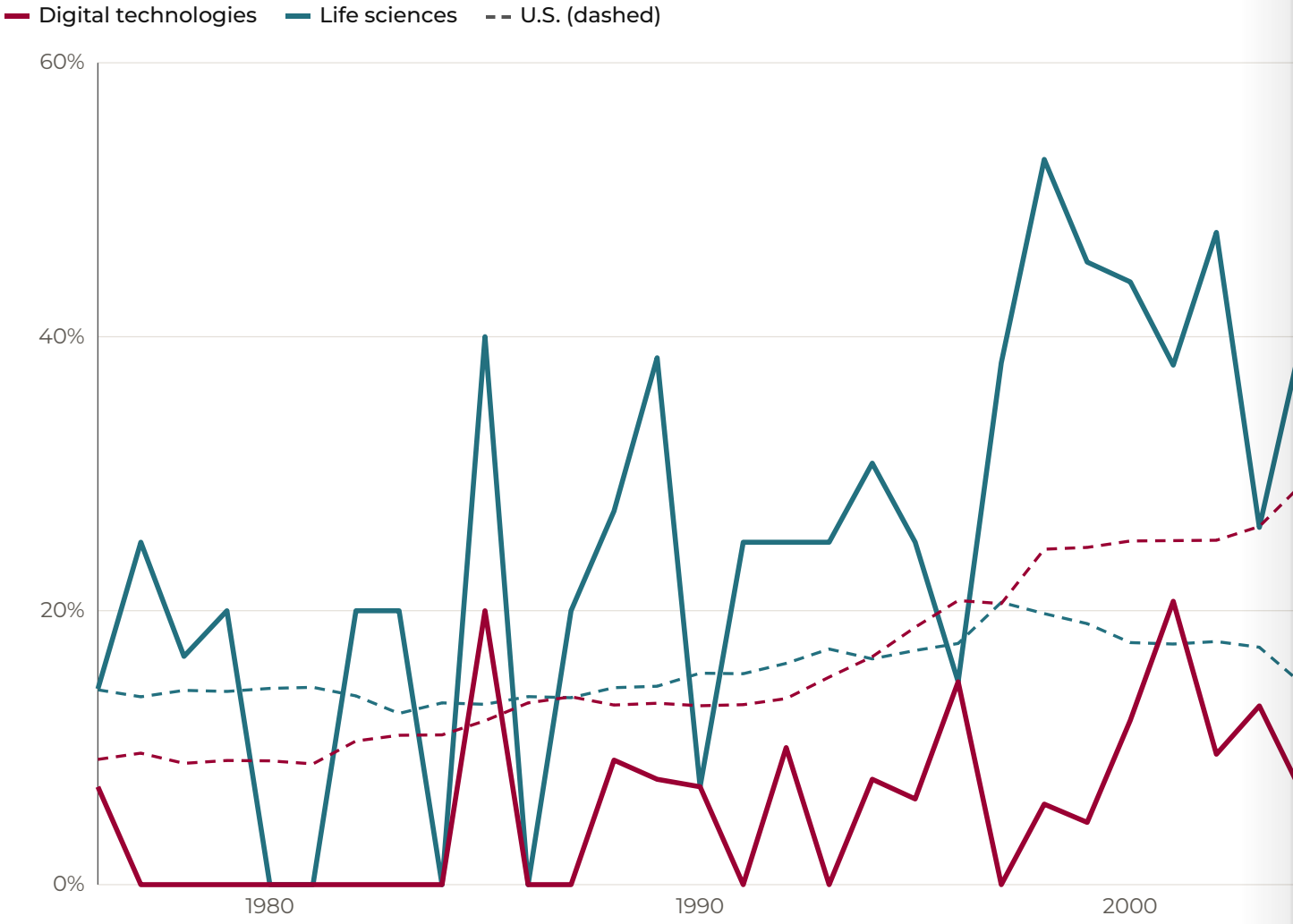
Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **11%** · **40th** of 51 · +0.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

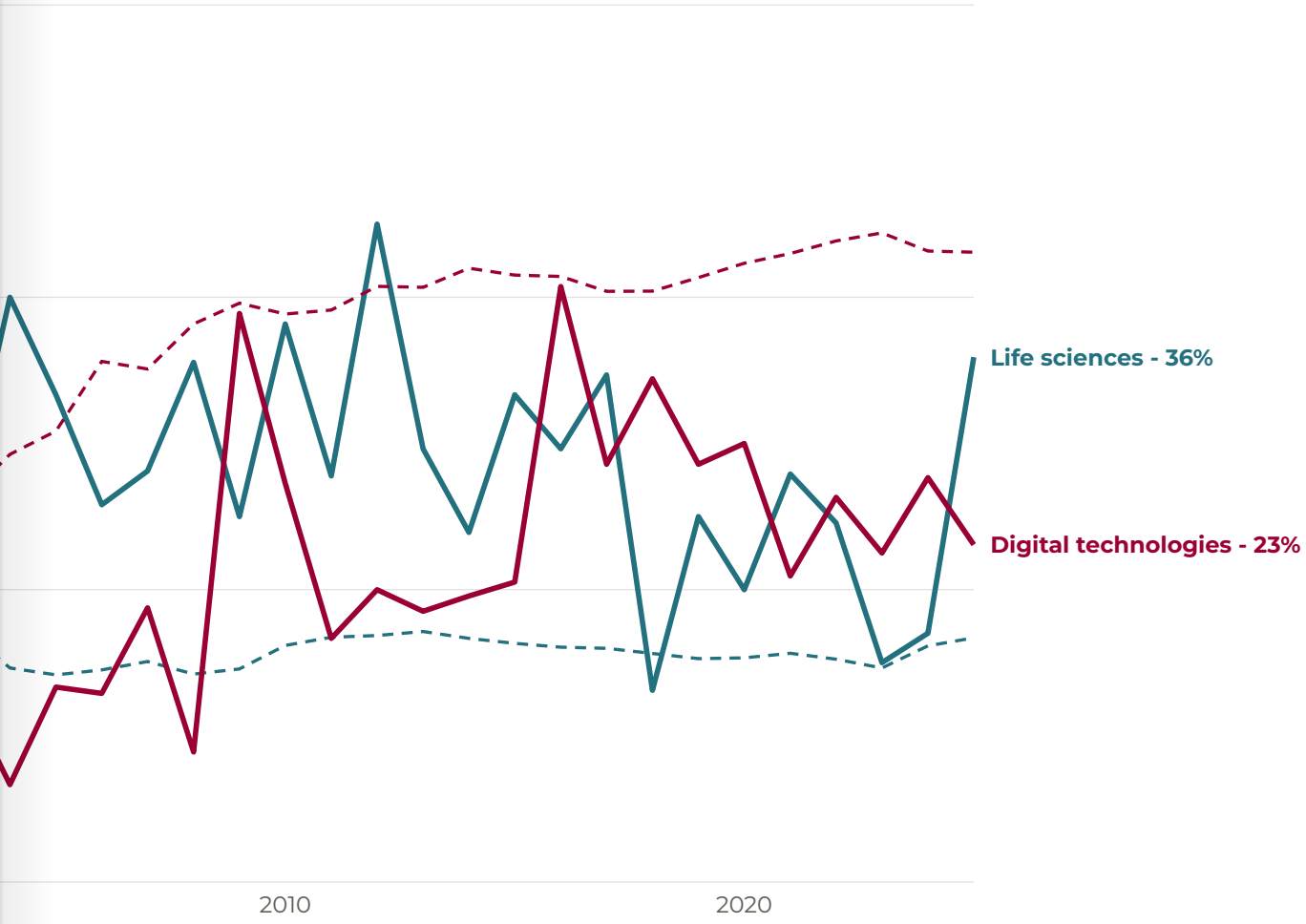
Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Hawaii Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed

Organizations and people in Hawaii were granted 38 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.0% of all patents with a U.S. owner (49th of 51).

23% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 36% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).



d. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

38

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **49th** of 51 · +1.3% since 2015

23%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **25th** of 51 · +2.6 pp since 2015

36%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

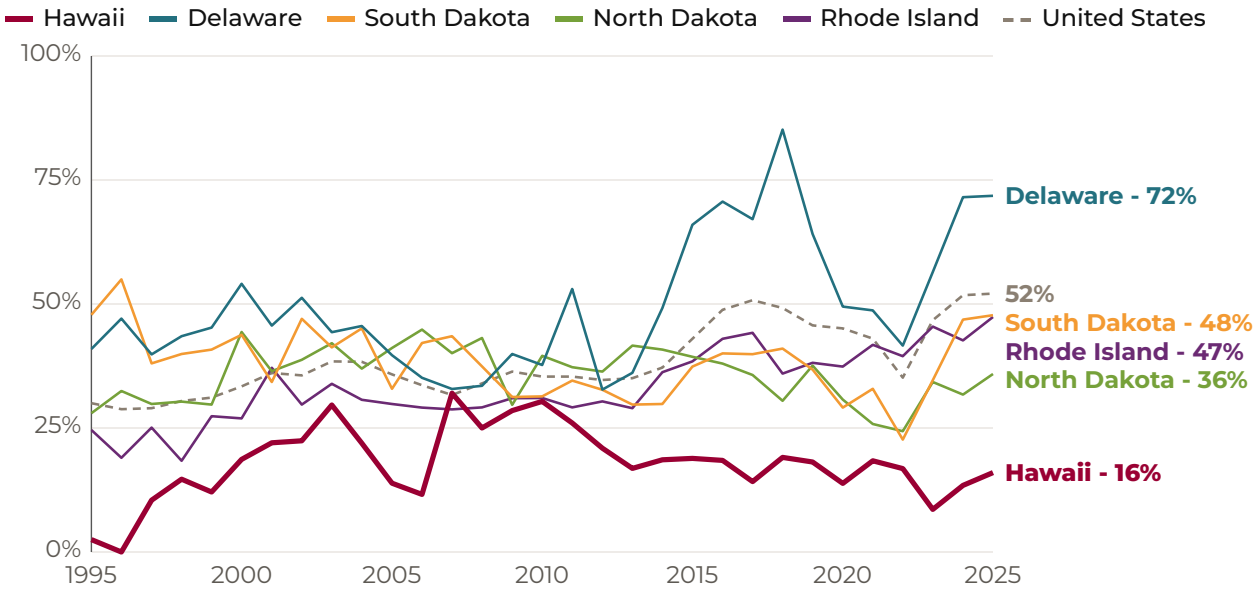
U.S. **17%** · **7th** of 51 · +2.6 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

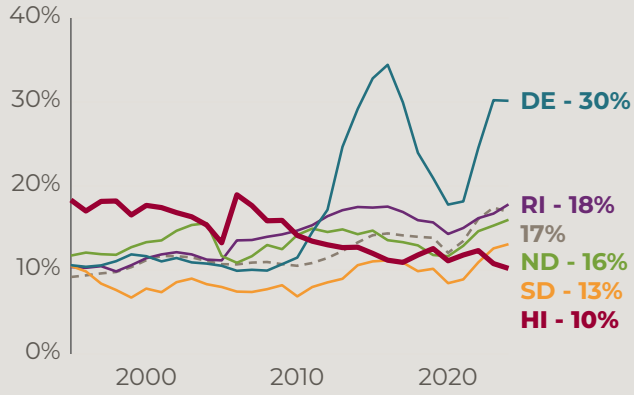
The four states closest in size are Delaware, South Dakota, North Dakota, Rhode Island. Hawaii ranks 5th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Delaware is the most dependent at 72%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Hawaii and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



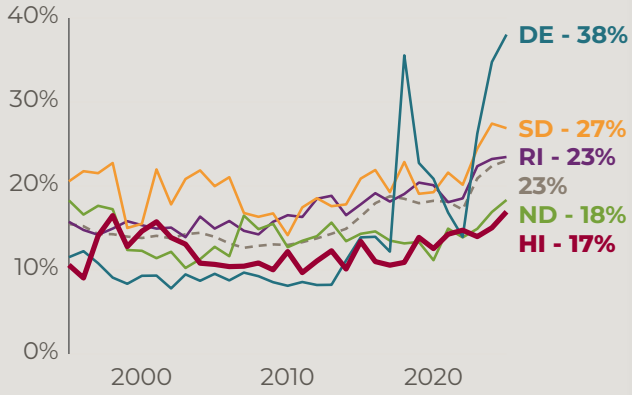
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



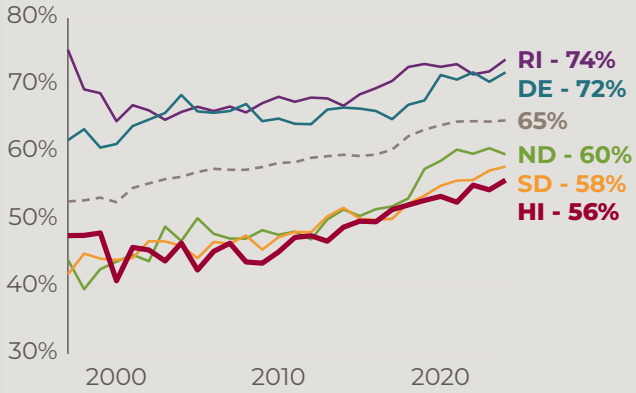
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Table 3 How Does Hawaii Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	HI	DE	SD	ND	RI	U.S.
Students enrolled	**61.4K**	57.8K	54.2K	53.5K	75.6K	19.7M
Graduate share of students	**12%**	18%	17%	15%	16%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's	**20%**	22%	26%	21%	23%	24%
STEM share of master's	**17%**	38%	27%	18%	23%	23%
International STEM master's	**40**	1.03K	277	122	406	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's	**0.0%**	0.9%	0.2%	0.1%	0.3%	100%
Int. share of STEM master's	**16%**	72%	48%	36%	47%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates	**35%**	52%	40%	57%	38%	43%
Int. share of grad students	**10%**	30%	13%	16%	18%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment	**6.2%**	3.5%	3.4%	2.7%	5.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate	**56%**	72%	58%	60%	74%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year	**$10.4K**	$11.8K	$9.25K	$9.87K	$15.5K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student	**$16.9K**	$8.9K	$9.61K	$11.9K	$8.67K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary	**$110K**	$123K	$79.3K	$82.6K	$120K	$106K
First-time students from in state	**73%**	58%	58%	50%	41%	–
Net migration per 100 residents	**−21**	+7	+22	+42	+58	–

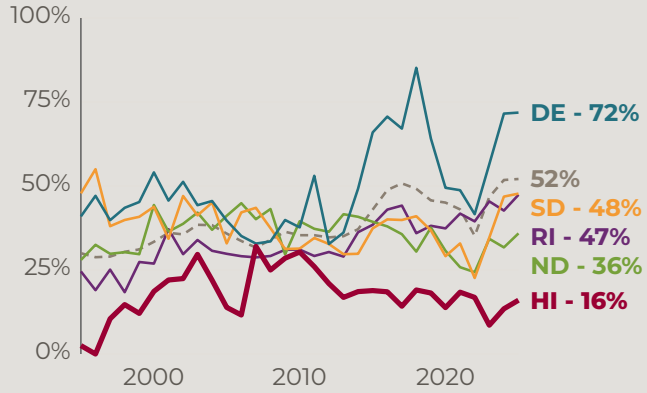
Latest year for each measure. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM master's

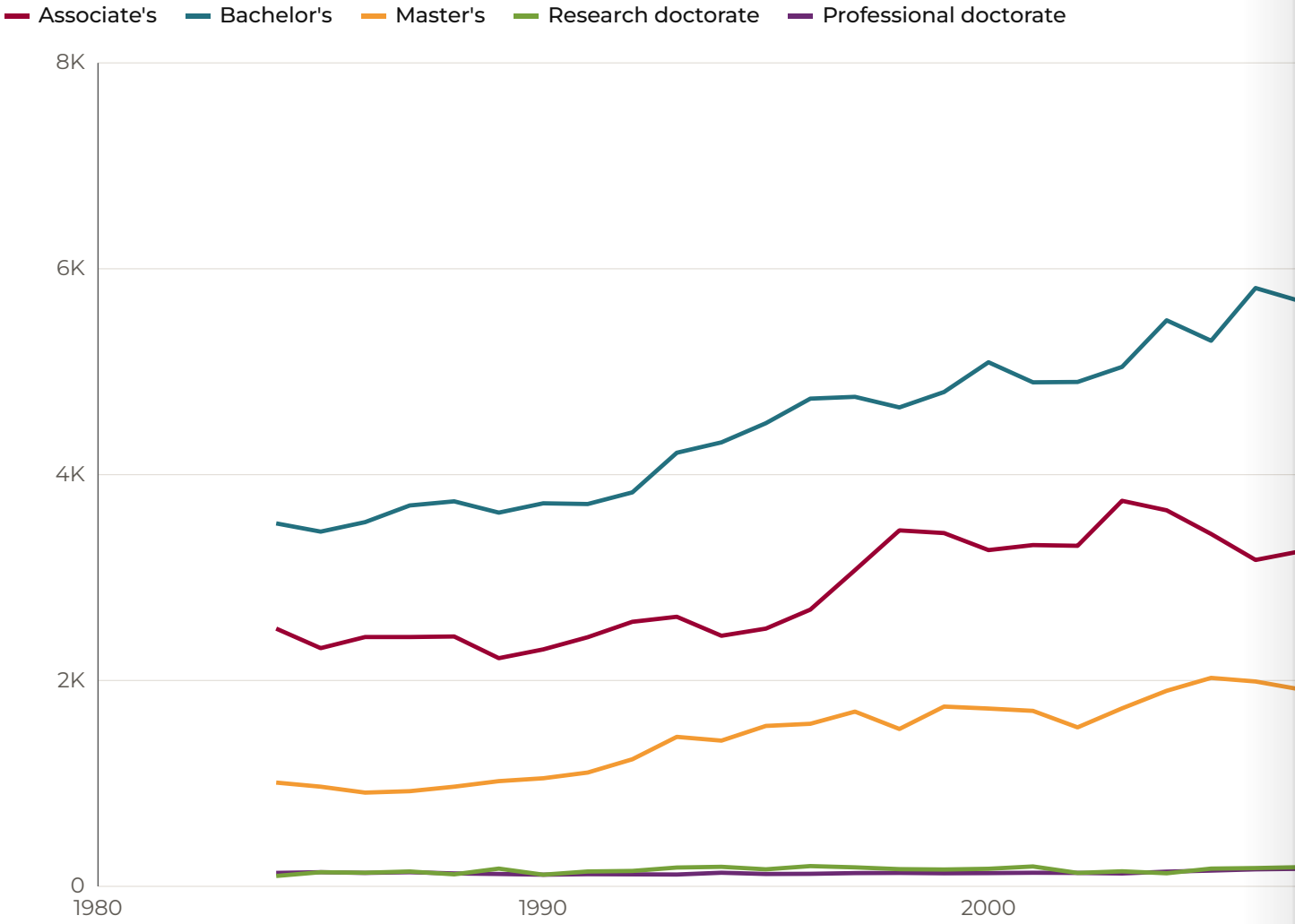


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

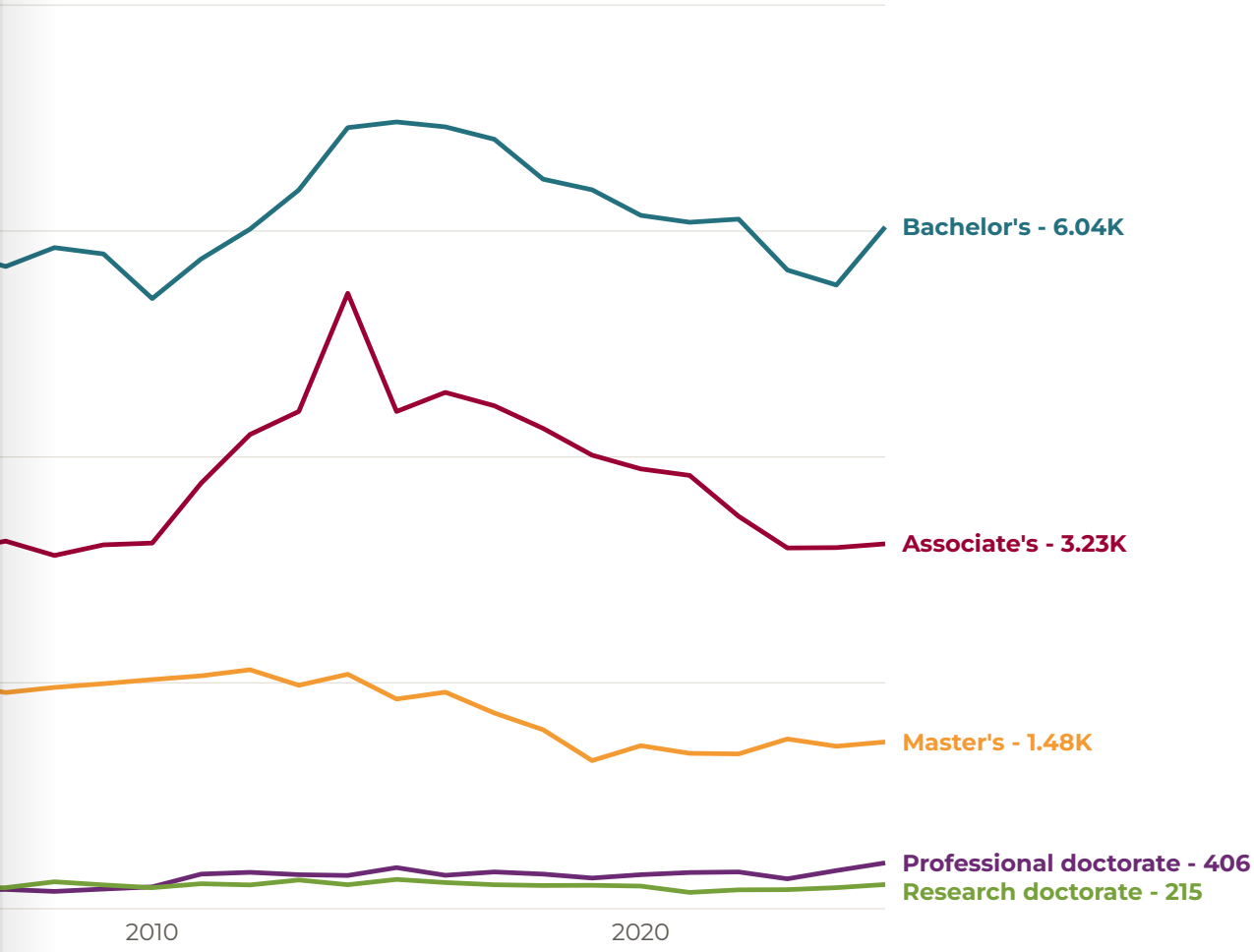
Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Hawaii Award?



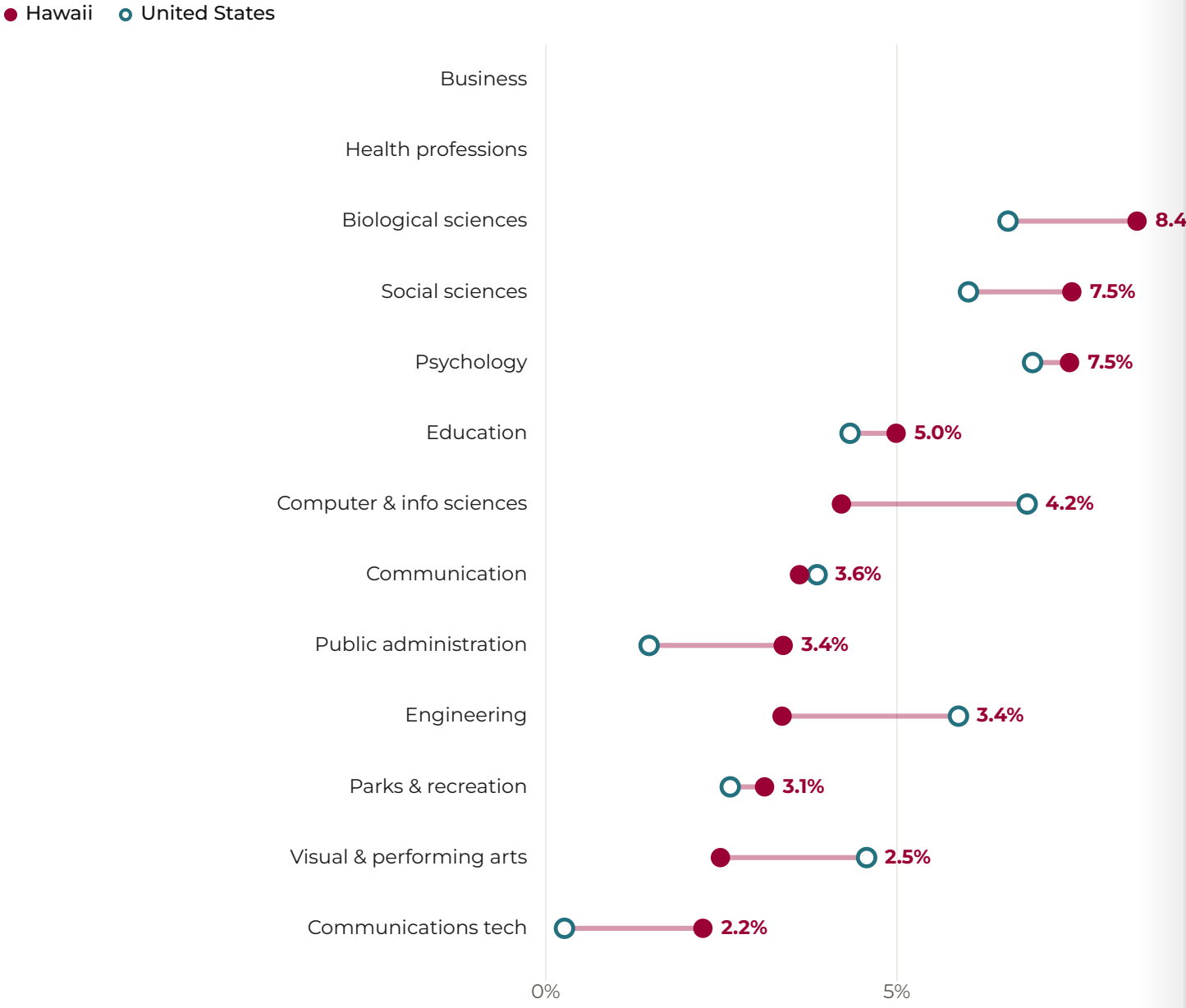
Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Hawaii's institutions awarded 3.23K associate's degrees, 6.04K bachelor's degrees, 1.48K master's degrees, 215 research doctorate degrees, 406 professional doctorate degrees.



Since 2015: associate's down 27%; bachelor's down 13%; master's down 20%; research doctorate down 17%; professional doctorate up 12%. The state awards 11.2 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

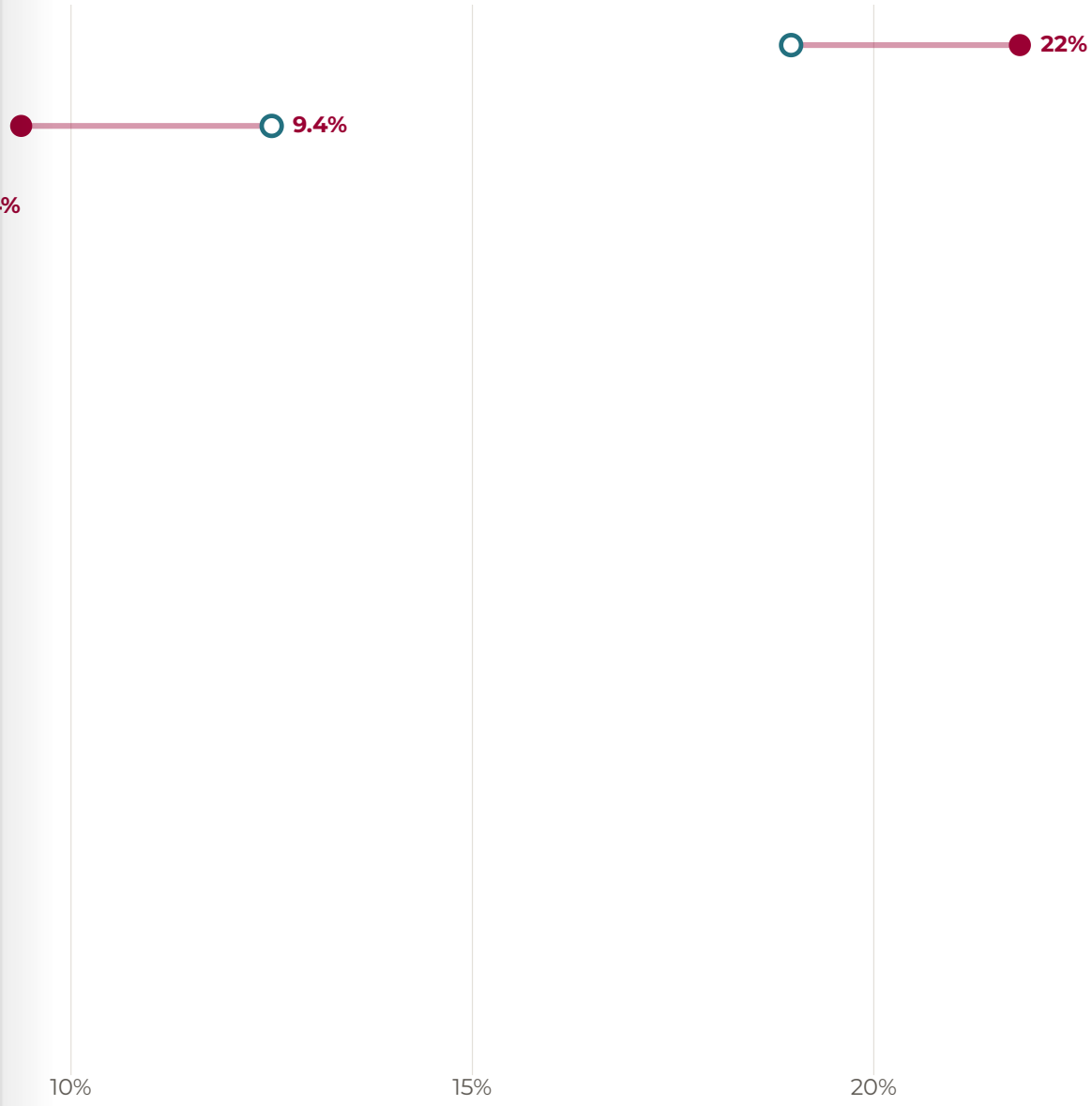
Figure 28 What Do Hawaii's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Hawaii's largest bachelor's fields are business (22%; U.S. 19%), health professions (9.4%; U.S. 13%), biological sciences (8.4%; U.S. 6.6%).

Relative to the nation, Hawaii's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in communications tech (8.42× the U.S. share), languages (3.01× the U.S. share), public administration (2.30× the U.S. share).



4.2%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **34th** of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2015

3.4%

Bachelor's in engineering, 2025

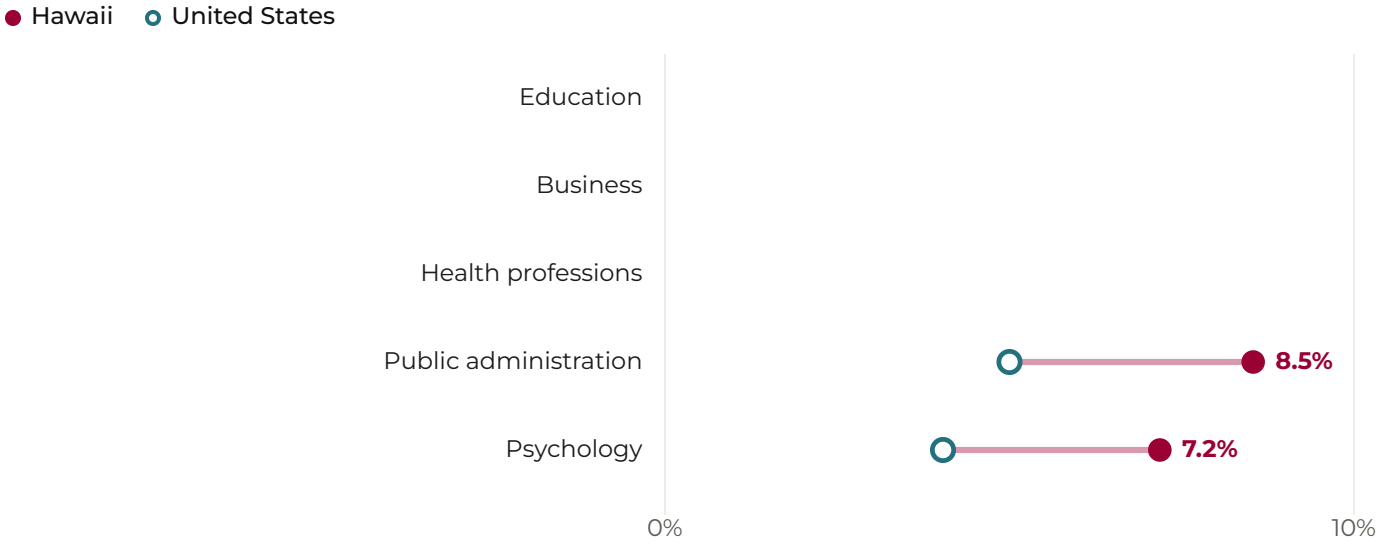
U.S. **6.8%** · **49th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

22%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **10th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

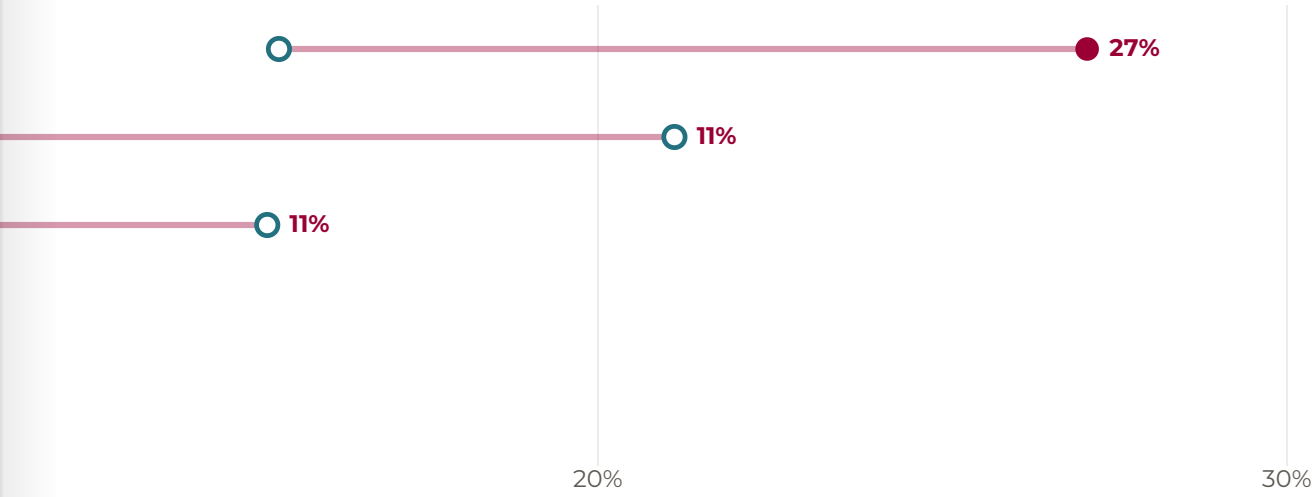
Figure 29 What Do Hawaii's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Hawaii's largest master's fields are education (27%; U.S. 15%), business (11%; U.S. 21%), health professions (11%; U.S. 15%).

International students earn 8.9% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 17% of them.



17%

STEM share of master's, 2025

U.S. **23%** · **35th** of 51 · +3.5 pp since 2015

8.9%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

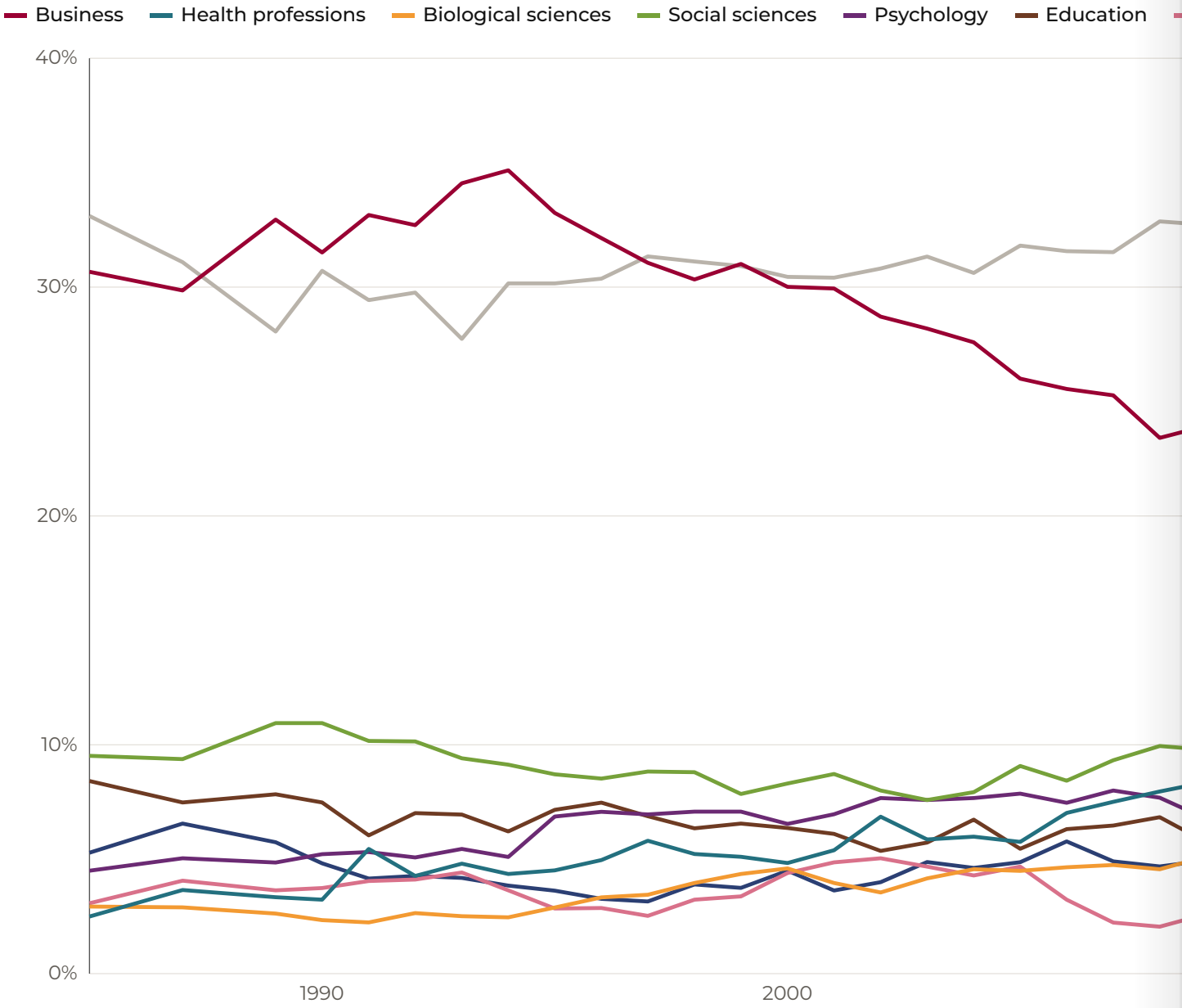
U.S. **22%** · **41st** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

20%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

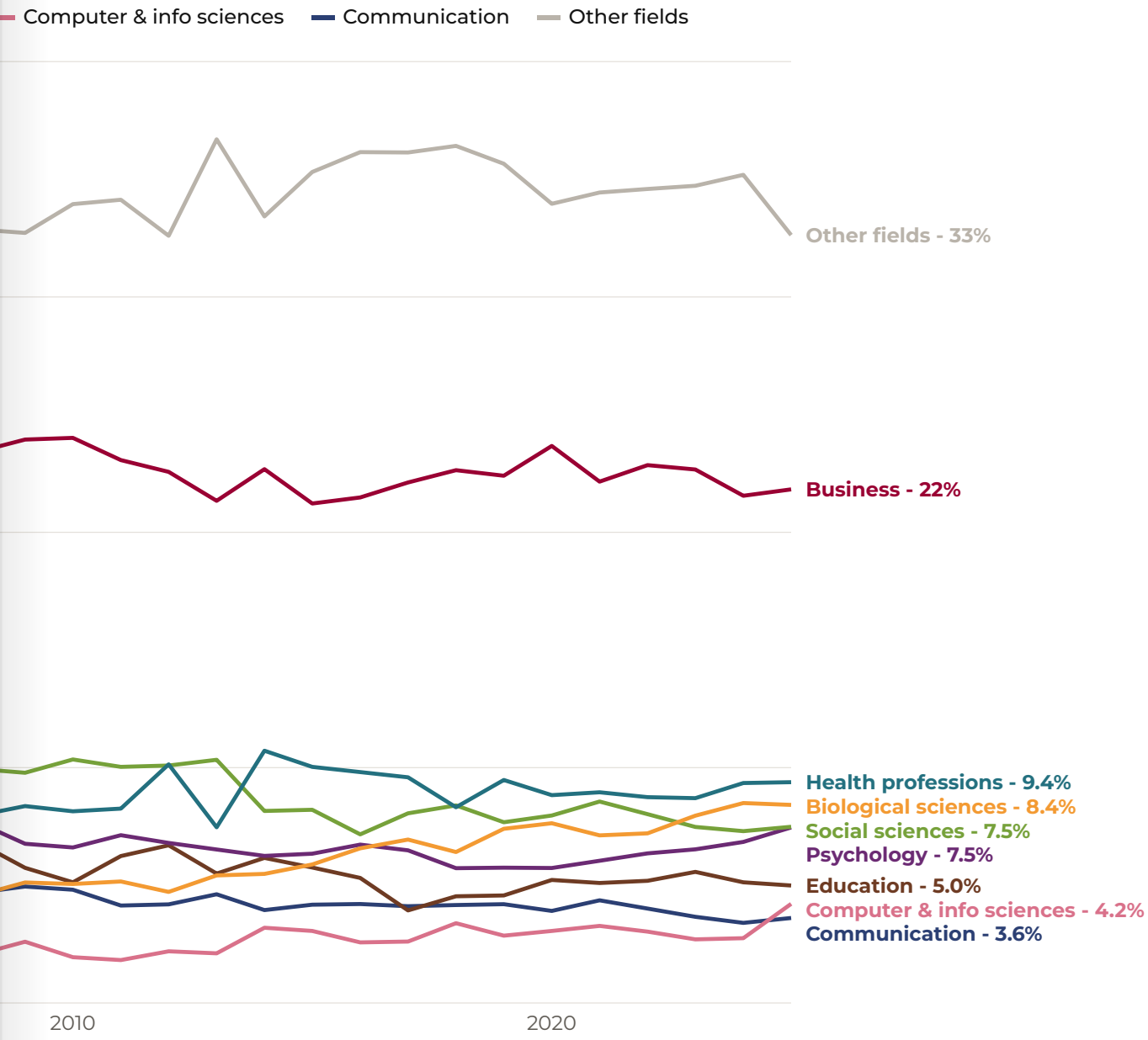
U.S. **65%** · **44th** of 47 · −6.5 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has Hawaii's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, biological sciences has gained the most ground, 2.5 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while education lost the most (0.8 points).



The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

Table 4 Where Is Hawaii Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Communications tech	**8.42**	2.2%	0.3%	135
Languages	**3.01**	1.7%	0.6%	105
Public administration	**2.30**	3.4%	1.5%	204
Biological sciences	**1.28**	8.4%	6.6%	508
Social sciences	**1.25**	7.5%	6.0%	452
Parks & recreation	**1.19**	3.1%	2.6%	188
Education	**1.15**	5.0%	4.3%	301
Business	**1.15**	22%	19%	1.32K
Liberal arts	**1.13**	2.1%	1.8%	124
Psychology	**1.08**	7.5%	6.9%	450

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The location quotient divides a field's share of Hawaii's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the ten fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

THE NUMBERS

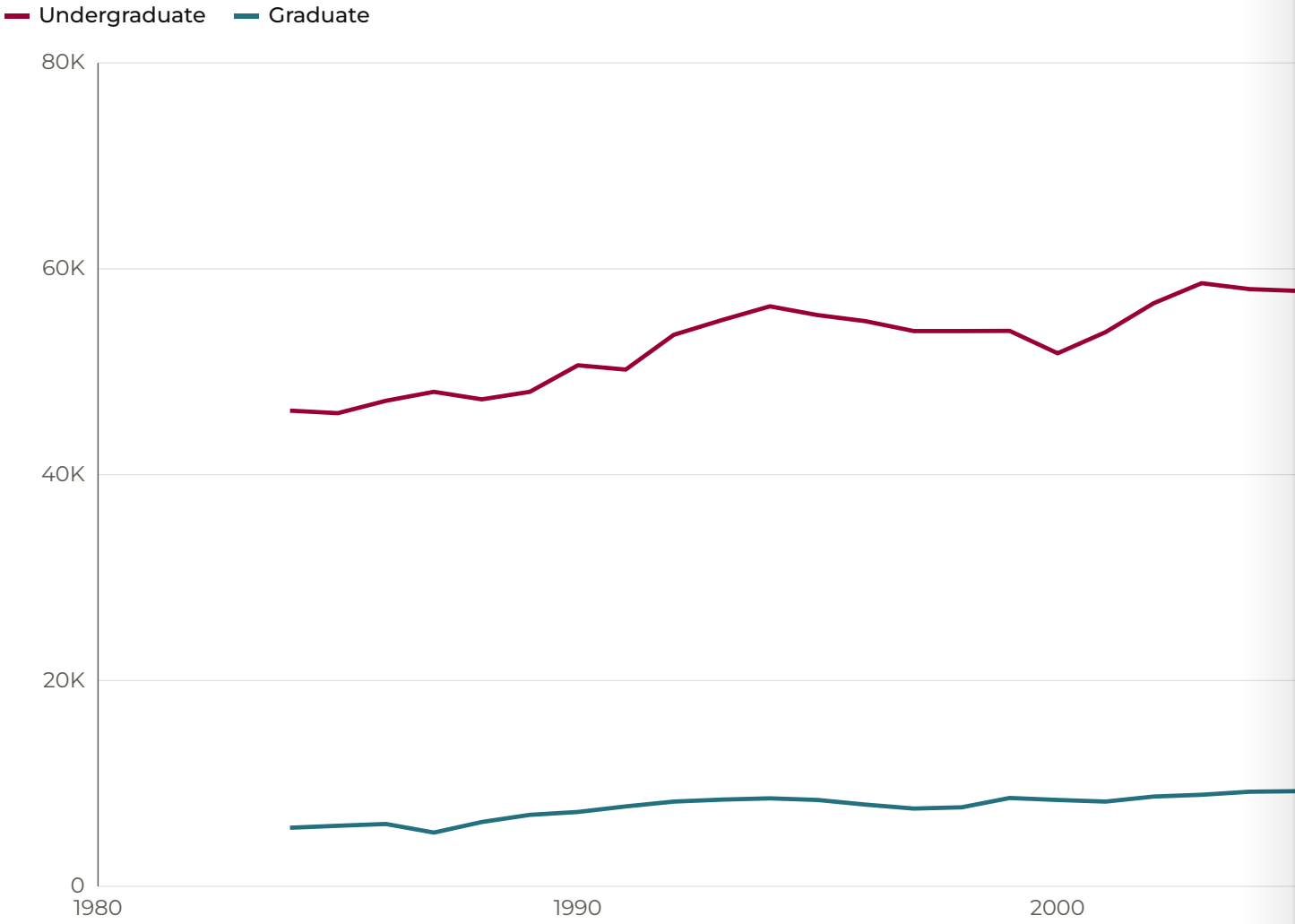
- **Highest location quotients**: communications tech 8.42 (2.2% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 0.3%); languages 3.01 (1.7% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 0.6%); public administration 2.30 (3.4% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 1.5%).
- **STEM share of bachelor's degrees**: 20% in 2025 (U.S. 24%; 42nd of 51 states), up 0.1 points from 20% in 2024, and up 4.4 points since 2015 (16%).
- **Computer and information sciences**: 4.2% in 2025 (U.S. 6.9%; 34th of 51 states), up 1.5 points from 2.8% in 2024, and up 1.2 points since 2015 (3.1%).
- **Engineering**: 3.4% in 2025 (U.S. 6.8%; 49th of 51 states), down 0.9 points from 4.2% in 2024, and unchanged since 2015 (3.4%).

This page intentionally left blank.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

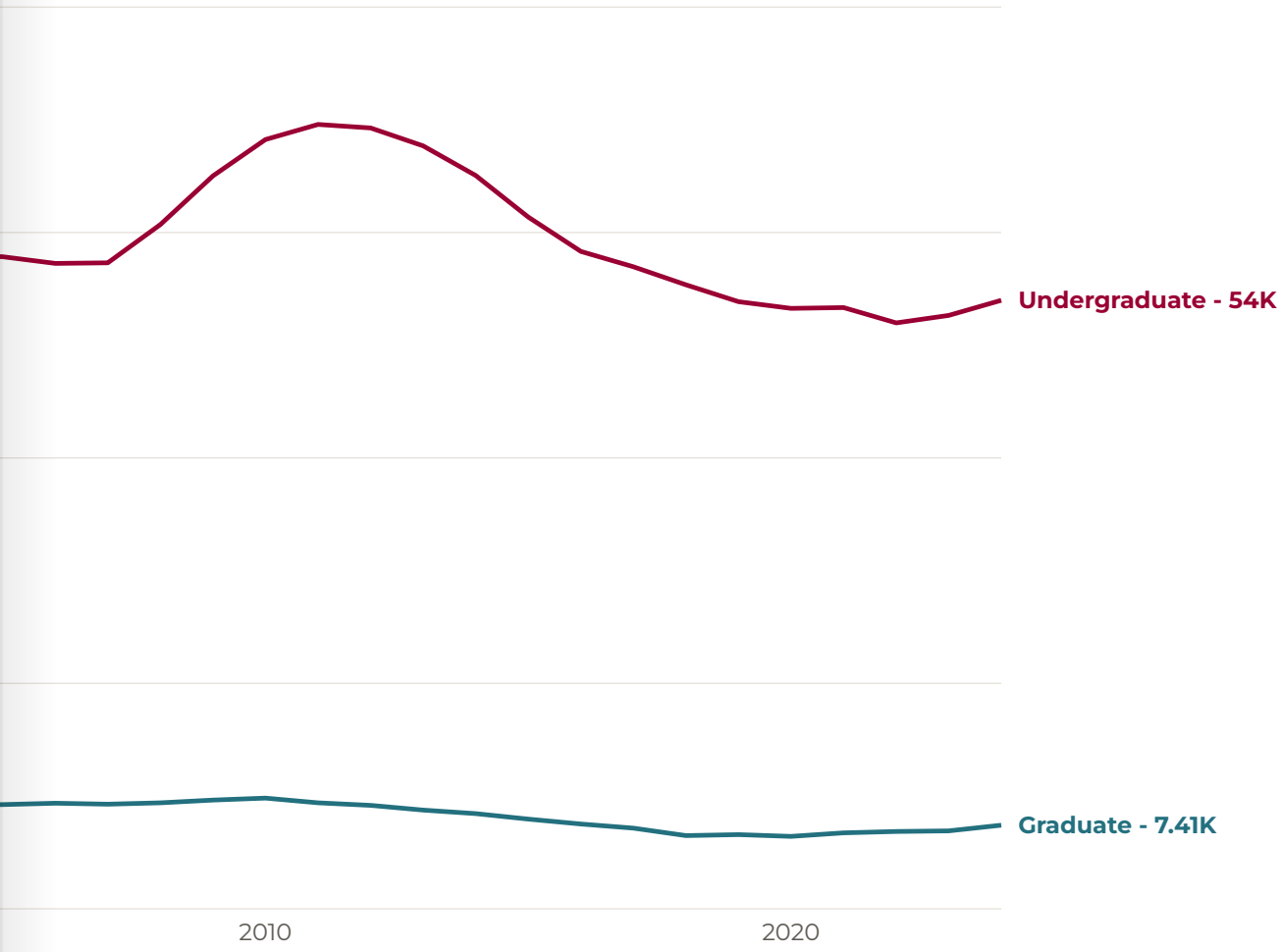
Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Hawaii enrolled 54K undergraduates and 7.41K graduate students, 61.4K in all (44th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 12% since 2015 and graduate enrollment down 7% since 2015. Graduate students are 12% of all students (U.S. 17%).



61.4K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **44th** of 51 · −11% since 2015

12%

Graduate share of students, 2024

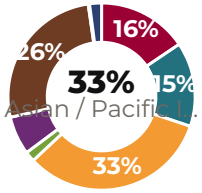
U.S. **17%** · **45th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

47%

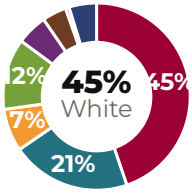
Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **8th** of 51 · +5.5 pp since 2015

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in Hawaii?



Hawaii



United States

	Hawaii	United States
White	**16%**	45%
Hispanic	**15%**	21%
Asian / Pacific Islander	**33%**	7.4%
Black	**1.8%**	12%
International	**6.7%**	5.3%
Two or more	**26%**	4.2%
American Indian	**0.2%**	0.6%
Unknown	**2.1%**	4.8%

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by race and ethnicity. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

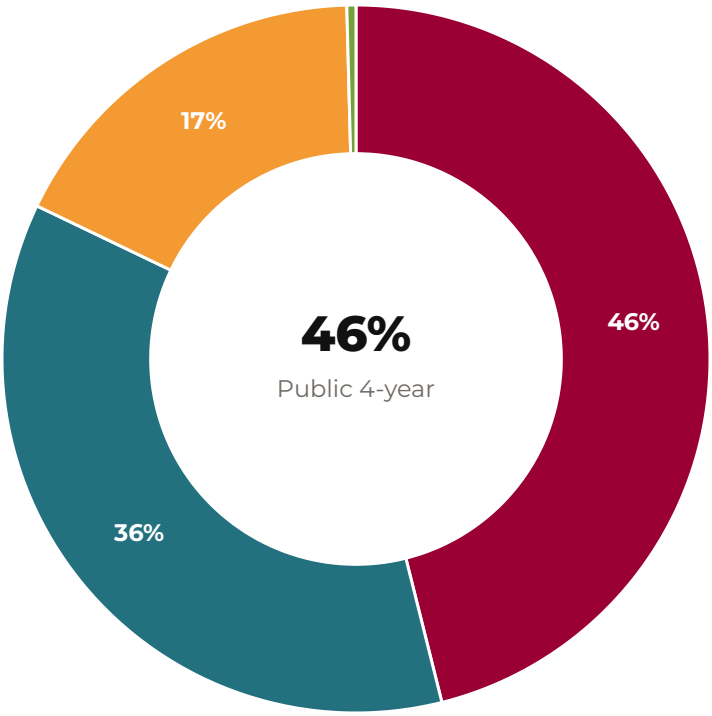
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide fall 2024 headcount enrollment at Hawaii's degree-granting institutions by race and ethnicity, with the nation for comparison. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race; "Unknown" is students whose race was not reported.

THE NUMBERS

- **Asian / Pacific Islander**: 33% in fall 2024 (U.S. 7.4%), down 0.4 points from 33% in fall 2023, and down 4.3 points since fall 2015 (37%).
- **Two or more**: 26% in fall 2024 (U.S. 4.2%), down 0.3 points from 27% in fall 2023, and up 1.3 points since fall 2015 (25%).
- **White**: 16% in fall 2024 (U.S. 45%), down 0.4 points from 16% in fall 2023, and down 1.5 points since fall 2015 (17%).
- **Hispanic**: 15% in fall 2024 (U.S. 21%), up 0.7 points from 14% in fall 2023, and up 4.0 points since fall 2015 (11%).
- **International**: 6.7% in fall 2024 (U.S. 5.3%), up 0.4 points from 6.3% in fall 2023, and up 0.8 points since fall 2015 (5.9%).

Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?



	Share
Public 4-year	46%
Public 2-year	36%
Private nonprofit	17%
For-profit	0.4%

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

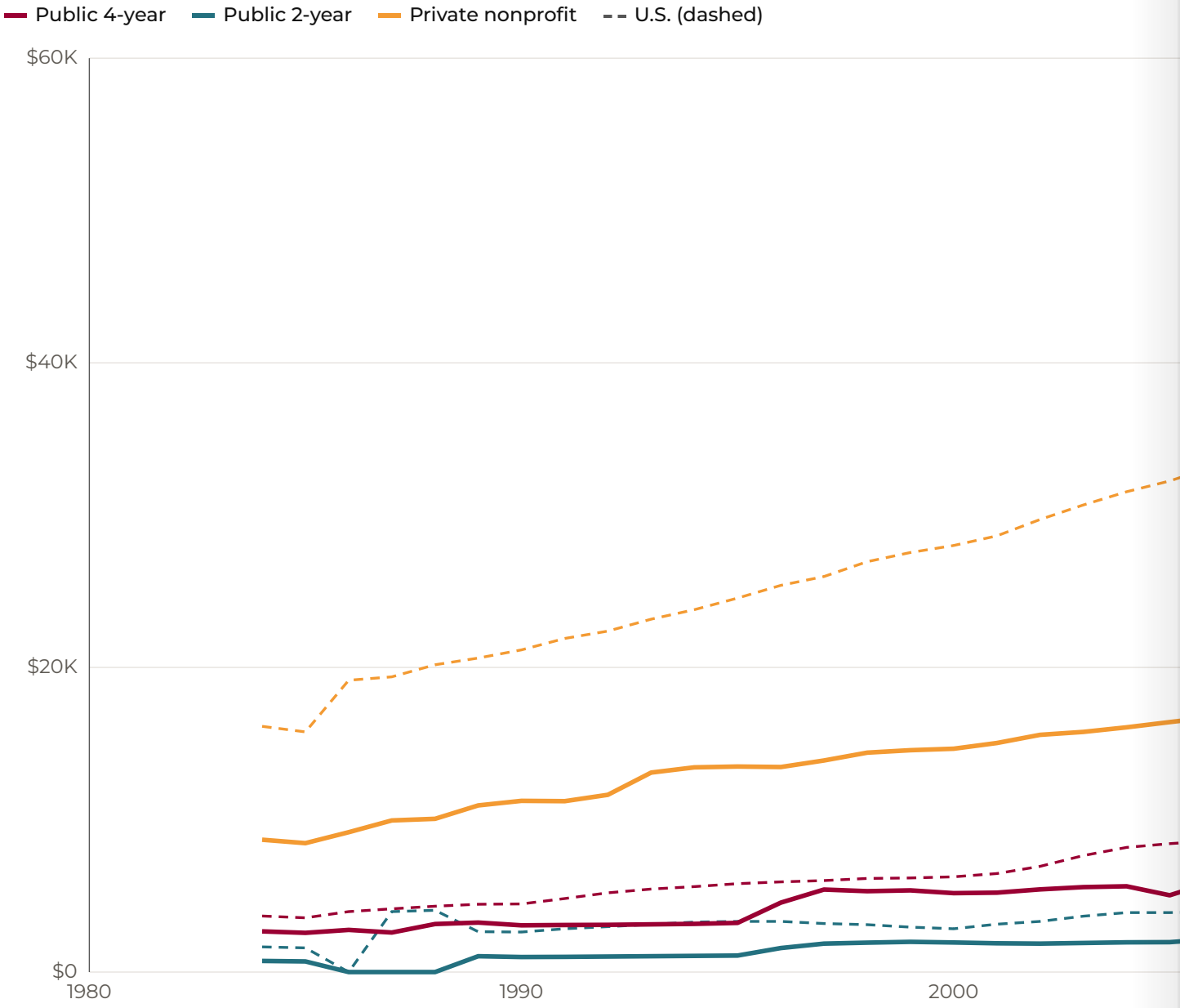
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The ring divides fall 2024 headcount enrollment in Hawaii among public four-year, public two-year, private nonprofit and for-profit institutions.

THE NUMBERS

- **Public 4-year share of enrollment**: 46% in fall 2024, down 0.1 points from 46% in fall 2023, and up 4.3 points since fall 2015 (42%).
- **Public 2-year share of enrollment**: 36% in fall 2024, up 0.1 points from 36% in fall 2023, and down 2.6 points since fall 2015 (39%).
- **Private nonprofit share of enrollment**: 17% in fall 2024, up 0.1 points from 17% in fall 2023, and up 2.2 points since fall 2015 (15%).
- **For-profit share of enrollment**: 0.4% in fall 2024, down 0.1 points from 0.5% in fall 2023, and down 3.9 points since fall 2015 (4.3%).

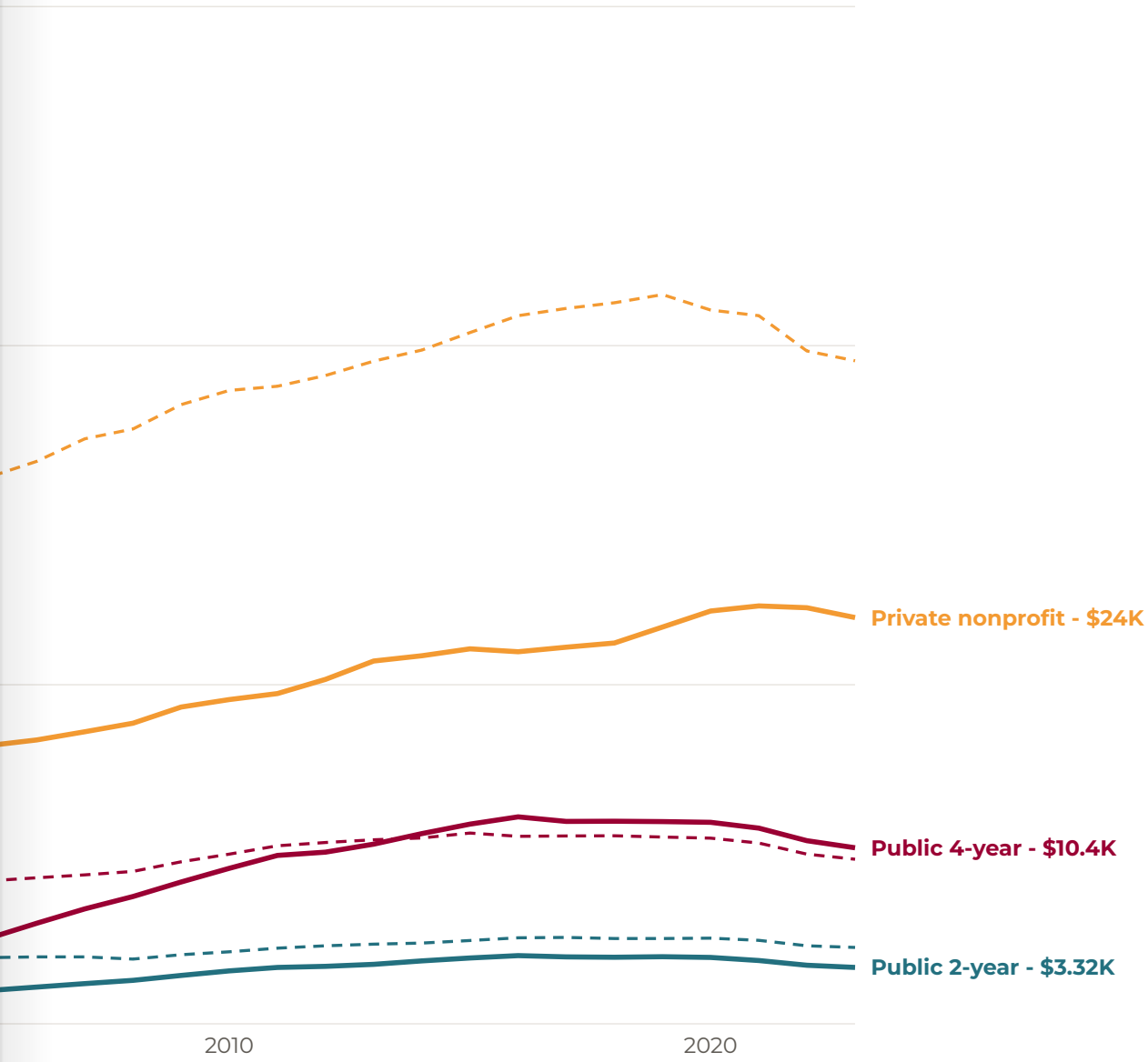
Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Hawaii's public four-year institutions are $10.4K (2023, 2024 dollars), 7% above the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 22nd of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $16.9K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (7th of 51), and tuition makes up 30% of their core revenue (U.S. 43%).



$10.4K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **22nd** of 51 · −12% since 2015

$16.9K

Appropriations per student, 2024

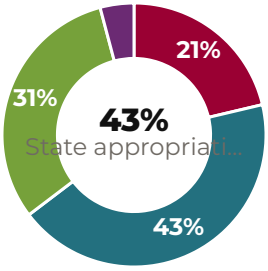
U.S. **$11.4K** · **7th** of 51 · +36% since 2015

30%

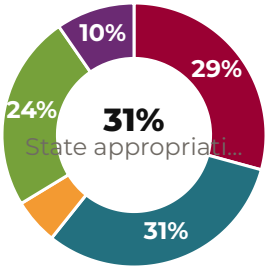
Tuition share of public revenue, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **44th** of 51 · −8.5 pp since 2015

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Hawaii



United States

	Hawaii	United States
Net tuition	**21%**	29%
State appropriations	**43%**	31%
Local appropriations	**0.0%**	5.6%
Federal grants & appropriations	**31%**	24%
Private gifts & grants	**4.1%**	9.6%

Core revenue per FTE student, public institutions. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide the core revenue of Hawaii's public institutions per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student by source, with the nation for comparison. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

THE NUMBERS

- **Net tuition per FTE student**: $8.3K in FY2024 (U.S. $8.96K), down 5.9% from $8.82K in FY2023, and down 5.4% since FY2015 ($8.78K).
- **State appropriations per FTE student**: $16.9K in FY2024 (U.S. $9.64K), up 1.0% from $16.7K in FY2023, and up 36% since FY2015 ($12.4K).
- **Local appropriations per FTE student**: $0 in FY2024 (U.S. $1.71K), from $0 in FY2023, and since FY2015 ($0).
- **Federal grants & appropriations per FTE student**: $12.2K in FY2024 (U.S. $7.36K), down 14% from $14.2K in FY2023, and up 2.6% since FY2015 ($11.8K).

Table 5 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Hawaii	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$10.4K**	$9.71K	22nd of 51	−12%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$16.9K**	$11.4K	7th of 51	+36%
Tuition share of public revenue	2024	**30%**	43%	44th of 51	−8.5 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**56%**	65%	42nd of 51	+6.1 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$110K**	$106K	13th of 51	−4.2%

Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Hawaii: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

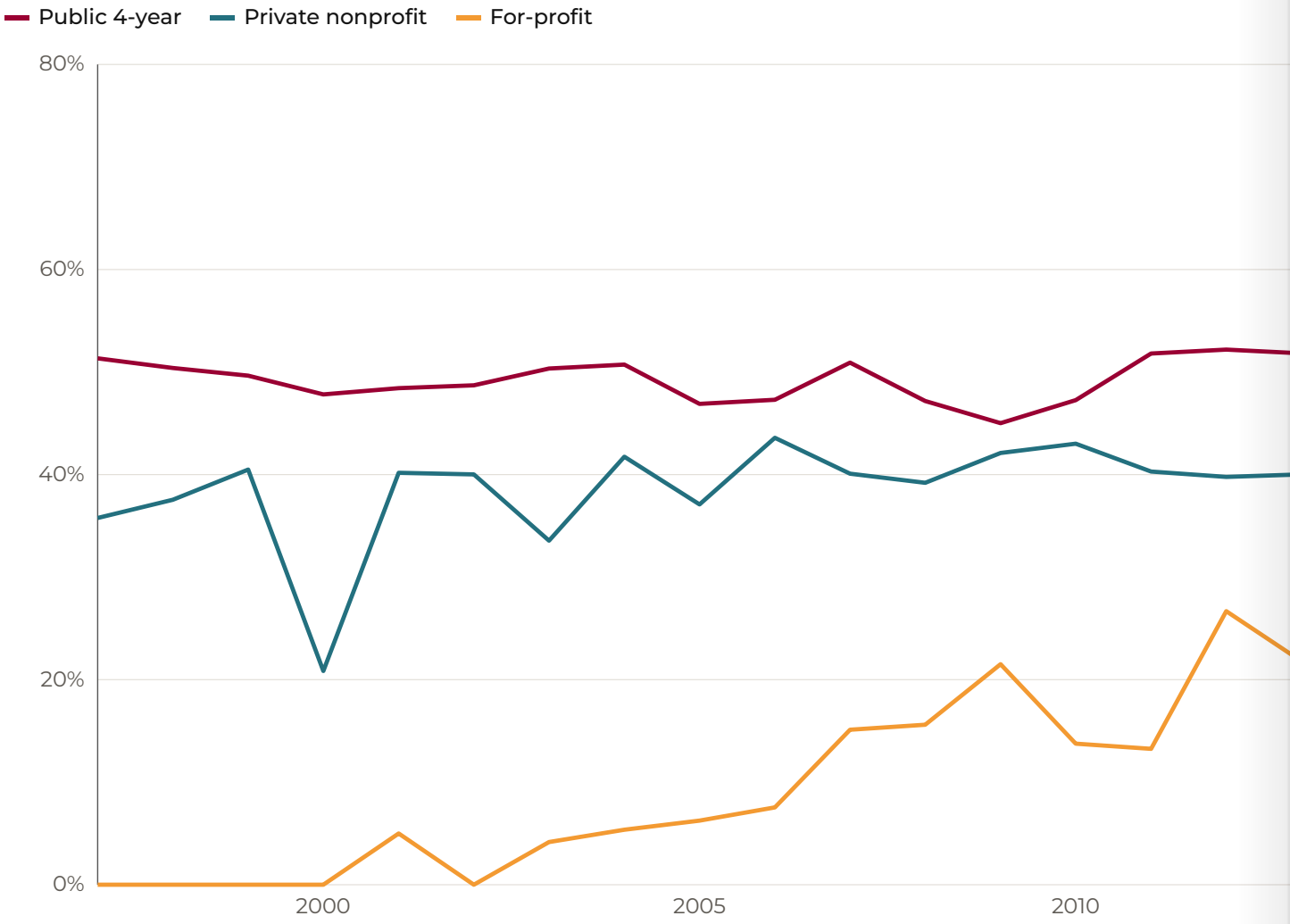
THE NUMBERS

- **In-state tuition, public 4-year**: $10.4K in 2023 (U.S. $9.71K; 22nd of 51 states), down 3.9% from $10.8K in 2022, and down 12% since 2015 ($11.8K).
- **Appropriations per student**: $16.9K in 2024 (U.S. $11.4K; 7th of 51 states), up 1.0% from $16.7K in 2023, and up 36% since 2015 ($12.4K).
- **Tuition share of public revenue**: 30% in 2024 (U.S. 43%; 44th of 51 states), down 1.5 points from 32% in 2023, and down 8.5 points since 2015 (39%).
- **Six-year graduation rate**: 56% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 42nd of 51 states), up 1.4 points from 54% in 2023, and up 6.1 points since 2015 (50%).

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

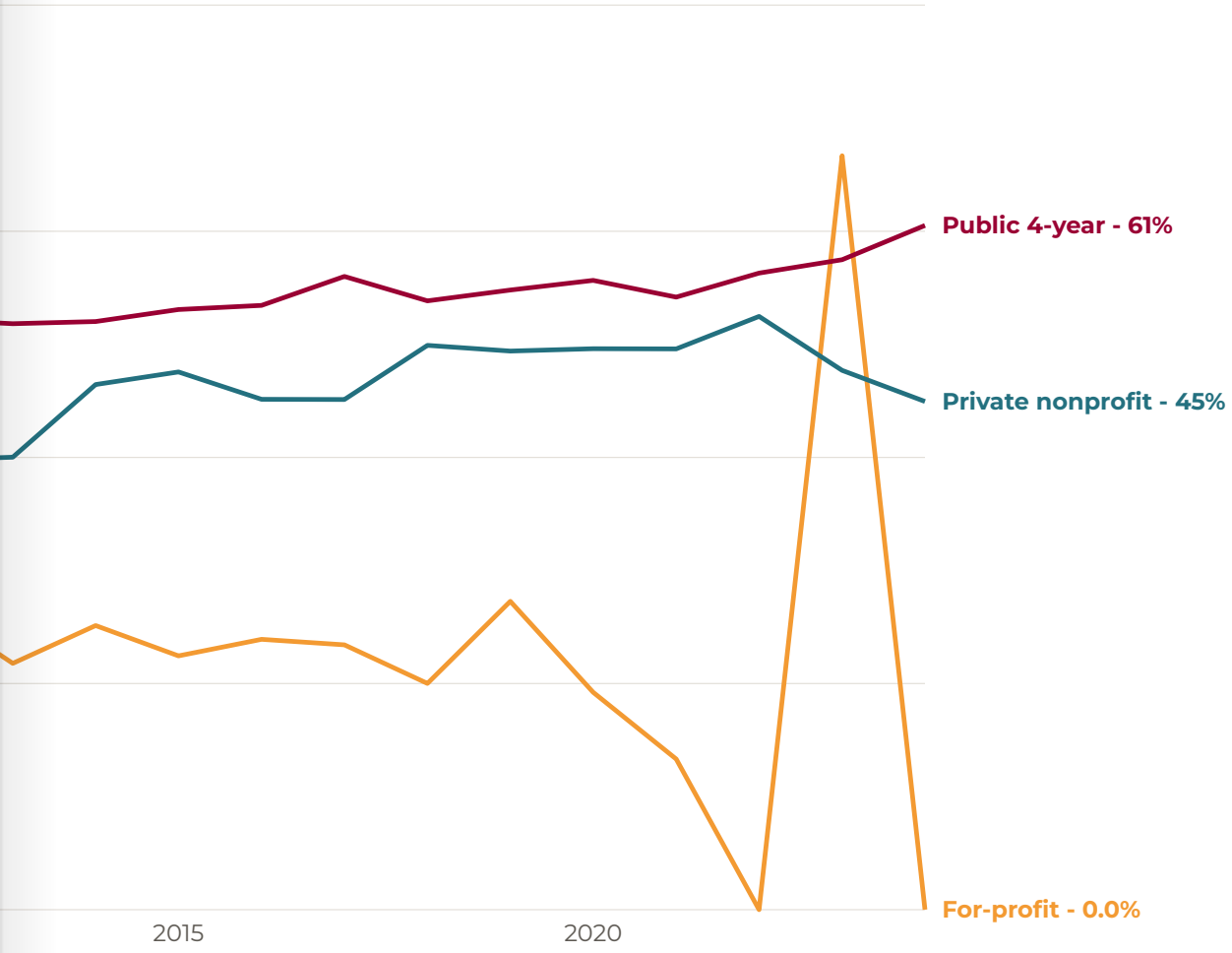
Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

56% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Hawaii graduated within six years (2024), 8.9 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 42nd of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 61%, private nonprofit 45%, for-profit 0.0%. At two-year institutions, 37% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).



56%

Six-year graduation rate, 2024

U.S. **65%** · **42nd** of 51 · +6.1 pp since 2015

37%

Two-year completion rate, 2024

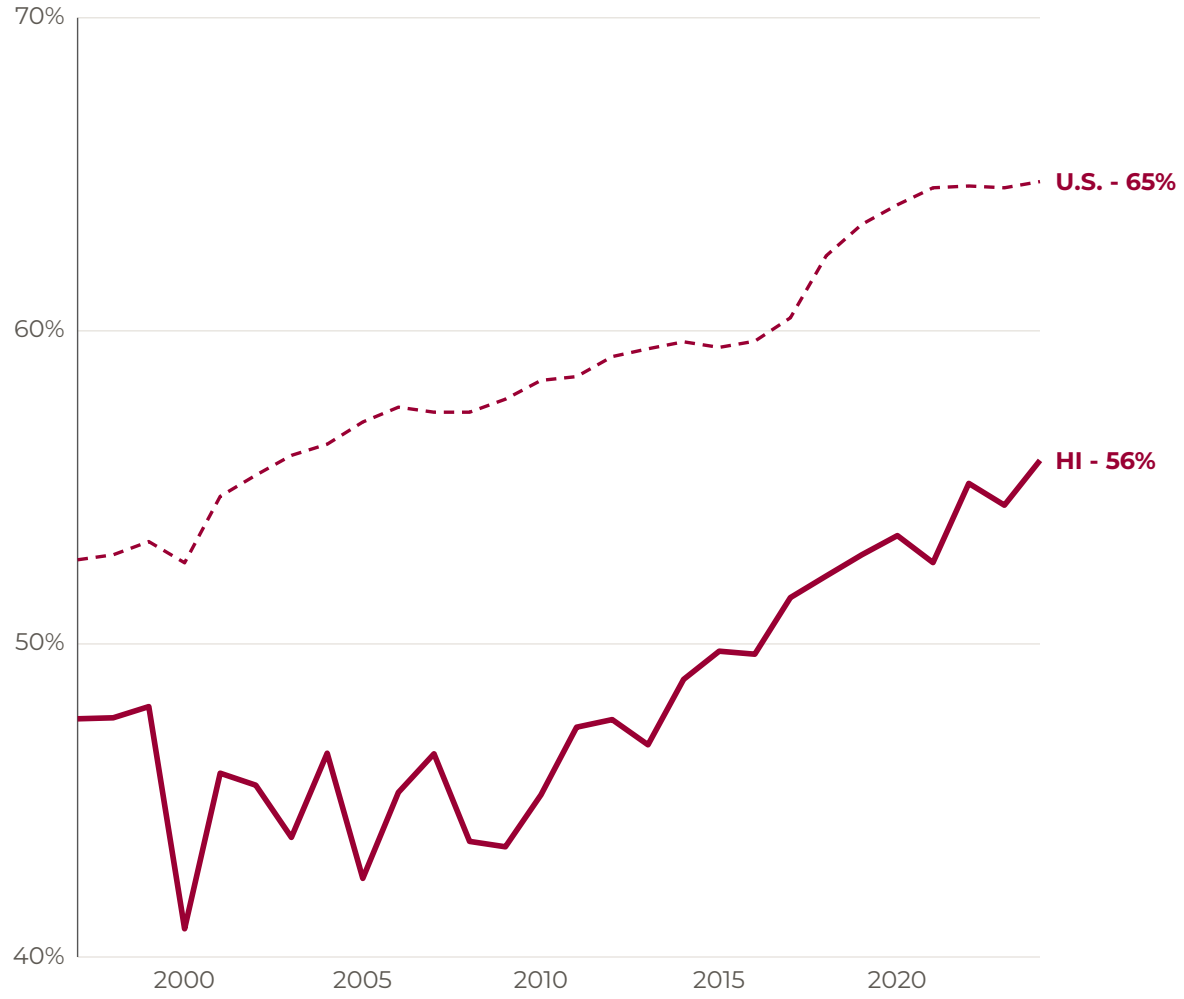
U.S. **41%** · **33rd** of 50 · +17.4 pp since 2015

11.2

Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025

U.S. **12.3** · **40th** of 51 · +0.5 since 2015

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

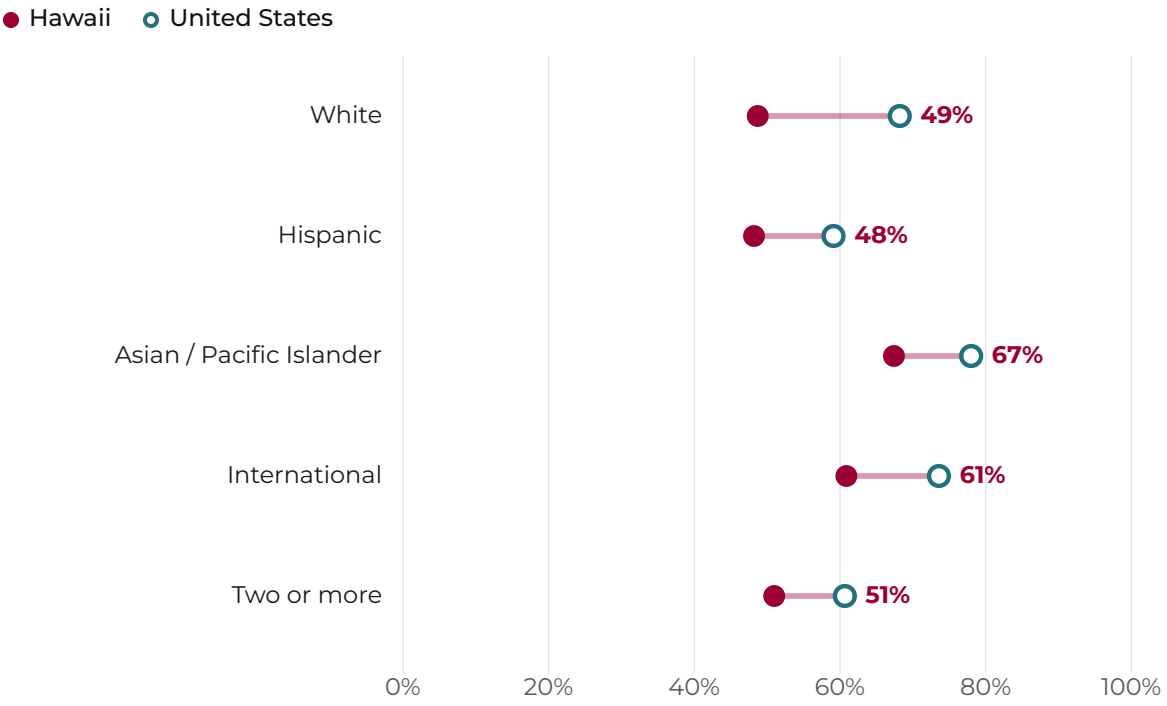
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Hawaii's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Six-year graduation rate**: 56% in 2024 (U.S. 65%), up 1.4 points from 54% in 2023, and up 6.1 points since 2015 (50%).
- **Public 4-year institutions**: 61% in 2024, up 3.0 points from 57% in 2023, and up 7.5 points since 2015 (53%).
- **Private nonprofit institutions**: 45% in 2024, down 2.8 points from 48% in 2023, and down 2.6 points since 2015 (48%).
- **For-profit institutions**: 0.0% in 2024, down 66.7 points from 67% in 2023, and down 22.5 points since 2015 (22%).
- **Two-year institutions, completion within 150% of normal time**: 37% in 2024 (U.S. 41%), up 7.7 points from 29% in 2023, and up 17.4 points since 2015 (19%).
- **State rank on the six-year rate**: 56% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 42nd of 51 states), up 1.4 points from 54% in 2023, and up 6.1 points since 2015 (50%).

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Hawaii's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

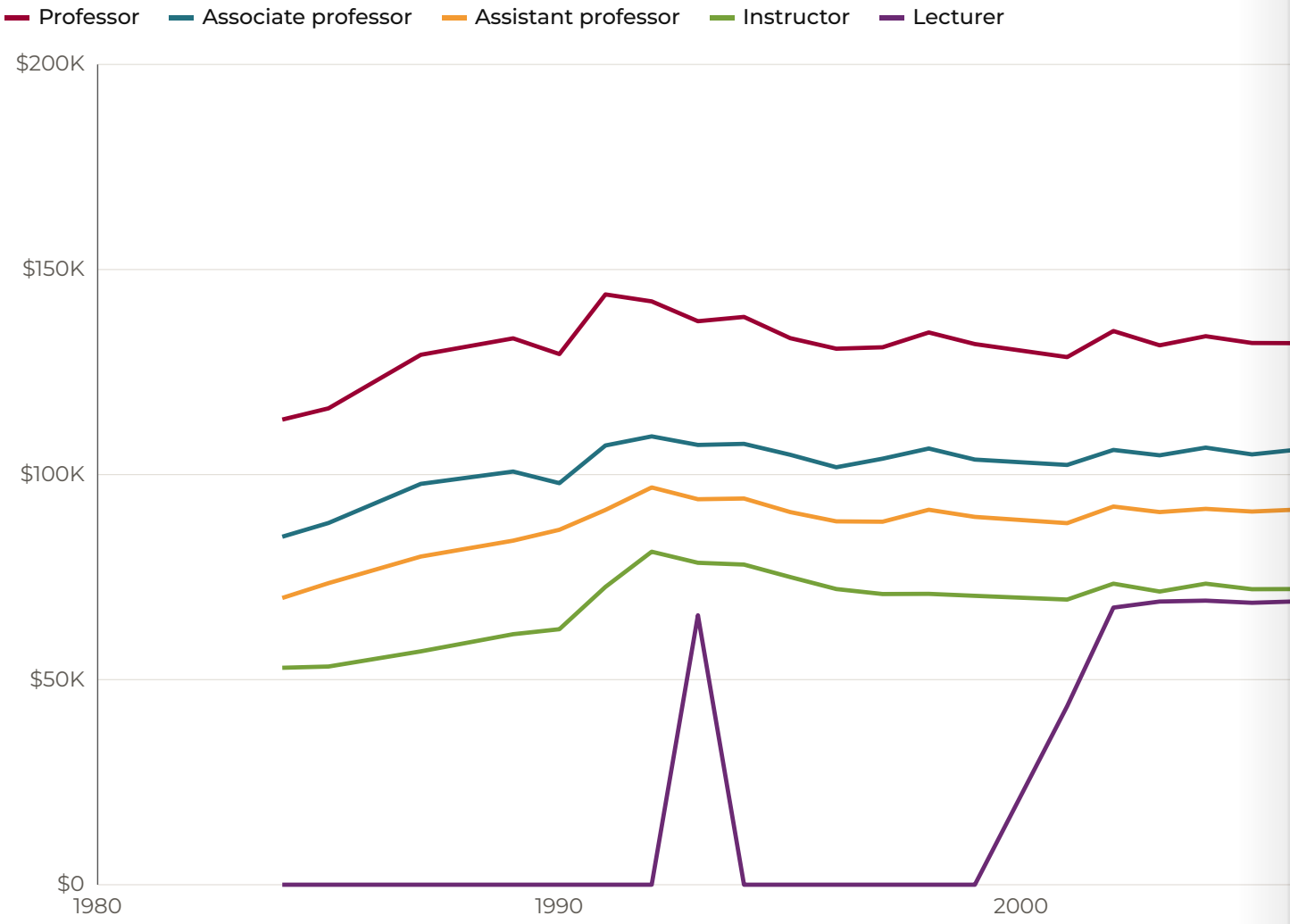
THE NUMBERS

- **White**: 49% in 2024 (U.S. 68%).
- **Hispanic**: 48% in 2024 (U.S. 59%).
- **Asian / Pacific Islander**: 67% in 2024 (U.S. 78%).
- **International**: 61% in 2024 (U.S. 74%).
- **Two or more**: 51% in 2024 (U.S. 61%).

SECTION 15

Faculty

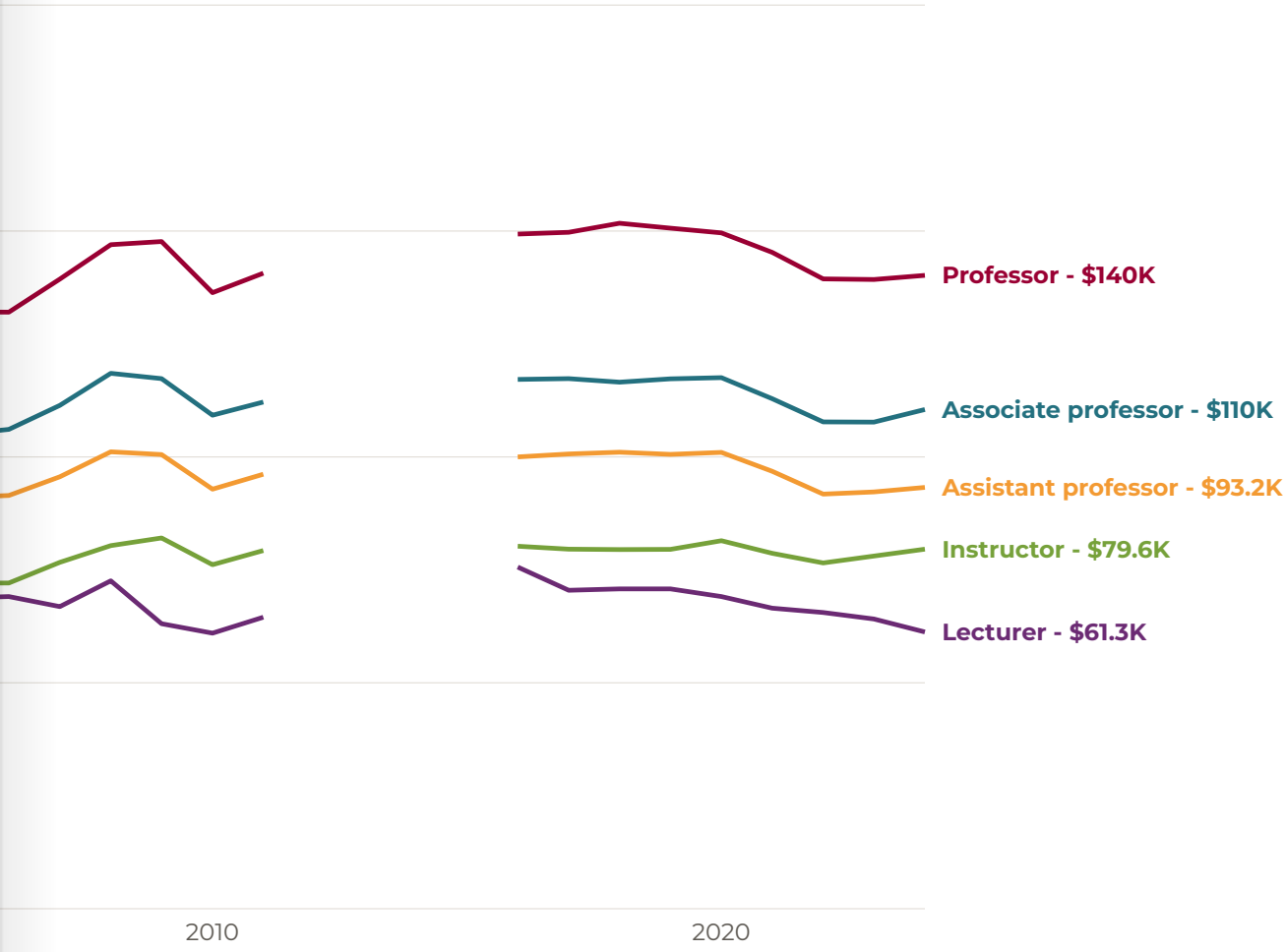
Figure 39 What Do Hawaii's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data fro

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Hawaii's institutions earned an average of $110K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 4% above the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 13th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $140K, associate professors $110K, assistant professors $93.2K, instructors $79.6K, lecturers $61.3K.

Hawaii's institutions had 2.38K full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 10% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 4% since 2016.



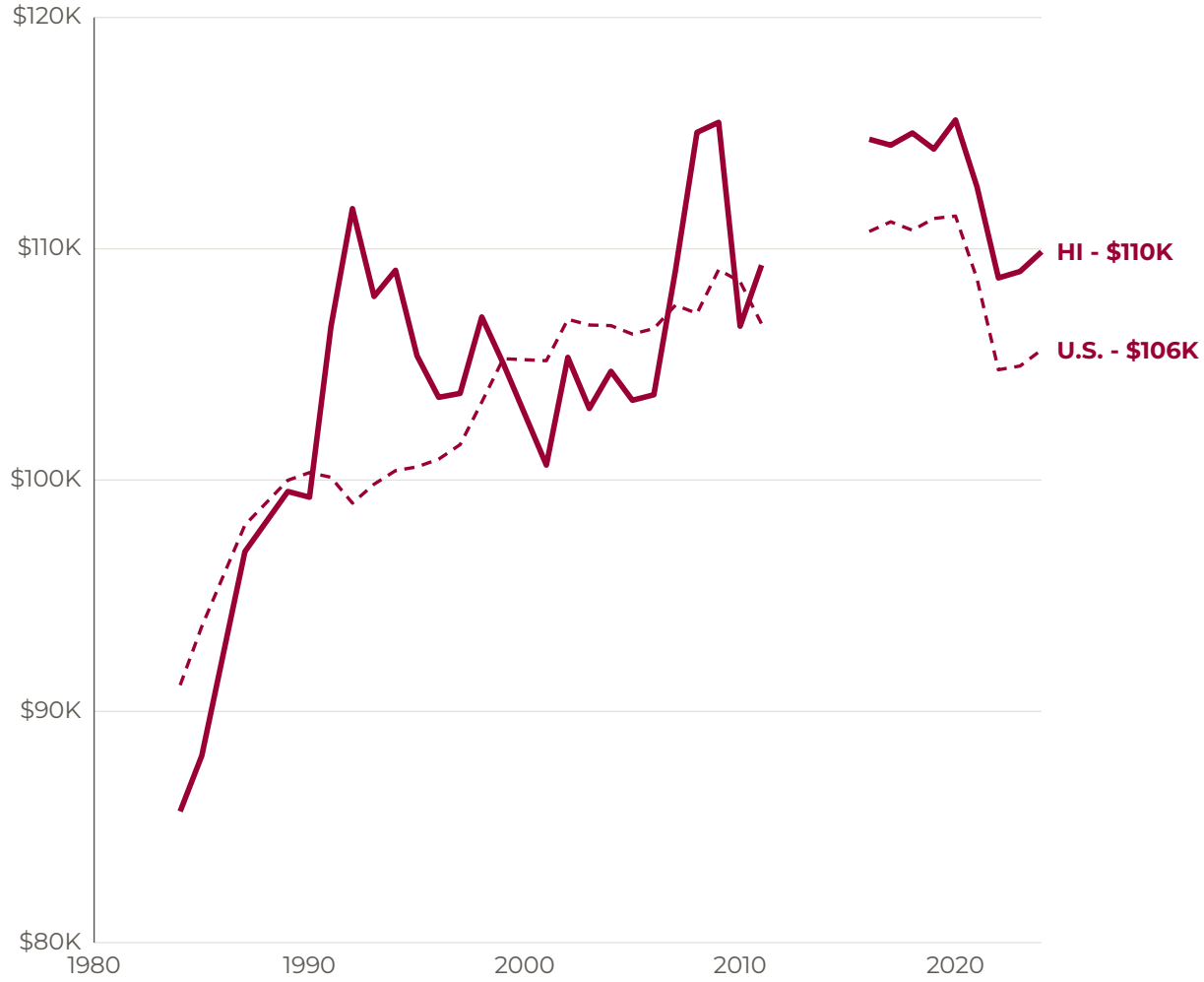
m NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

$110K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **13th** of 51 · −4.2% since 2016

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

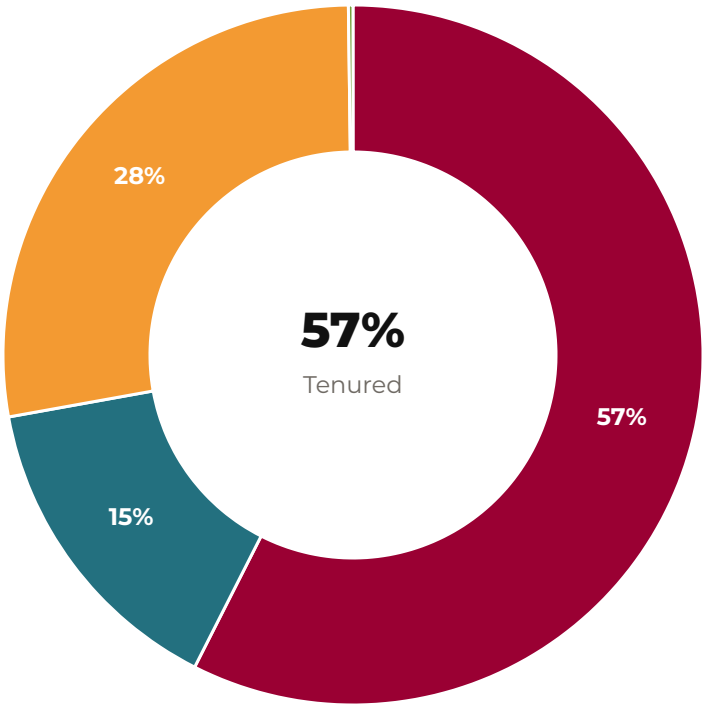
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Hawaii's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Average salary**: $110K in 2024 (U.S. $106K), up 0.8% from $109K in 2023, and down 4.2% since 2016 ($115K).
- **State rank on average salary**: $110K in 2024 (U.S. $106K; 13th of 51 states), up 0.8% from $109K in 2023, and down 4.2% since 2016 ($115K).
- **Full-time instructional staff**: 2.38K in 2024, up 2.8% from 2.32K in 2023, and down 10% since 2015 (2.65K).
- **Professors, average salary**: $140K in 2024, up 0.7% from $139K in 2023, and down 6.1% since 2016 ($149K).
- **Associate professors, average salary**: $110K in 2024, up 2.6% from $108K in 2023, and down 5.7% since 2016 ($117K).
- **Assistant professors, average salary**: $93.2K in 2024, up 1.1% from $92.2K in 2023, and down 6.7% since 2016 ($100K).

Figure 41 Tenure Status



	Share
Tenured	57%
On tenure track	15%
Not on tenure track	28%
No faculty status	0.2%

Full-time instructional staff, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The ring divides Hawaii's full-time instructional staff in 2024 by tenure status: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

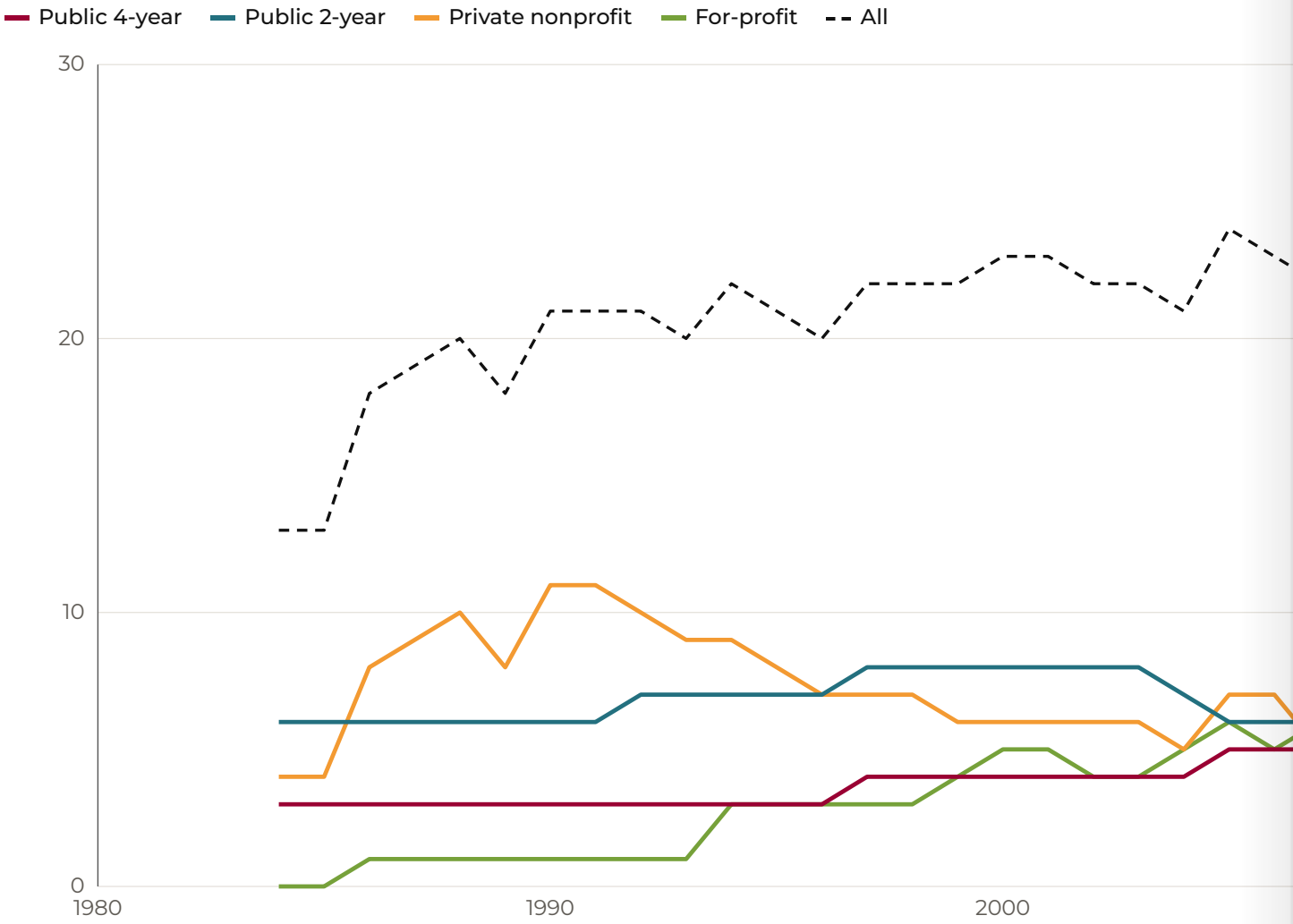
THE NUMBERS

- **Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff**: 57% in 2024, down 1.5 points from 59% in 2023, and up 2.5 points since 2015 (55%).
- **On tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 15% in 2024, up 1.2 points from 13% in 2023, and down 4.3 points since 2015 (19%).
- **Not on tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 28% in 2024, up 0.2 points from 27% in 2023, and up 2.2 points since 2015 (25%).
- **No faculty status, share of full-time instructional staff**: 0.2% in 2024, up 0.1 points from 0.1% in 2023, and down 0.4 points since 2015 (0.6%).

SECTION 16

Institutions

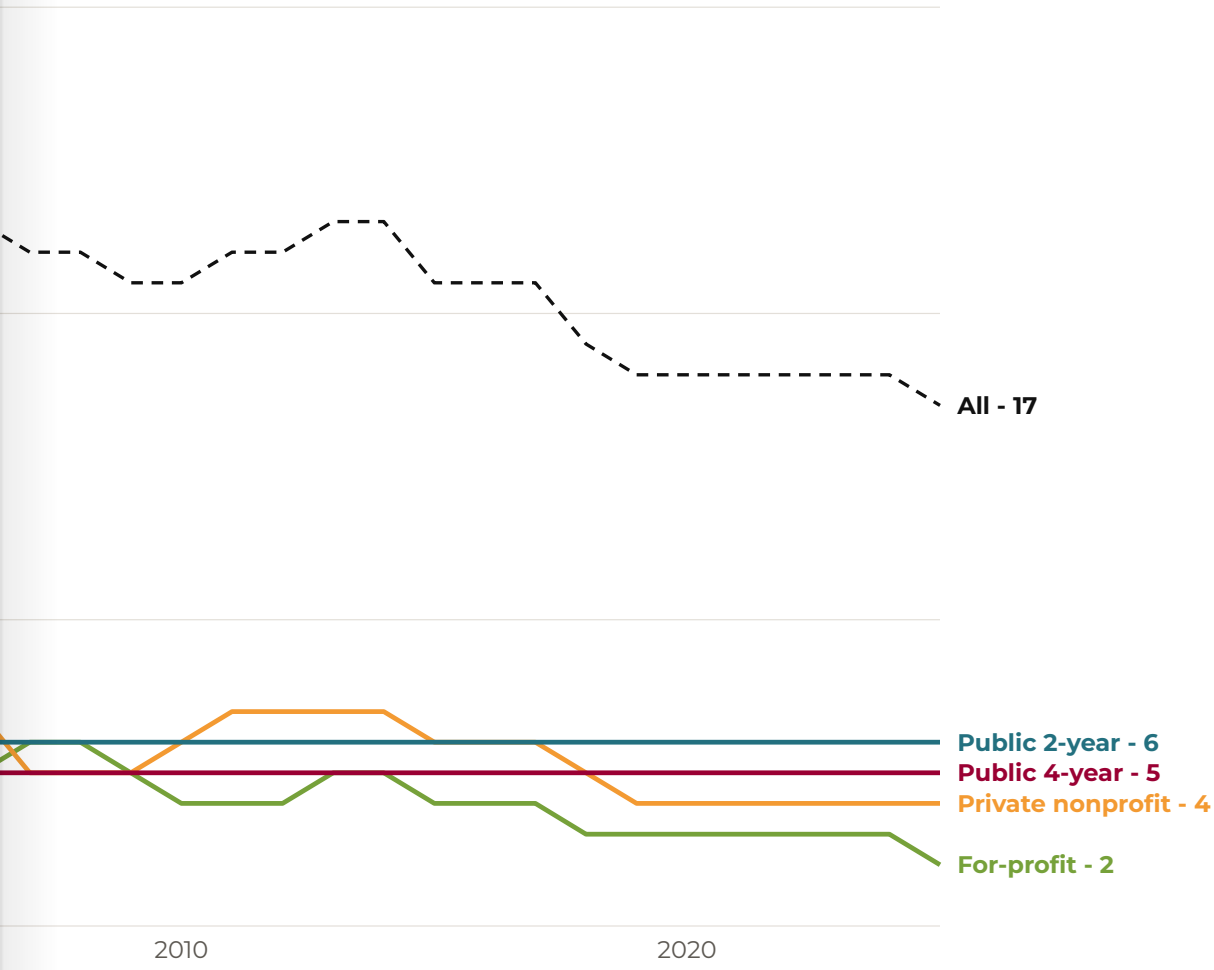
Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does Hawaii Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Hawaii has 16 degree-granting institutions: 5 public 4-year, 6 public 2-year, 4 private nonprofit, 2 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 19% since 2015. 82% of students attend public institutions and 0.4% attend for-profit ones.



82%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **23rd** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

0.4%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **39th** of 51 · −3.9 pp since 2015

30%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **14th** of 51 · +17.9 pp since 2015

Table 6 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
University of Hawaii at Manoa Honolulu · Public 4-year	**38**	17%	34	35%
University of Hawaii at Hilo Hilo · Public 4-year	**2**	12%	–	–

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Institutions in Hawaii ranked by the STEM master's and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: University of Hawaii at Manoa (38 international STEM master's, 34 doctorates); University of Hawaii at Hilo (2 international STEM master's, – doctorates).
- **International STEM master's degrees, all institutions**: 40 in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 47th of 51 states), up 38% from 29 in 2024, and down 15% since 2015 (47).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 35% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 41st of 51 states), up 2.2 points from 32% in 2024, and down 5.7 points since 2015 (40%).

Table 7 What Are Hawaii's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of Hawaii at Manoa	**20K**	15%	817	64%	87%
Leeward Community College	**6.47K**	–	–	–	–
Kapiolani Community College	**5.91K**	–	–	–	–
Hawaii Pacific University	**4.92K**	3.3%	141	35%	86%
Honolulu Community College	**3.34K**	–	–	–	–
Brigham Young University-Hawaii	**2.91K**	–	112	50%	47%
University of Hawaii-West Oahu	**2.81K**	–	–	50%	95%
University of Hawaii Maui College	**2.79K**	–	–	–	–
Windward Community College	**2.77K**	–	–	–	–
Chaminade University of Honolulu	**2.71K**	0.7%	24	65%	91%
University of Hawaii at Hilo	**2.67K**	3.5%	110	48%	61%
Hawaii Community College	**2.29K**	–	–	–	–
Kauai Community College	**1.33K**	–	–	–	–
Hawaii Medical College	**194**	–	–	–	–
Pacific Rim Christian University	**187**	6.9%	–	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Hawaii's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: University of Hawaii at Manoa (20K students); Leeward Community College (6.47K students); Kapiolani Community College (5.91K students).
- **Degree-granting institutions**: 16.
- **Share of students at public institutions**: 82% in 2024 (U.S. 73%; 23rd of 51 states), unchanged from 82% in 2023, and up 1.7 points since 2015 (80%).
- **Share at for-profit institutions**: 0.4% in 2024 (U.S. 5.5%; 39th of 51 states), down 0.1 points from 0.5% in 2023, and down 3.9 points since 2015 (4.3%).

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

All dollar values are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts.

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

Source

National Center for Education Statistics, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS): Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions components, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. Department of Homeland Security, SEVIS by the Numbers data mapping tool, 2014–2026. Generated November 2026.

This page intentionally left blank.

Hawaii – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	279	**270**[2024]	−9.3 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#30	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	30%	**23%**[2024]	−6.9 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#38	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	238	**239**[2024]	+1.4 ▲	237	−2.5 ▼	#14	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	38%	**42%**[2024]	+3.8 pp ▲	39%	0.0 pp	#13	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	257	**257**[2024]	−0.1 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#25	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	26%	**29%**[2024]	+3.4 pp ▲	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#23	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	215	**216**[2024]	+0.7 ▲	214	−7.1 ▼	#16	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**144**[2015]	–	153	–	#42	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$16.8K	**$19.5K**[2021]	+16% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#16	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	82%	**86%**[2022]	+4.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#25	[3]
Public high school graduates	10.7K	**11.4K**[2024]	+6.5% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#42	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$74.8K	**$73.5K**[2022]	−1.7% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#15	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	15.5	**14.2**[2022]	−1.3 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#25	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	182K	**167K**[2024]	−8.2% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#41	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	50%	**46%**[2023]	−4.0 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#30	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	8.4%	**10%**[2022]	+1.6 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#14	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	5.7%	**7.1%**[2023]	+1.4 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#21	[3]
High schools offering calculus	24%[2016]	**51%**[2024]	+27.0 pp ▲	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#28	[14]
High schools offering physics	67%[2016]	**77%**[2024]	+10.3 pp ▲	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#13	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	84%[2016]	**80%**[2024]	−4.1 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#31	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	94%[2016]	**85%**[2024]	−9.0 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#42	[14]
High schools offering computer science	71%[2021]	**82%**[2024]	+10.6 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#4	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	67%[2016]	**58%**[2024]	−8.2 pp ▼	56%	0.0 pp	#26	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	35%[2021]	**34%**[2024]	−1.6 pp ▼	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#15	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	90%[2016]	**94%[2024]**	+3.4 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#1	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	11.5[2016]	**12.8[2024]**	+1.2 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#35	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	0.8[2016]	**2.3[2024]**	+1.5 ▲	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#36	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	6.2[2016]	**17.0[2024]**	+10.8 ▲	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#5	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	23.7[2016]	**18.1[2024]**	−5.6 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#29	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	2.9[2016]	**0.5[2024]**	−2.4 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#47	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	32%	**28%[2025]**	−3.4 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#44	[15]
Fall enrollment	69.3K	**61.4K[2024]**	−11% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#44	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	80%	**82%[2024]**	+1.7 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#23	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	4.3%	**0.4%[2024]**	−3.9 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#39	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	41%	**47%[2024]**	+5.5 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#8	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	11%	**12%[2024]**	+0.6 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#45	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	12%	**30%[2024]**	+17.9 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#14	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	240	**202[2025]**	−16% ▼	59K	+7.3% ▲	#44	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	152	**135[2025]**	−11% ▼	44.4K	+14% ▲	#44	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.4%	**0.3%[2025]**	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#44	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	15	**17[2025]**	+13% ▲	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#47	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	8	**7[2025]**	−13% ▼	5.07K	+33% ▲	#46	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	2.6	**2.6[2025]**	−0.1 ▼	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#49	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	16%	**20%[2025]**	+4.4 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	3.1%	**4.2%[2025]**	+1.2 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#34	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	3.4%	**3.4%[2025]**	0.0 pp	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#49	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**0.4%[2025]**	−0.3 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#49	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	5.9%	**8.4%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#5	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	0.8%	**1.3%**[2025]	+0.5 pp ▲	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#26	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	10%	**9.4%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#41	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	21%	**22%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#10	[4]
STEM share of master's	13%	**17%**[2025]	+3.5 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	3.7%	**3.0%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#43	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	2.6%	**5.1%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#31	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.4%	**1.3%**[2025]	+0.9 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#19	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	2.0%	**2.2%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	1.9%	**1.8%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#9	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	8.4%	**11%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#43	[4]
Share of master's in business	27%	**11%**[2025]	−15.6 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#51	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	36%	**46%**[2025]	+9.4 pp ▲	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#18	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	1.2%	**3.7%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#23	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	10%	**11%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#35	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	1.9%	**0.9%**[2025]	−1.0 pp ▼	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#43	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	11%	**17%**[2025]	+5.6 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#5	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	8.8%	**13%**[2025]	+4.2 pp ▲	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#6	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	4.6%	**5.6%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#38	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	4.2%	**4.7%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#16	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	10.7	**11.2**[2025]	+0.5 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#40	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	4.5%[2016]	**5.3%**[2024]	+0.8 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#5	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	47	**40**[2025]	−15% ▼	117K	2.18× ▲	#47	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.1%	**0.0%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#47	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	5.1%	**6.2%**[2024]	+1.1 pp ▲	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#2	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	12%	**10%**[2024]	−1.8 pp ▼	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#36	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	7.6%	**7.2%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#3	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	5.1%	**8.3%**[2025]	+3.2 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#7	[4]
International share of all master's	13%	**8.9%**[2025]	−3.8 pp ▼	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of STEM master's	19%	**16%**[2025]	−2.9 pp ▼	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#46	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	26%	**20%**[2025]	−6.5 pp ▼	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#44	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	17%	**17%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#48	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	16%	**19%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#23	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	20%	**23%**[2023]	+2.9 pp ▲	26%	−3.3 pp ▼	#22	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	27%	**31%**[2025]	+4.2 pp ▲	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#10	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	40%	**35%**[2025]	−5.7 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#41	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	16%[2017]	**33%**[2025]	+17.2 pp ▲	23%	−2.3 pp ▼	#3	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	–	**34%**[2019]	–	39%	–	#29	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	4.8K	**2.68K**[2026]	−44% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#44	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.4%	**0.2%**[2026]	−0.2 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#44	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	0.5%	**1.5%**[2026]	+1.0 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#51	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	10%	**8.8%**[2026]	−1.2 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#33	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	50%	**40%**[2026]	−10.1 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#23	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	114	**101**[2026]	−11% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#48	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	543	**688**[2026]	+27% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#47	[20]
Active STEM master's students	104	**177**[2026]	+70% ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#47	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	174	**271**[2026]	+56% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#47	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	5.8%	**21%**[2026]	+15.7 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#50	[20]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	538[2017]	**701[2024]**	+30% ▲	–	–	#44	[1]
Economic contribution of international students	$121M[2018]	**$125M[2024]**	+2.9% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#37	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	1.01K[2018]	**762[2024]**	−25% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#39	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.4%[2024]**	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#36	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.3%[2024]**	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#38	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.5%	**0.6%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#35	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	1.64K	**1.93K[2025]**	+17% ▲	275K	−14% ▼	#35	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	2.03K	**1.87K[2016]**	−8.2% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#44	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	469	**412[2016]**	−12% ▼	241K	+2.3% ▲	#45	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	23%	**22%[2016]**	−1.0 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#46	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	32%	**33%[2016]**	+1.2 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#48	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	201	**202[2016]**	+0.5% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#36	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	55%	**64%[2016]**	+9.1 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#6	[9]
University R&D spending	$332M	**$404M[2024]**	+22% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#42	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.5%	**0.3%[2024]**	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#42	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	64%	**65%[2024]**	+0.4 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#6	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	2.0%	**0.9%[2024]**	−1.1 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#49	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	4.3%	**4.8%[2024]**	+0.6 pp ▲	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#28	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science	$22.3M	**$31.7M[2024]**	+42% ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#31	[6]
University R&D in engineering	$24.1M	**$31.2M[2024]**	+30% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#49	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	5.05K	**3.92K[2024]**	−23% ▼	1.09M	+20% ▲	#43	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state	$305M	**$487M[2024]**	+59% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#38	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state	$135M	**$186M[2024]**	+38% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#39	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state	$157M	**$277M[2024]**	+76% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#30	[8]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state	$49.4M	**$74.2M**[2024]	+50% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#43	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state	$110M	**$139M**[2025]	+26% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#39	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state	$74.5M	**$134M**[2026]	+80% ▲	$59.3B	+59% ▲	#29	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$51.3K[2020]	**$51.9K**[2022]	+1.2% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#13	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$44.5K**[2025]	–	$47.5K	–	#46	[15]
Median debt of completers	$12.9K	**$18.8K**[2024]	+45% ▲	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#32	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$45.7K**[2025]	–	$68.2K	–	#51	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$45.9K**[2025]	–	$51.9K	–	#45	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$59.3K**[2025]	–	$68.1K	–	#48	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$49.7K**[2025]	–	$91.6K	–	#48	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	50%	**56%**[2024]	+6.1 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	19%	**37%**[2024]	+17.4 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#33	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$11.8K	**$10.4K**[2023]	−12% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#22	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$12.4K	**$16.9K**[2024]	+36% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#7	[4]
Tuition share of core revenue, public institutions	39%	**30%**[2024]	−8.5 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#44	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$115K[2016]	**$110K**[2024]	−4.2% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#13	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	76%	**71%**[2016]	−4.5 pp ▼	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#2	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	75%	**71%**[2016]	−3.6 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#6	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	80%	**63%**[2016]	−17.2 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#4	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	60%	**63%**[2016]	+3.4 pp ▲	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#2	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	1.01	**0.91**[2016]	−0.1 ▼	1.00	0.0	#22	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	24	**22**[2016]	−8.3% ▼	41.2K	+51% ▲	#48	[21]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	77%[2016]	**75%[2019]**	−1.7 pp ▼	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#8	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**64%[2016]**	–	65%	–	#13	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**62%[2010]**	–	64%	–	#16	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	70%[2016]	**71%[2019]**	+1.8 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#7	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**79%[2016]**	–	66%	–	#3	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**52%[2016]**	–	49%	–	#13	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$41.6K[2016]	**$41.5K[2019]**	−0.2% ▼	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#33	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$60.8K[2016]**	–	$67.3K	–	#31	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$48.2K[2016]	**$45.2K[2019]**	−6.2% ▼	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#33	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−4.5	**−3.5[2025]**	+1.0 ▲	–	–	#38	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−266	**+461[2025]**	– ▲	–	–	#19	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	4.2%	**4.1%[2025]**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#7	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	4.7%	**4.4%[2025]**	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#2	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	4.67K	**2.44K[2025]**	−48% ▼	–	–	#36	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	77%[2016]	**73%[2024]**	−4.2 pp ▼	–	–	#24	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	−24[2016]	**−21[2024]**	+2.4 ▲	–	–	#49	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	41%[2016]	**45%[2022]**	+3.4 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#6	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	792	**349[2025]**	−56% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#49	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.1%	**0.0%[2025]**	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#49	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	67%	**47%[2025]**	−19.7 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#41	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars	$65.1K	**$90.7K[2025]**	+39% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#40	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	36%	**3.4%[2025]**	−32.8 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#49	[17]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Green-card labor certifications	74	**124**[2025]	+68% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#46	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	8.1%	**5.9%**[2024]	−2.2 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#47	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	7.0%	**22%**[2024]	+15.2 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#2	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	50%	**15%**[2024]	−34.7 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#45	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	26%	**17%**[2025]	−9.3 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#44	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars	$63.4K	**$54.6K**[2025]	−14% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#36	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	6.51K	**4.79K**[2024]	−26% ▼	1.36M	+30% ▲	#36	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.6%	**0.4%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#36	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	3.7K	**3.67K**[2024]	−0.8% ▼	819K	+12% ▲	#31	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.5%	**0.4%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#31	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.1%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#46	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#42	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#44	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#29	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	84	**72**[2026]	−14% ▼	127K	+14% ▲	#50	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	113	**91**[2026]	−19% ▼	268K	+52% ▲	#50	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.1%	**0.1%**[2026]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#50	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	5.6%	**6.5%**[2026]	+0.9 pp ▲	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#2	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	26%	**26%**[2026]	+0.2 pp ▲	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#18	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	38%	**31%**[2026]	−7.5 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#24	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	56%	**57%**[2026]	+1.0 pp ▲	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#9	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	35.6K	**45.2K**[2024]	+27% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#42	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	5.0%	**6.1%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#41	[12]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	15%	**17%**[2024]	+2.7 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#19	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	23%[2021]	**20%**[2024]	−3.0 pp ▼	41%	+1.3 pp ▲	#38	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	4.4%	**4.9%**[2024]	+0.5 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#40	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	1.9%	**3.1%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#43	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	18%	**18%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#8	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	14%	**16%**[2025]	+2.1 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#18	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	25.6K	**31.9K**[2025]	+25% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#43	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.69	**0.76**[2025]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#39	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal	$75.7K	**$101K**[2025]	+34% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#32	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal	$90.8K[2019]	**$124K**[2025]	+37% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#31	[10]
Software developer jobs	1.65K	**1.6K**[2025]	−3.0% ▼	1.69M	+48% ▲	#48	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal	$47.7K	**$70.3K**[2025]	+47% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#17	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	38	**38**[2025]	+1.3% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#49	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#49	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	21%	**23%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#25	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	33%	**36%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#7	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	2.6%	**0.0%**[2025]	−2.6 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#44	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	6.7%	**7.8%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#47	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

Sources

[1] Institute of International Education. *Open Doors Report on International Educational Exchange: State Fact Sheets*. Editions 2020–2026. New York: Institute of International Education. https://opendoorsdata.org/. Accessed November 2026.

[2] NAFSA: Association of International Educators. *NAFSA International Student Economic Value Tool*. Academic years 2018–19 to 2024–25. Washington, DC: NAFSA. https://www.nafsa.org/isev. Accessed November 2026.

[3] National Center for Education Statistics. *Digest of Education Statistics*. Editions 1995–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/programs/digest/. Accessed November 2026.

[4] National Center for Education Statistics. *Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS)*. Survey files, 1980–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/ipeds/. Accessed November 2026.

[5] National Center for Education Statistics. *National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP)*. NAEP Data Service, 1990–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://www.nationsreportcard.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[6] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Higher Education Research and Development Survey*. Data tables, FY2003–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/higher-education-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[7] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Earned Doctorates*. Data tables, 1994–2025. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/earned-doctorates. Accessed November 2026.

[8] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Federal Funds for Research and Development*. Data tables, FY1985–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/federal-funds-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[9] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates in Science and Engineering*. Data tables, 1994–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/graduate-students-postdoctorates-s-e. Accessed November 2026.

[10] U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. *Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics*. State estimates, 1999–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.bls.gov/oes/. Accessed November 2026.

[11] U.S. Census Bureau, Center for Economic Studies. *Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes (PSEO)*. Release R2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://lehd.ces.census.gov/data/pseo_experimental.html. Accessed November 2026.

[12] U.S. Census Bureau. *American Community Survey*. 1-year estimates and Public Use Microdata Sample, 2010–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://data.census.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[13] U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services. *H-1B Employer Data Hub*. Fiscal years 2009–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.uscis.gov/tools/reports-and-studies/h-1b-employer-data-hub. Accessed November 2026.

[14] U.S. Department of Education, Office for Civil Rights. *Civil Rights Data Collection*. School years 1980–81 to 2023–24. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://civilrightsdata.ed.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[15] U.S. Department of Education. *College Scorecard*. Institution and field-of-study data, 1996–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data/. Accessed November 2026.

[16] U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Office of Homeland Security Statistics. *Yearbook of Immigration Statistics*. Fiscal years 1996–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://ohss.dhs.gov/topics/immigration/yearbook. Accessed November 2026.

[17] U.S. Department of Labor, Employment and Training Administration, Office of Foreign Labor Certification. *LCA and PERM Disclosure Data*. Fiscal years 2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.dol.gov/agencies/eta/foreign-labor/performance. Accessed November 2026.

[18] U.S. Department of State, Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs. *BridgeUSA: Exchange Visitor Program Participants by State*. 2015–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of State. https://j1visa.state.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[19] U.S. Department of the Treasury, Bureau of the Fiscal Service. *USAspending.gov*. Award data, FY2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of the Treasury. https://www.usaspending.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[20] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Student and Exchange Visitor Program. *SEVIS by the Numbers: Data Mapping Tool*. Monthly data, 2014–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://studyinthestates.dhs.gov/sevis-data-mapping-tool. Accessed November 2026.

[21] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement. *Student and Exchange Visitor Information System (SEVIS) Data*. Freedom of Information Act releases, 2008–2016. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.ice.gov/foia/library. Accessed November 2026.

[22] U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. *PatentsView*. Annualized patent data, grant years 1976–2025. Alexandria, VA: U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. https://patentsview.org/. Accessed November 2026.